# CENTER FOR BLACK STUDENT EXCELLENCE

## A Place, An Approach, and a Redesign of the System

**Portland Public Schools**
Portland, Oregon

PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS | INNOVATION STUDIO

## THE PROBLEM:

Decades of underinvestment, systemic racism, lack of coordinated systems of support, and discriminatory practices have resulted in an enduring opportunity and achievement gap for Black students in Portland.

## THE OPPORTUNITY:

The opportunity ahead is to redefine the future by advancing a culture of Black excellence *while meaningfully integrating joy and healing*, unifying and elevating the Black educational experience, and improving outcomes for Black students.

## THE MECHANISM:

Center for Black Student Excellence.

*A place, an approach and a redesign of the system.*

# CO-DESIGNERS

The vision for the **Center for Black Student Excellence** is full of the fingerprints of our community. We couldn't have done this alone. We were tasked with creating a comprehensive, co-constructed, community plan to advance Black student excellence. This historic opportunity allows us to create a stronger future for Black students. Thank you to our community for this labor of love.

## "I AM BECAUSE WE ARE."

- African Proverb

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Black Educational Achievement Movement Village
Black Men In Training
Black Women for Peace
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Center for Black Excellence Steering Committee
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ConnectHer
Everyday Grinds
Feed'em Freedom Farm Hub
Four Forces Inc.
Global Movement Network
Kairos PDX
Love Is Stronger GV
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Museum of the African Diaspora
National Association of Minority Contractors
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Nurture
Portland Parks and Recreation TeenForce
SAMO
Self Enhancement, Inc.
Team Safer II
US First PDX
Word is Bond
Young Gifted and Black

We would also like to thank the justice-involved individuals and community groups that support them for sharing their experiences in this design process.

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# 01. INTRODUCTION

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- A Letter from the Superintendent and Executive Sponsor

# HISTORICAL CONTEXT

## HOW DID WE GET HERE?

Understanding Oregon's history of racism and discrimination

**"RACISM AND INEQUITY ARE PRODUCTS OF DESIGN. THEY CAN BE REDESIGNED."**

**- EQUITYXDESIGN**

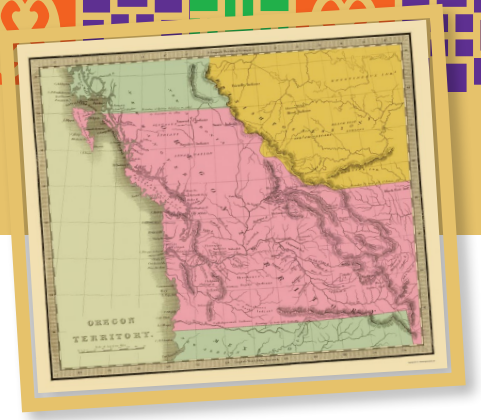
# BACKGROUND:
# LEGACY OF DISCRIMINATION

The fight for equitable access to public education in Portland is influenced by Oregon's path to statehood.

Oregon's Black Exclusion Law

## 1844

**OREGON PASSED A BLACK EXCLUSION LAW,** banning African Americans from entering, residing, or acquiring property. African Americans were met with threats of violence if they did not flee the state within three years of residence.




Oregon Territory

## 1857

**OREGON INCLUDED A "WHITES ONLY"** clause in its original constitution – the only such law for any state in the Union.

1

2

[1] Portland's Black children were denied the public education guaranteed all children by legislation.

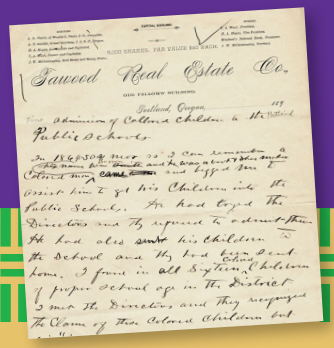
[2] Central school, located originally at Southwest Sixth and Morrison.

# 1859

## WHEN OREGON OFFICIALLY JOINED THE UNION,

Portland Public Schools had been established for nearly a decade.

But the school district had already adopted racist practices that disadvantage students of color -especially Black and Native students.



Jawood Real Estate Co.

Harrison Street school, was in operation when William Brown asked for his childern to be admitted to Portland's public schools.

# 1867

## WILLIAM BROWN,

a resident of Portland, tried but was unable to enroll his Black children in one of Portland's only two public elementary schools.

Brown appealed to the school board but was denied once again, in the first recorded case of racism against Black children in Portland Public Schools.

This historical example is one of many instances of racism that have affected the education of generations of Black students in the Portland area.

# ALBINA:
# FORCED DISPLACEMENT AND MARGINALIZATION

**The close-in Portland neighborhood of Albina was once the cultural capital of Black Portland, particularly after WWII. It offered world-class jazz venues, environmental-justice initiatives, and education models created for and by Black Portlanders. As with other previous neighborhoods where Black residents were allowed to live, Albina was segregated by design, yet it thrived – becoming a creative, affordable enclave for Portland's African American community.**

Black-owned businesses, homes, and faith institutions lined its streets.

Most importantly, the Albina neighborhood created a sense of place and community.

**By the 1960s, disinvestment and urban renewal– such as the construction of Interstate 5 – forcibly displaced thousands of Black residents and businesses from the neighborhood.**

The neighborhood's schools suffered under the weight of this upheaval. And in the end, students bore the cost. Forced busing sent many Black students to schools outside of their neighborhood.

# PPS REIMAGINED:
# A NEW VISION FOR PUBLIC EDUCATION

**In 2018, the Board of Education and the Superintendent of Portland Public Schools launched a community-wide process to develop a long-term vision for public education in Portland.** This vision, created after dozens of community meetings involving hundreds of stakeholders, describes PPS' aspirations for each member of the graduating class of 2030, and the educational experience that will increasingly become the reality for each PPS graduate.

While this vision titled **"PPS reImagined"** would set the "north star" of the school district's direction for the next decade, Black and Native students have continued to experience the greatest barriers in realizing the Vision of the Graduate Portrait.

# A TRADITION OF ADVOCATING FOR BLACK STUDENT ACHIEVEMENT

There have been long standing, well-documented examples of advocacy by Black leaders and Black-led organizations who fought for children and against discrimination.

**These efforts gained momentum in 2020 following the murder of George Floyd and the social movement for Black Lives.**

The work of improving educational outcomes for Black youth further accelerated when Portland's Black community leaders put forth the concept of the Center for Black Student Excellence (CBSE).

Later in 2020, voters approved a bond measure that enabled Black-led and -serving educational organizations in the Albina community to engage in the design and implementation of the CBSE.

The core idea behind the CBSE comprised both material components – such as redesigning the physical environment – and symbolic ones, such as culturally responsive curriculum, including comprehensive Black and African-American history.

# MEETING THE MOMENT WITH INSTITUTIONAL INVESTMENT

**By December of 2020,** the Superintendent of PPS directed staff to prioritize the creation of the first multi-year strategic plan to focus on actively implementing PPS reImagined. **The Center for Black Student Excellence** became a priority within the 2021-2025 Strategic Plan for Racial Equity, Inclusion and Excellence.

# DEVELOPING THE CBSE:
# NEW PARTNERSHIPS AND COALITIONS

**To turn the vision for the Center for Black Student Excellence into reality, in 2022, the PPS Board of Education unanimously approved a historic cooperating agreement with the Albina Vision Trust (AVT) – a community-based organization facilitating the thoughtful reinvention and transformation of the 94-acres of lower Albina, which remains as an emotional marrow of the now-dispersed Black community.**

This community-led effort is embarking on efforts to listen, learn, and present a plan to develop a youth-centered community in lower Albina that creates opportunities for Portland's next generation of Black people to learn, build wealth and reclaim their cultural center.

A 13-member Board, comprising members chosen by a Steering Committee of senior leaders from established, Black-led organizations, have met regularly to focus on student-facing PPS capital projects, including the Jefferson High School modernization and the relocation of Harriet Tubman Middle School; the Center for Black Student Excellence; the monitoring of of the Black student experience in PPS schools; and leading a vision for future projects and work streams to enrich the Black student experience.

Within PPS, the district's Innovation Studio, a problem-solving accelerator, was tasked with facilitating the design and engagement process using its Innovation Equity Design methodology.

**During the process, PPS tapped into the experience of subject matter experts, stakeholders with lived experience in the community, and a Guiding Coalition, which included students, Black-led organizations and leaders who have a history of influencing change within the community, including Albina Head Start, Black Parent Initiative, KairosPDX, Portland Opportunities Industrialization Center, REAP and Self-Enhancement, Inc. and others.**

KairosPDX

Albina Head Start and Early Head Start

SEI
YOUTH POTENTIAL REALIZED

ALBINA

POIC®
Portland Opportunities Industrialization Center

BLACK PARENT INITIATIVE

REAP
the next wave of leaders

# PUTTING OUR VALUES INTO ACTION

These engagement opportunities included hallmark moments that further exemplified PPS' commitment to forging a new path with the Black community, such as the renaming of the district headquarters after the late Dr. Matthew Prophet, Jr. whose legacy as PPS' first Black superintendent was one of encouraging and supporting Black excellence.

**In the decade that Dr. Prophet led our city's school system, from 1982 to 1992, he helped stabilize district funding.** He rightly saw promise in ALL students - and he made it his goal to raise and recognize achievement for those who had historically been left behind.

**Under his leadership, Black students saw a**

**65%**
**improvement in mathematics**

**43%**
**improvement in reading assessments**

Dr. Prophet also helped open doors for a greater share of Black students to continue their education beyond high school. **For instance, the percentage of Black high school graduates choosing higher education rose from 49% in 1987 to 80% by 1991.**

**49%** in 1987 → **80%** in 1991

Renaming a prominent physical space in his honor came only months after his passing in 2022 at the age of 92.

# MOMENTUM UNDERGIRDED BY BLACK SCHOLARLY RESEARCH

"JUST BEAR WITH ME AND DON'T GIVE UP ON ME."

"BE THERE FOR ME WHEN I NEED YOU."

"UNDERSTAND ME."

BREONNA TAYLOR
JAMES FORMAN

While the development of the Center for Black Student Excellence is driven by community advocacy, Black researchers and scholars have built a braintrust of expertise from which this project draws upon. The conditions that prevent Black students from thriving in Portland Public Schools are generational and persistent. Black students currently experience low academic performance as evidenced by Measure of Academic Progress (MAP) assessment data, disproportionate discipline as noted by increased rates of suspension and discipline hearings, and community violence heightened by a lack of belonging and access to a quality educational environment. **When asked what educators need to know about how to better support Black students, Black youth have consistently appealed to be seen, heard, and understood from a cultural perspective.**

**“Just bear with me and don't give up on me."**
**"Be there for me when I need you.”**
**“Understand me.”**

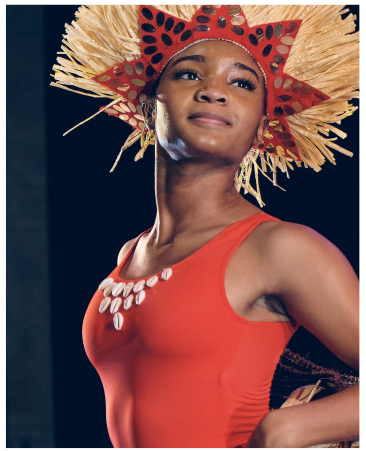
The opportunity of the Center for Black Student Excellence is met with research that positively correlates cultural affirmation and community networks with improved academic and social outcomes. In order to significantly elevate the Black educational experience, we need to advance a culture of Black excellence, increase the presence of Black educators, and commit to maintaining high expectations, while meaningfully integrating joy and healing. It is under these conditions, research shows, that Black students will thrive.

# ADVANCING A CULTURE OF BLACK EXCELLENCE

Positive Cultural Identity Development and Student Advocacy are two strategies that confirm that students are able to be more confident and have a positive cultural identity when they are allowed to share elements of their culture with their peers. Research shows that when students have a positive, well-informed sense of self, they are able to have social and emotional success (Chen, 2005). Research also shows that when students are able to have a positive sense of their racial identity, when they can identify and critique racism, advocate for themselves, and are being offered culturally relevant instruction, then students have a clearer and more supportive opportunity to attain and maintain academic success (Ginwright, James, 2002).

American psychologist Urie Bronfenbrenner was the first to put forth the 'Ecological Systems Theory' (Bronfenbrenner, 1974) based on understanding of a child's relationship to the systems that influence them. His theory is one of the most accepted explanations about how one's environment influences an individual's development.

Local and national Black scholars, however, are increasingly understanding how Brofenbrenner's theory fails to reflect the particular influences of an endemic devaluation that Black children consistently encounter within various social environments.



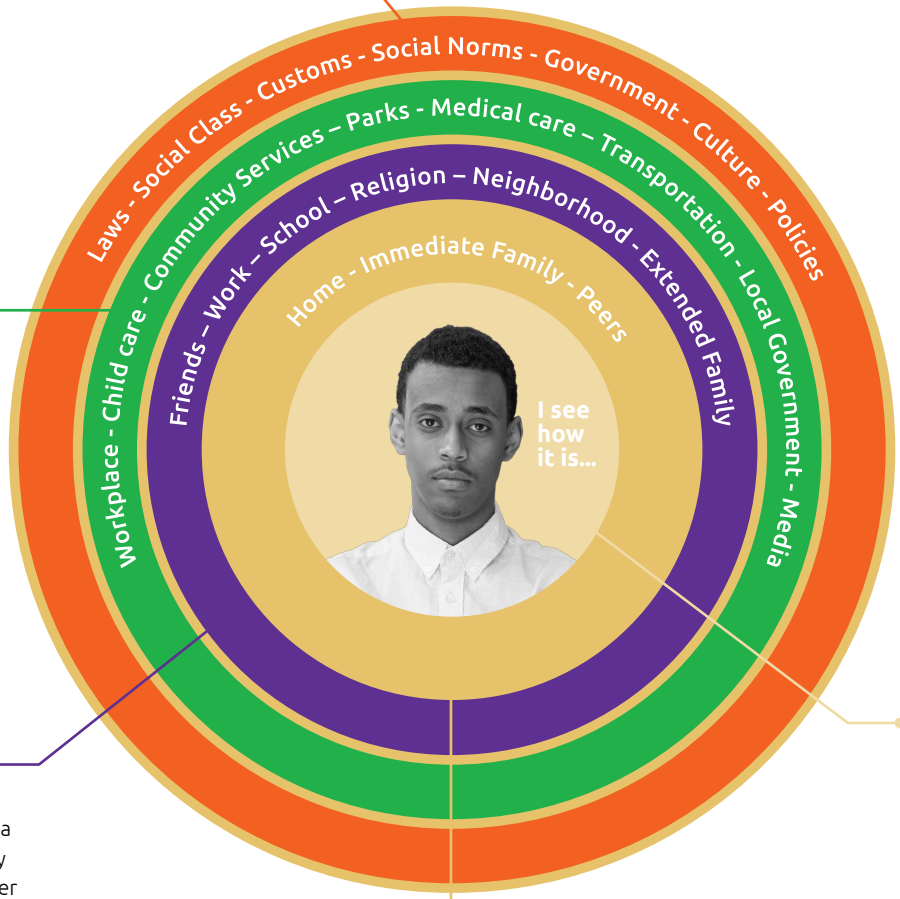
**In the groundbreaking study, "In My Power, I Empower: Moving Black Youth from Spirit Murder to Emotional Emancipation" (2021), Portland's Dr. S. Renee Mitchell, a former high-school teacher, was the first to tease out the unique experiences of African Americans in relation to each of the ecosystems articulated by Brofenbrenner.** Mitchell argues that to more deeply understand Black students' academic experiences, one must begin thinking of Black students in relation to the layers of their lived experiences, which is steeped in and deeply influenced by racism, and in particular, anti-Blackness. Understanding that context shapes the low academic achievement of Black students as a consequence of their broken hearts, not inferior minds.

# Black children are set up to fail from birth.
## *When will the healing begin?*

**Color key**
Macrosystem
Exosystem
Mesosystem
Microsystem
Individual

### MACROSYSTEM
Society, laws, customs, and policies are socially constructed to favor whiteness and justify racial oppression in the lie of Black inferiority. Government engages in financial disinvestment, negligence, and injustice in employment, housing, health care, law enforcement, land use, child welfare, transportation, and privatization of public services. Gentrification disrupts historically Black neighborhoods. Prisons serve as free labor.

### EXOSYSTEM
Anti-Black messages are perpetuated in media. Black families work more hours and earn less. Schools lack sufficient resources. Affordable child-care centers are limited. Community services provided from deficit lens (reduce violence, increase academic achievement) that reinforces stereotypes. Bias of medical care providers contributes to health disparities. Absence or underfunding of community-based, culturally specific services. Limited access to safe, neighborhood parks. Over-reliance on public transportation.




### MESOSYSTEM
Gang violence & peer victimization. Family dysfunction shuttles Black children toward a culturally deficit foster care system. Racially disproportionate health issues lead to higher death and infant mortality rates. Lack of connection to neighborhood and friends because of gentrification leads to depression and disconnection.

### MICROSYSTEM
Race-based traumatic stress intensifies. Grief from repeated Black death. Poverty. Police bias. Family dysfunction breeds child abuse, sexual and physical abuse, and divorce. Neighborhoods lack safe places to play. Subconscious racial bias of white educators make schools "a site of Black suffering." School-to-prison pipeline.

### INDIVIDUAL
Anti-Blackness organizes the social context of each Black child's life. Impacts: Prolonged grief, self-hatred, shame, hidden rage, aggression, helplessness, frustration. Unhealthy eating, sleep impairment, paranoia, alcohol & drug use, fatalism.

### Here's what the research says works:

- Black children find meaning & belonging when engaged in creativity and interdepence.
- Black children need to build critical consciousness to understand how to navigate around the pro-White, anti-Black social systems designed to oppress them.
- Using storytelling, creativity, and naming of anti-Blackness provides necessary context for healing.

**Source:** Adopted from Bronfenbrenner, U. (1979) by Dr. S. Renee Mitchell (2021)

Further, Dr. Joy DeGruy, in her revised 2017 book, **"Post Traumatic Slave Syndrome – America's Legacy of Enduring Injury and Healing,"** defined maladaptive survival behaviors in African American communities throughout the United States and the Diaspora as a consequence of multigenerational oppression of Africans and their descendants resulting from centuries of chattel slavery, which was followed by generations of institutionalized racism. Under such persistently undermining circumstances, according to DeGruy, predictable negative behavior patterns form in Black children and adults, which include the lack of self-esteem, high risk of violence, and internalized racism (DeGruy, 2017). **These patterns have contributed to a re-emergence of community violence that has captured the attention of local and national news as gun-violence perpetrators are becoming younger. The epidemic of gun violence, as noted by the American Public Health Association, is the leading cause of premature death (Benjamin, 2015).**

And yet, insights from Black scholars echoed in decades-old research from the 1960s and beyond identify that there is potential progress if schools and society address the underlying issues that historically and consistently prevent Black students from achieving socially and academically. Similarly, for decades, Black scholars have pointed to healing practices as a key lever to reverse the effects of racialized trauma. *"This is a troublesome argument, touching as it does on a still unhealed part of American race relations," noted Claude M. Steele, in The Atlantic Online in April 1992. "But it leads us to a heartening principle: If blacks are made less racially vulnerable in school, they can overcome even substantial obstacles."*

"BUT IT LEADS US TO A HEARTENING PRINCIPLE: IF BLACKS ARE MADE LESS RACIALLY VULNERABLE IN SCHOOL,THEY CAN OVERCOME EVEN SUBSTANTIAL OBSTACLES."

Each of these mentioned studies, in 1992, 2017, and 2021, confirm the need for schools and society to acknowledge and provide spiritual, psychological and social support for Black students, which research acknowledges as the most prodigiously traumatized adolescent group. Scholarly research also calls upon educators to support these youth to critically examine and reject racist, sexist ideals embedded in popular culture (Love, 2009). As the research surmises, youth must be rooted in a positive sense of self, empowered to advocate for themselves, and critique unjust systems while also cultivating opportunities to experience joy and healing. Additionally, as research positively connects play to learning, when we nourish liberatory spaces for Black youth to experience playfulness, it becomes a powerful way for them to radically heal from trauma, resist violence, and experience joy and liberation (Hill, 2021).

# UNIFYING AND ELEVATING THE BLACK EDUCATIONAL EXPERIENCE

Generations of racist policies and practices have negatively affected Black families and their children in the Portland area. Placemaking in Albina was initially coerced by racist policies forcing Black community members to concentrate in Northeast Portland, so Black community members laid claim to the Albina area, as it was the only neighborhood most Blacks were allowed to live in (Gibson, 2007). Now, Black Portlanders, who have endured generations of serial forced displacement, find themselves scattered across the city, with no emotional connection to any particular neighborhood outside of Albina.

**In Portland Public Schools, Black students occupy <1-51% of schools' populations across the district, with the largest percentages still within the historic Albina neighborhood (2022, October 3).**

PPS also offers a **Right to Return** opportunity which allows students in David Douglas, Reynolds and Parkrose school districts to transfer to PPS, based on the harmful impacts of urban renewal and gentrification, specifically in North/Northeast Portland neighborhoods.

## Culturally Specific Partnerships

Research suggests that there are positive benefits to culturally specific services provided by culturally relevant providers. The literature shows the value of such services meets the needs of communities of color, both in improving individual health and well-being outcomes and also improving social capital by engaging in community development and systemic advocacy (Lambarth, Cross-Hemmer, Mitchell, Green, 2019).

**Research asserts that the three benefits of investing in this approach include:**

- Increased engagement and improved outcomes for children of color.
- Increased family engagement and community involvement.
- Improved ability to address opportunity gaps in access to culturally relevant supports.
- And more inclusive decision-making.

## Family Engagement

Equitable family engagement does not characterize or treat specific parent groups as deficient in their level of engagement or approach to education (Day, 2013). Instead, it focuses on meaningful engagement activities and systems between schools and families, as family engagement is understood to be a high-leverage strategy that supports student learning and is designed to reduce or eliminate institutional barriers for families of color to advocate for the needs of their students. Dr. Karen Mapp developed the Dual Capacity-Building Framework for Family-School Partnerships (Version 2) based on existing research and best practices to support the development of family engagement strategies, policies, and programs (Bergman, Mapp, 2019). This framework advises that educational systems work in tandem with families to increase student achievement and school improvement and adopt specific strategies that are unique to the school context.

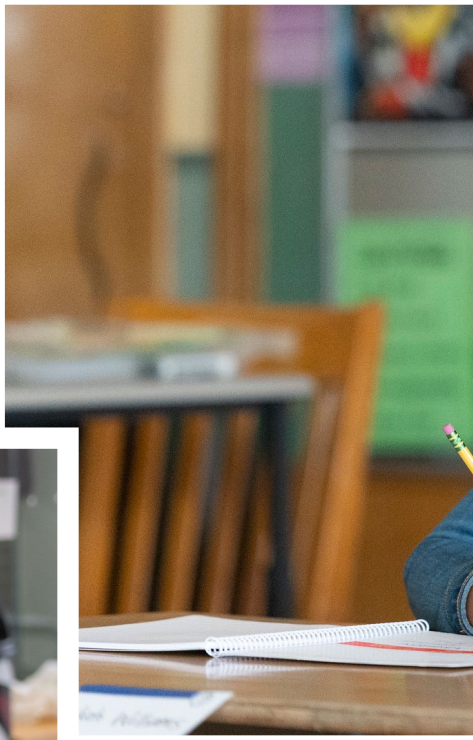
## Black Educator Retention

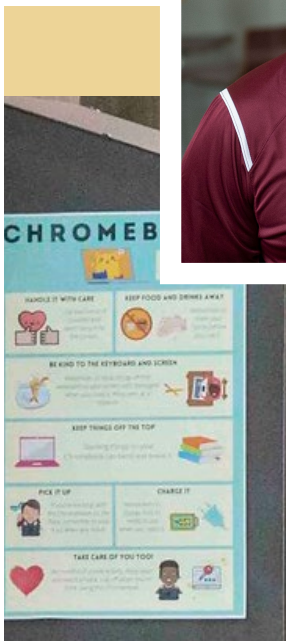
Research studies show that Black students who have had at least one Black teacher have powerful academic outcomes and personal trajectories, as Black teachers offer what Naman (2009) terms as "cultural synchronicity." In addition, according to Ware (2002), *"students who were identified as having low socioeconomic status and those identified as low achievers were frequently more dependent on Black teachers because those teachers helped their students to develop their self-concept."*

To this day, though, school districts are experiencing difficulty recruiting and retaining Black educators. The untold emotional and academic impact on Black students who lack access to Black teachers can be traced to the historical 1954 Brown v. Board of Education ruling, which also negatively influenced the health of Black communities because of the dismantling of the teaching profession as a stable middle-class profession. According to Hudson and Holmes (1994), *"the loss of African American teachers in public school settings has had a lasting negative impact on all students, particularly African American students and the communities in which they reside… (A)lthough the shrinking African American teacher pool has been attributable to several factors, it is partly a fall-out of how Brown was implemented by white American policy makers (p. 389)."*

According to the Institute for Research and Labor Employment, Black teachers have the highest rate of turnover because of working conditions in schools (Gershenson, Hart, Lindsay & Papageorge, 2017).

And much of that exodus, as noted by Scallon, Bristol, Esboldt (2023), "across grade level, contexts, and student demographics, teachers' perceptions of principal leadership have had the greatest influence on teachers' decisions to stay in or leave their schools (pg. 2).





"THE LOSS OF AFRICAN AMERICAN TEACHERS IN PUBLIC SCHOOL SETTINGS HAS HAD A LASTING NEGATIVE IMPACT ON ALL STUDENTS, PARTICULARLY AFRICAN AMERICAN STUDENTS AND THE COMMUNITIES IN WHICH THEY RESIDE..."

## Community Schools

Community Schools are public schools that provide services and support that fit each neighborhood's needs, created and run by the people who are expected to "know our children best" —all working together. They are rooted in the academic core while also attending to the whole child. In this structure, parents and schools need to engage in reflection, clear communications partnerships, and adequate training in order for the school to have a collectivist approach to student education.

An intentional, collectivist approach is when a group focuses on a common goal over the individual wants and desires of each individual. Partnership among all stakeholders to make possible the academic success for all students, particularly Black students, needs to happen as a joint effort, and it needs to be a collective and collaborative process that is grounded in an abolitionist paradigm. *"Valuing the knowledge and strength of communities that have survived and thrived in the face of centuries of oppression, we conclude that community stakeholders in collaboration with education workers, from organizers to students, envisioned a blurring of communities and schools as part of a strategy to build collective power that both exposes and challenges injustice"* (Daniel, Sunshine Malone & Kirkland, 2020).

# IMPROVING OUTCOMES FOR BLACK STUDENTS

## Culturally Responsive Instruction

Culturally responsive instruction is a pedagogy that incorporates the values, beliefs, expressions, and behaviors that a particular cultural group shares in order to teach them new knowledge and skills (Noguera, 2003). According to Noguera (2003), teachers who use this model tend to make skill-building more meaningful to that student, as opposed to just expecting students to adapt their learning style to the way that's most comfortable or the teacher.

In addition, cultural responsiveness includes consciously pursuing partnerships with families the schools serve, and the culturally specific partners that work in those communities. This collective approach generates social capital, and establishes a commitment to mutual accountability and responsibility as co-decision makers and advocates. Without this type of approach, according to Noguera, *"Schools that isolate themselves from the*

*neighborhoods they serve because they perceive the residents as 'threatening,' tend to undermine the social capital of the community. Often, the presence of such schools contributes to the exodus of families with resources, both financial and social, from poor communities, and the lowering of property values. o the extent that such schools are perceived as ineffective and incapable of serving the needs of children, they operate as a source of negative social capital because they further the marginalization of the community; eventually such schools serve only those who are unable to escape them."*

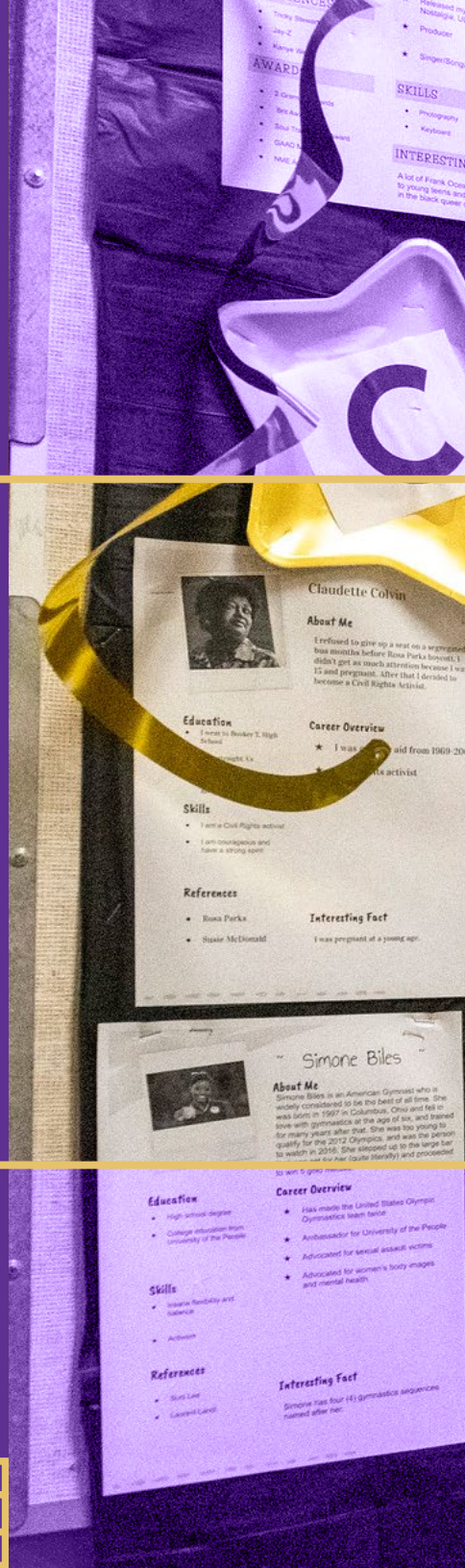
However, when school communities recognize the conditions of Black students, provide them with culturally affirming experiences, and are committed to working with culturally relevant stakeholders, the outcomes are bound to be favorable toward students. This is called a wraparound approach. Research shows that a wraparound approach has many positive youth outcomes *"including reduced out-of-home placements, improvements in mental health functioning, and better school attendance and achievement"* (Walker, 2008). This wraparound approach is also aligned with Afrocentric pedagogy of (1) cooperation in order to establish a familial environment for students; (2) affirmation of students' culture and challenges of oppressive practices based on race; and (3) preserving the dignity of those targeted by historical and ongoing injustice (Howard, 2019).

The research supports the idea that students whose cultural context is acknowledged and factored into the learning experience; whose school forms alliances with the family through authentic engagement; who receive positive social affirmations; who have access to culturally specific partnerships and diverse educators will see outcomes improve.

# DEFINING "BLACKNESS"

"THERE ARE AS MANY WAYS OF BEING BLACK AS THERE ARE BLACK PEOPLE, BUT THE EXPERIENCE OF BEING BLACK UNITES US."

- IMAGINE BLACK



CELEBRATION
OF BLACK EXCELLENCE
Ms. Fournier's Student Scholars
Created Resumes Of Black Excellence

"THERE ARE AS MANY WAYS OF BEING BLACK AS THERE ARE BLACK PEOPLE, BUT THE EXPERIENCE OF BEING BLACK UNITES US."

**The African diaspora refers to the collective identity of the many communities of people of African descent dispersed throughout the world as a result of historic movements through forced and voluntary migration.** The racial categorization of Blackness, however, was first created arbitrarily to justify forced enslavement.

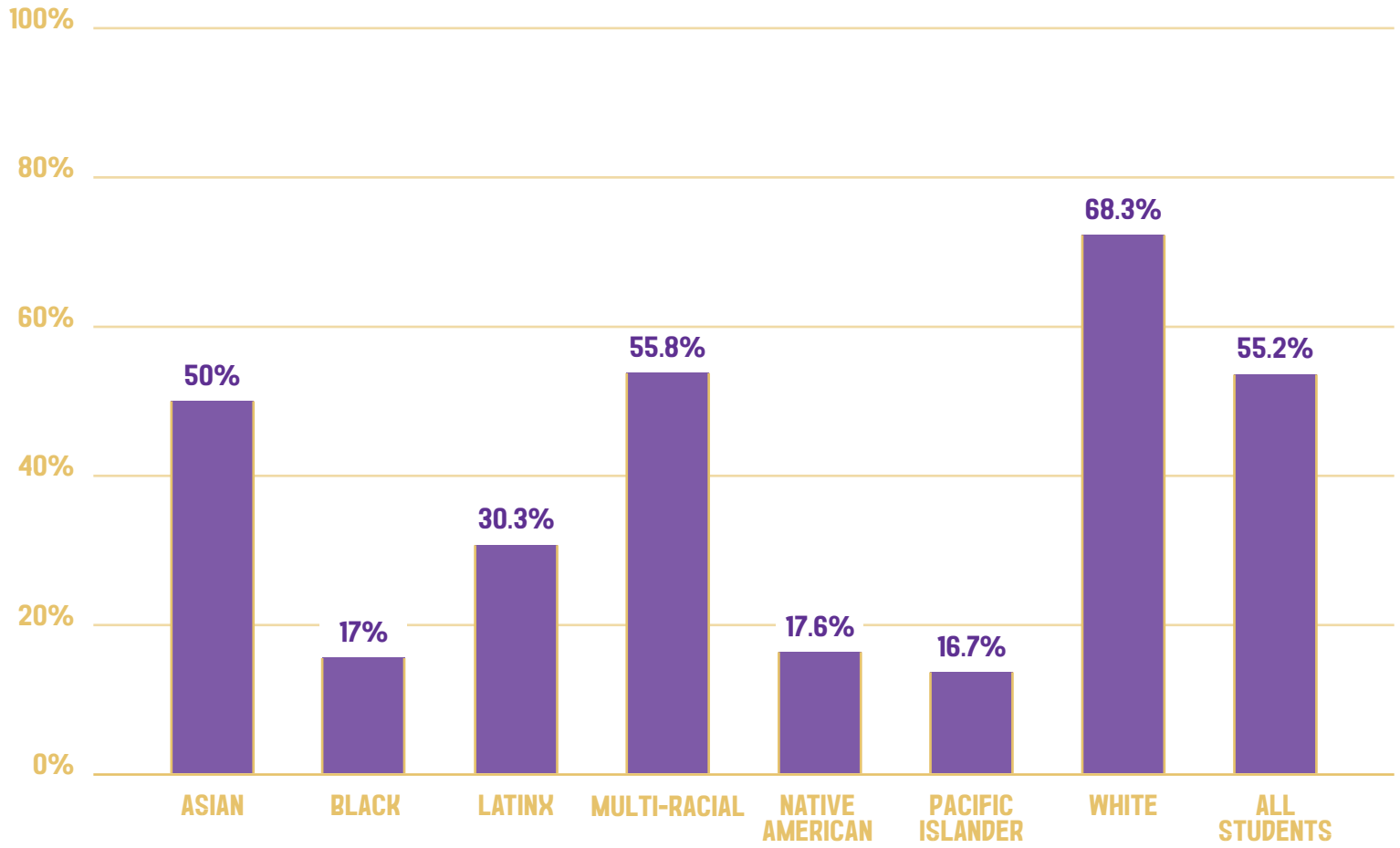
As Black people embrace their identity, the reclamation of this racial categorization can be attributed to Black people's resilience in resisting systems of oppression. As articulated by Imagine Black, *"There are as many ways of being Black as there are Black people, but the experience of being Black unites us."*

# WHAT STORY DOES THE DATA TELL?

For decades, Portland Public Schools has underserved its Black students. **The proof is in the data: Systemic racism and discriminatory practices have negatively impacted the quality of education that Black students receive,** resulting in a pernicious opportunity and achievement gap.

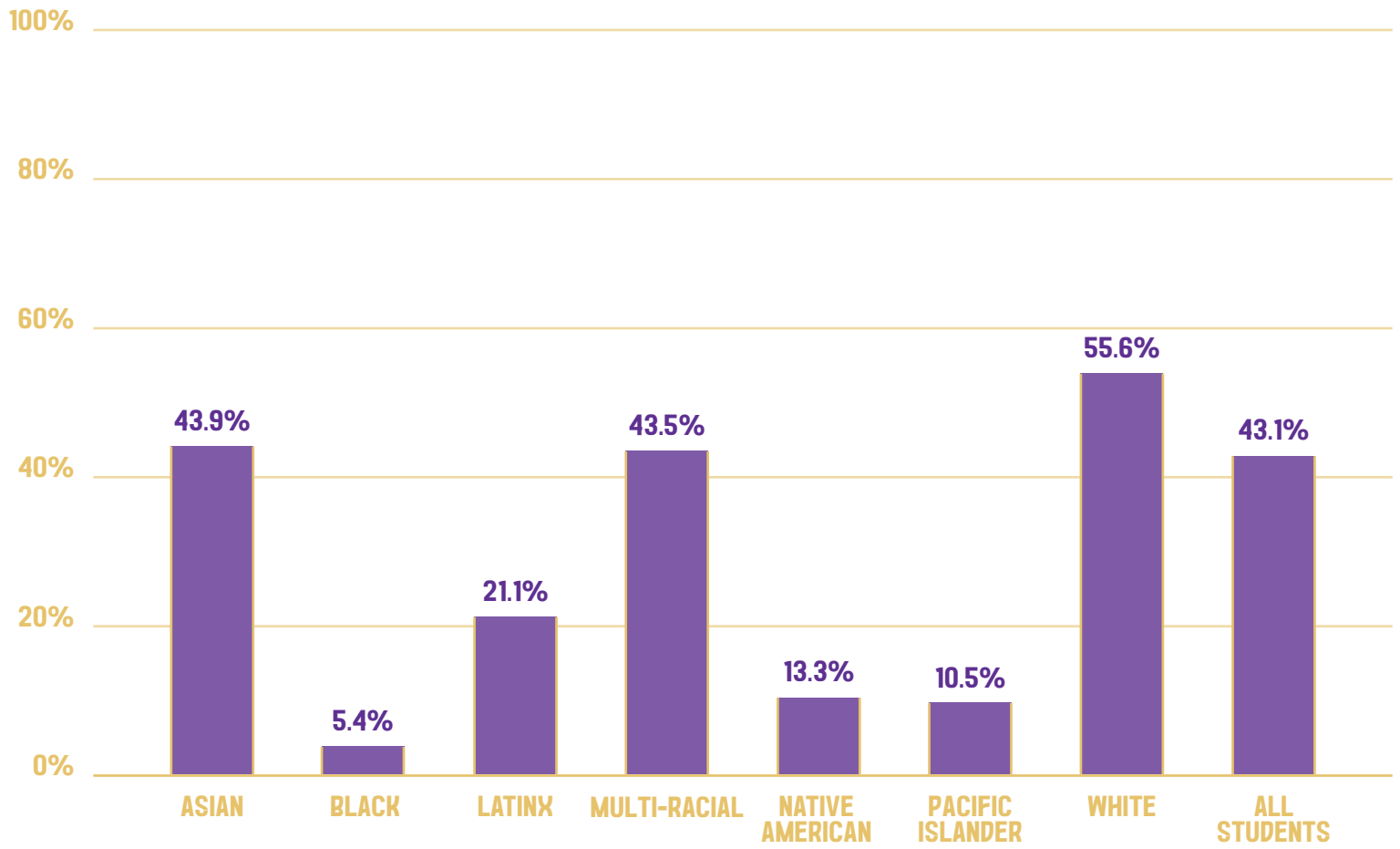
## 3RD GRADE READING | 2021-22 Third Grade Proficiency in ELA by Race/Ethnicity

Recent data shows that only 17 percent of Black students meet third grade reading proficiency levels.



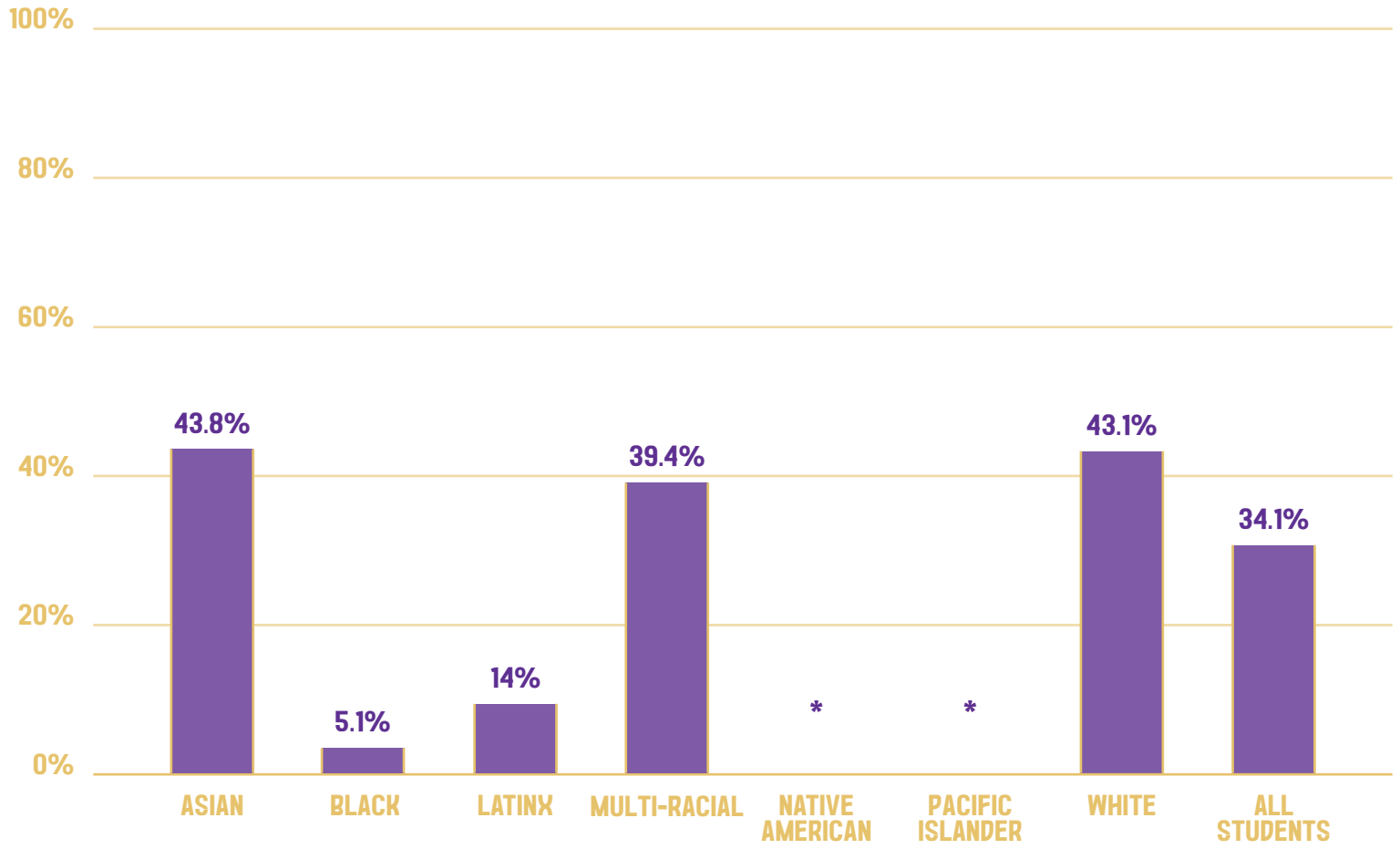
## 5TH GRADE READING | 2021-22 Fifth Grade Proficiency in ELA by Race/Ethnicity

By the time Black students are in the fifth grade, only five percent of them are proficient in math.



## 8TH GRADE READING | 2021-22 Eighth Grade Proficiency in ELA by Race/Ethnicity

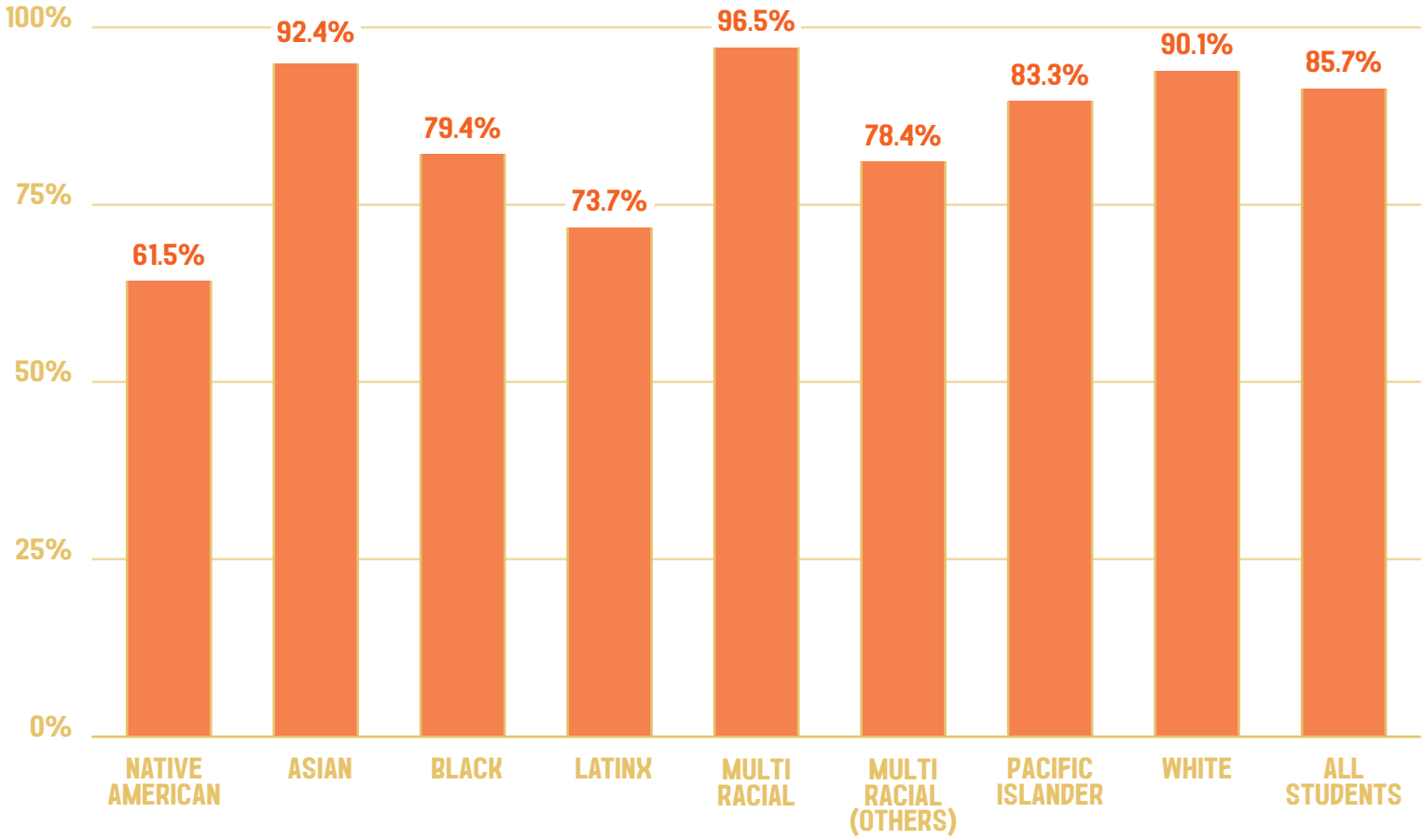
Among eighth graders, one out of every 20 Black students is proficient in language arts and math. Meanwhile, 43 percent of white students are equipped with the necessary skills they need to be successful in high school.




*Results are suppressed to protect student confidentiality. When a single group has fewer than 11 students, data for the second smallest group is also suppressed.

## HIGH SCHOOL GRADUATION | 2021-22 High School Graduation Rates by Race/Ethnicity

Currently, 79 percent of Black students are graduating high school. That figure is unacceptable. All Black students deserve to not only graduate high school, but to do so proficiently with a post secondary plan.



Black students in Portland Public Schools are three and a half times more likely to be referred, excluded or sent to disciplinary hearing compared to their white peers. There is a direct correlation between discipline and graduation rates.

# PPS DISCIPLINARY DATA MIRRORS NATIONAL TRENDS

We recognize that implicit bias influences everyone's decisions.

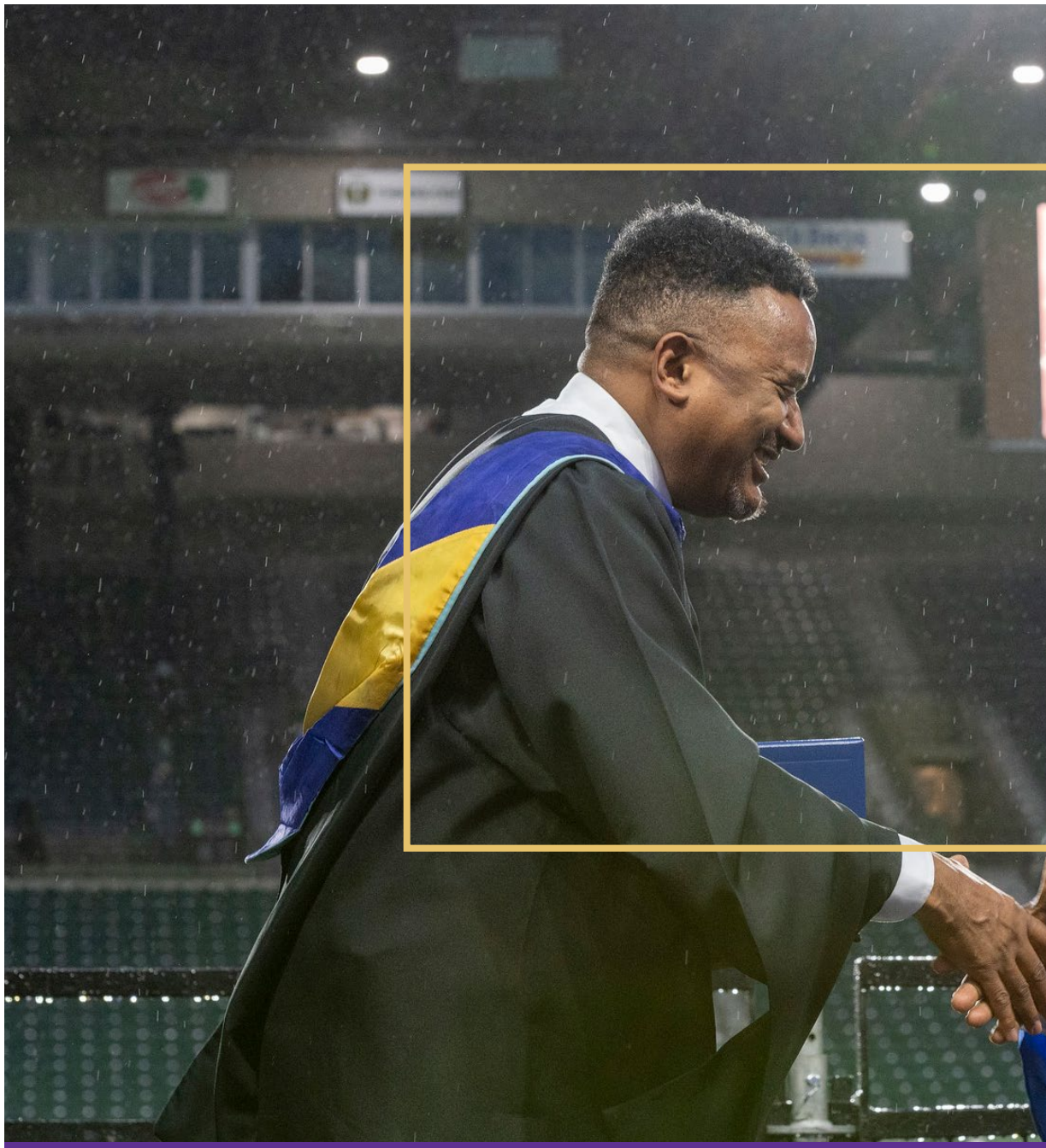
Across the US, Black, Native American and students of color and students with disabilities are disproportionately referred, suspended or expelled from public school.

**Unfortunately, PPS is not an outlier.**

There is a strong correlation between school discipline and the likelihood of dropping out, arrests, and incarceration.

PPS discipline data mirrors disproportionate impact on students of color being referred, suspended, and sent to disciplinary hearings at higher rates than their white counterparts:

- Black Students: x 3.5
- Native American Students: x 2.5
- Latinx Students: x 1.24



In addition, **students with disabilities are referred and suspended 2x times the rate** of their non-disabled peers.

**These results are not representative of Black students' capability.** Rather, they are reflective of the system that underserves them. Black students deserve to receive high quality learning and better outcomes. The educational experience maintains their futures.

# COMMUNITY DESIGN & ENGAGEMENT

"INNOVATION IS CREATIVITY THAT DISRUPTS THE STATUS QUO BY EMPOWERING THOSE WHO WILL BE MOST IMPACTED TO CREATE POWERFUL CHANGE."

- INNOVATION STUDIO

OPERATIONAL

## About the Innovation Studio

The Portland Public Schools Innovation Studio is a problem-solving accelerator that enables PPS teams across the organization to design equity-centered solutions in service of PPS ReImagined, the district vision and Forward Together, Portland Public Schools' 2021–2025 Strategic Plan for Equity, Inclusion, and Excellence.

## Engagement Approach

The Center for Black Student Excellence design and engagement process is rooted in the Innovation Studio's Innovation Equity Design methodology. This method and accompanying mindsets exist at the intersection of racial equity, social justice and design thinking. Central to the process is the recognition that those most impacted by a challenge should be empowered to co-create the solutions. Innovation in PPS is defined as:

**"CREATIVITY THAT DISRUPTS THE STATUS QUO BY EMPOWERING THOSE WHO WILL BE MOST IMPACTED TO CREATE POWERFUL CHANGE."**

While community engagement often falls on a spectrum, the Innovation Studio has maintained its resolve to Center, Collaborate, Empower and Involve Black students, staff, partners, experts, and community members in the co-creation of this historic plan. Throughout the process, the Innovation Studio in partnership with project partners - such as Imagine Black Futures, Colloqate Design, and I Am MORE (Making Ourselves Resilient Everyday) - has employed trauma-informed healing practices, design justice, and Black radical imagination as foundational practices.

## Community Design Phases

The project phases are reflected as a continuous progression, but it's also important to recognize that PPS has remained flexible to move at the speed of trust. Only recently, has the restoration process begun.

### Phase I: Relationships, History, Healing and Needs Finding

Phase I of the CBSE design process included activities to encourage relationship building. During this phase, project participants explored the histories that have shaped the current Black student experience in PPS schools. In addition, project participants engaged in a needs analysis to define what the CBSE should accomplish on behalf of primary stakeholders.

### Phase II: Inspiration and Ideation

During Phase II, project participants learned from examples of people and organizations that are demonstrating Black excellence. The Innovation Studio created immersive experiences to generate inspiration for what Portland Public Schools' CBSE could be as students and the community began to generate new and creative solutions to address the challenges inhibiting Black student success.

### Phase III: Prototype and Test

During Phase III, project participants began to formulate a series of concepts to reimagine the Black student experience. Over several engagement opportunities, these concepts were reflected back to community members to be refined.

### Phase IV: Test

During Phase IV, project participants continued to refine the concepts and focus on the implications of these shifts to the current system before submitting the plan to the PPS Board of Education for final approval.

# GUIDING PRINCIPLES

The Center for Black Student Excellence Design Team and Guiding Coalition created a **set of principles that will govern the vision and implementation of the CBSE over the course of several work sessions.**

ALLIANCE
OF BLACK
EDUCATORS

These **eight guiding principles** are central to the CBSE's mission and will act as key influences to all decision making.

**01**

**The Center for Black Student Excellence will ensure that all students are seen, welcomed, valued and heard** for their genius through authentic engagement with rigorous learning to encourage openness to learning.

**02**

**The Center for Black Student Excellence** efforts will center Blackness unapologetically.

**03**

**The Center for Black Student Excellence will ensure that Black students and Black educators in PPS access empowering activities, services, and relationships,** regardless of their learning location by reimagining possibilities where they can be authentically themselves and be provided love, nurturing, and support.

**04**

**The Center for Black Student Excellence and its partners will ensure that Black students will graduate** with a post-secondary plan.

**05**

Every aspect of the design of the Center for Black Student Excellence will emulate intentionality around **bringing out the excellence in Black students.**

**06**

**The Center for Black Student Excellence programming will recognize and incorporate the brilliance of the past and present** in the creation of African, African American, and Caribbean curriculum; assume best intentions of the members on the Center for Black Student Excellence committees; and center and apply the feedback of Black students.

**07**

The Center for Black Student Excellence **will prioritize justice and liberation.**

**08**

**The Center for Black Student Excellence will cultivate a culture of trust, transparency and authenticity** that centers students and accommodates their individuality and unique experiences.

# JOURNEY**MAP**

This Journey Map details the **timeline** and **sequence of community design and engagement activities** from fall 2022 through spring 2023.

Center for
Black Student
Excellence

# FALL 2022 THROUGH SPRING 2023

## 2022

### SEPTEMBER 20

#### PPS BOARD APPROVAL OF THE COOPERATION AGREEMENT BETWEEN PPS AND CENTER FOR BLACK EXCELLENCE (CBE)

The PPS Board adopted a resolution that read in part: "The vision of the CBSE is one of collaboration, among Black-led community organizations and PPS ... working together to advance a culture of Black excellence, unify, and elevate the Black educational experience, and improve outcomes for Black students, families, and educators."

### OCTOBER

#### IN-SCHOOL DESIGN RESEARCH: PHASE I

The district's Innovation Studio launched preliminary design research with students, staff, and families to understand the current experiences in our schools.This phase involved activities aimed at building relationships, healing, exploring the history leading up to the project, and needs finding.

### OCTOBER 31

#### CBSE MIXER

The Innovation Studio held a kickoff gathering at the Prophet Education Center for members of the CBSE working groups. This gathering served as the first interaction with peers as the project moved into the design phase.

### NOVEMBER 4-5

#### GUIDING COALITION #1

Through a set of curated activities, the Guiding Coalition performed a needs analysis, visioned towards the future, and became acquainted with the overall design process. The group explored the origins behind the project, discussed what current research says about the condition of Black students and families, participated in collective storytelling, and established guiding principles for the project.

## 2023

### DEC 2022-FEB 2023

#### COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT: PHASE II

The second phase of the work involved Inspiration and Ideation. Drawing from both local and national exemplars of Black excellence, an array of community organizations, Black community leaders, students, educators, and Portland residents learned from others to inform what could be possible for Portland's CBSE. Importantly, PPS students and recent graduates shared their aspirations and experiences within the district – crucial input for the design of the CBSE.

## JANUARY 27-28

### GUIDING COALITION #2

The Guiding Coalition built on the initial work from Fall 2022 to understand the origins and research basis for the project, and focused squarely on student voice. During this gathering, the Guiding Coalition leaned on art, design fiction, multimedia and primary source documents to begin generating creative solutions to the challenges identified during the first session. This served as the first opportunity to begin defining a CBSE brand identity.

## FEBRUARY 17-18

### GUIDING COALITION #3

The Guiding Coalition established foundational knowledge in how to read space, shared ideas about the physical design of the CBSE and contemplated how the CBSE infrastructure might coexist alongside current PPS facilities. In addition, the group raised and prioritized the programmatic needs of the CBSE both in schools and within the new infrastructure. To further develop the brand identity, the group studied the efficacy of how students currently receive messaging.

## MARCH-APRIL

### COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT: PHASE III

During the prototype and testing phase, community members began to see the emergence of vision and strategies – while also refining early assumptions. These stakeholder-specific engagements elicited discussions about safety, educator beliefs, the family's role, special education, immigrant and refugee experiences, identity, belonging, engaging elders, career pathways, the role of faith based communities, partnership and collaboration.

## MARCH 17-18

### GUIDING COALITION #4

During the final session, the Guiding Coalition spotlighted parent and caregiver voices and student gifts and talents. The group mapped system level barriers to mitigate against, and collectively reviewed and refined all of the work to date.

## APRIL 1-30

### COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT: PHASE IV

The final phase of the design process involved staff interviews to understand the implication of the emerging CBSE on the system at large with the goal of submitting final recommendations to the Portland School Board to vote on by May 23rd, 2023.

# A LETTER FROM THE SUPERINTENDENT & EXECUTIVE SPONSOR

Four years ago, our community came together to reimagine our district and specify the qualities we wanted our graduates to exhibit. Over the past four years, we've been building, shifting, and shaping our educational system into the equity-centered institution our students and community deserve.

It is now time that we finish building and then institutionalize a critical force in our system's transformation: the Center for Black Student Excellence. Following deep stakeholder engagement, we are ready to join with the community to bring this innovative constellation of infrastructure, strategies, and newly designed systems to life.

We know why we need the Center for Black Student Excellence. Our Black students experience persistent, generational, and unacceptable achievement gaps. They graduate at lower rates. They are disciplined more often. Too often, they are taught by educators who do not look like them or share their lived experiences. Until recently, they were often taught lessons from curricula that did not acknowledge the contributions of Black people or celebrate their excellence. As a society, we face historical, structural, and systemic obstacles to unlocking our Black students' potential.

Thankfully, we have a community that is committed to the work. In 2020, 75% of voters endorsed the Center when they voted for our most recent school modernization bond. Since the visioning work began, hundreds of stakeholders – especially from Portland's Black community – have dedicated time and energy to produce this document you are reading. These people and organizations will now join with others in standing up this transformative program. We are incredibly blessed to begin this project with this level of support.

Fortified with this support, a clear vision, and strong sense of best practices, Portland Public Schools is proud to offer this plan to our Board, our students, and our community.

In community,

**Guadalupe Guerrero**
Superintendent of Portland Public Schools

**Dr. Cheryl Proctor**
Deputy Superintendent of Instruction & School Communities
Executive Sponsor, Center for Black Student Excellence

AND DOWNTOWN
FRONT

# 02.
# CBSE VISION

- **Summary**
  - A Place
  - An Approach
  - A Redesign of the System
  - PPS RESJ Theory of Action
  - Graduate Portrait
  - Forward Together
    - Themes
    - Strategic Outcomes
- **Design Fiction**
  "A Day in the Life of" - Our Personas

# SUMMARY

A GRADUATE OF PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS WILL BE A COMPASSIONATE CRITICAL THINKER, ABLE TO COLLABORATE AND SOLVE PROBLEMS, AND BE PREPARED TO LEAD A MORE SOCIALLY JUST WORLD.

The Center for Black Student Excellence comprises a PLACE, AN APPROACH, and a REDESIGN of Portland Public Schools to ensure aligned coordination of efforts so that every Black student succeeds. **Undergirded by Black scholarly research, community advocacy, identity, culture, and belonging, students fundamentally experience school differently and are embedded within an ecosystem of care.** Outcomes improve exponentially and Black students have a plan for their path beyond graduation, as illuminated in the graduate portrait:

## A GRADUATE OF PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS WILL BE A COMPASSIONATE CRITICAL THINKER, ABLE TO COLLABORATE AND SOLVE PROBLEMS, AND BE PREPARED TO LEAD A MORE SOCIALLY JUST WORLD.

Community violence has reduced with the return of collectivism and community building. Portland's model becomes an exemplar on a national scale of the possibilities that emerge when the community and public education system work shoulder to shoulder to redefine the future for Black students.

**Black student excellence** is defined as student efficacy, connection to the community and knowledge of oneself, mastery of foundational concepts, and perseverance in the learning experience. In addition to core academics, students demonstrate confidence and the skillful ability to share boldly on topics of interest. **They recognize that their excellence is innate**, and they reclaim their own cultural narratives. Joy is visibly present as students cultivate a practice of healing even on days they don't feel their best. This is inclusive of all students in the African diaspora regardless of linguistic, ethnic, or experiential diversity.

KING

# A PLACE

Students, staff, and community members have a dedicated place to experience Black joy and healing. The infrastructure serves as a resource hub of programs, aid, and multi-use spaces as students gather for affinity, staff gather for professional development, and community members gather to facilitate honest discussions. The resources of the space extend digitally for families who've been displaced and for accessibility.

# AN APPROACH

The standard of excellence is exemplified through measurable outcomes across student, staff, and partner groups. Student leadership development opportunities and self-efficacy are encouraged and supported through peer and intergenerational mentorship. Students have consistency in the PK-12 educational experience that results in high achievement. Students with various developmental and social needs are adequately seen and resourced, including LGBTQIA2S+ students, and students with disabilities.

Educators with proven track records of success are celebrated, and managed risk taking is supported. All educators continue to refine their practice and are supported with the necessary professional learning. **Black staff retention has increased because the environment has shifted to support their health, safety, growth, and development.**

Families and caregivers are leveraged for their expertise and coached to navigate the system including non-Black parents of Black children. Schools become a place for continuous learning for honest local histories as new families move to the area. Non-Black families are allies in the pursuit of Black student excellence.

# A SYSTEM REDESIGN

The system redesign is rooted in redistribution of power from silos to community networks, processes of competition to collaboration, transparency, and accountability. A new educational pathway is formed in historic Albina including Jefferson High School, Harriet Tubman Middle School, KairosPDX, Martin Luther King Elementary, Boise-Eliot Humboldt Elementary and displaced families. The strategies of the Center for Black Student Excellence scale to ensure that Black students across Portland Public Schools are seen, valued, and held to high standards.

At the district level, efforts are coordinated to ensure high-quality delivery of service to schools and communication is clear, consistent, and reliable. Teams meaningfully collaborate so that efforts are not duplicated. And through repeated behavior change, PPS cultivates opportunities for communal healing.

Community leaders and organizations contribute to a tightly woven network of educators, service providers, community members and entities working in coordination for the benefit of Black students. In the system redesign, every member of the community feels a sense of shared responsibility for the outcomes of Black students, and the organization has established accountability measures to reflect progress.

THE
ALL-STAR
AWARDS
CEREMONY

# PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS STRATEGIC PLAN THEORY OF ACTION:

**IF... WE BRAID RACIAL EQUITY AND SOCIAL JUSTICE STRATEGIES INTO OUR INSTRUCTIONAL CORE, WORK WITH OUR STUDENTS, TEACHERS, AND CONTENT, AND BUILD OUR ORGANIZATIONAL CULTURE AND CAPACITY TO CREATE A STRONG FOUNDATION TO SUPPORT EVERY STUDENT...**

**THEN... WE WILL REIMAGINE PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS TO ENSURE EVERY STUDENT, ESPECIALLY OUR BLACK AND NATIVE AMERICAN STUDENTS WHO EXPERIENCE THE GREATEST BARRIERS, REALIZE THE VISION OF THE GRADUATE PORTRAIT.**

As Portland Public Schools in partnership with Black students, partners and community members move towards implementing the vision of the Center for Black Student Excellence, it is important for the organization to rely on the most impactful levers for change which includes coordinated and thoughtful implementation of Forward Together, PPS' strategic plan with a specific lens on Black students. While Forward Together doesn't, in its entirety, express the desires of the community, it serves as one lever of systemwide accountability. Forward Together is organized into four major themes that have been identified as areas of focus, aimed at producing meaningful outcomes.

# FORWARD TOGETHER THEMES

## Racial Equity and Social Justice

Cultivate a Culture of Racial Equity and Care

Reimagine Relationships and a Sense of Belonging

Plan the Center for Black Student Excellence

Ensure Equitable Access to Facility Resources

## Inclusive and Differentiated Learning for Every Child

Develop an Integrated Instructional Framework

Design Learning Experiences that Promote Self-Directed, Future-Ready Learning

## Professional Excellence and Support

Develop a Diverse, High-Quality, and Thriving Workforce

## Embracing Change

Build a Collective Sense of Trust and Belonging

Embed System-Wide Data-Driven Continuous Improvement Practices

Implement a Proactive, Effective, and Creative Communication Practice

Cultivate and Promote Aligned Community Partnerships

Develop a Coherent System-Wide Community Engagement Approach

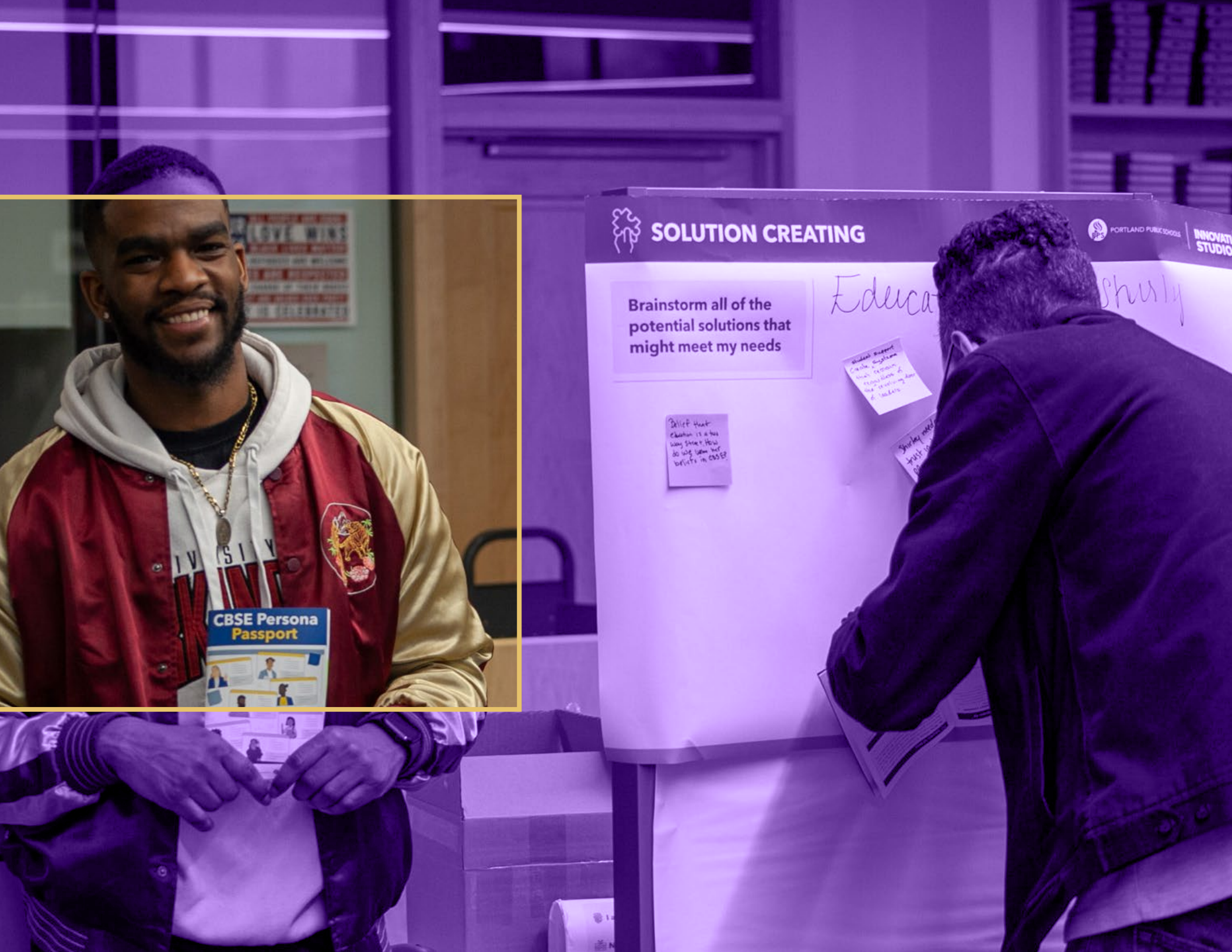
# DESIGN FICTION

Design fiction is a practice that allows designers to imagine what the future could look like.

Personas help designers to create understanding and empathy with the end-users. **Personas are fictional characters that represent the needs of a larger group.**

Each of the attributes of the personas are representative of students, families, staff, and partners that we became familiar with throughout the design process.

As we vision to the future of a fully realized, Center for Black Student Excellence, read about how it could manifest in these short design fiction stories.


SOLUTION CREATING
Brainstorm all of the potential solutions that might meet my needs
CBSE Persona Passport

## PK STUDENT
## ADAM SIMMS

### Day in the Life

Adam, age 4, is an African American boy who lived with both parents until his mother passed away from cancer. He now lives with his grandmother and his father, who struggles with substance abuse and works long hours for low wages. Their family is rooted in Northeast Portland, where his great-grandfather founded a Black church. In his Afrocentric preschool classroom, Adam is encouraged to play and learn by doing because he largely communicates with his body language. After school, his grandmother takes him to the CBSE, where Adam has access to a speech pathologist, academic support, and family trauma-informed counseling. Adam's father attends parenting classes and also has an assigned grief and addiction counselor whom he meets with regularly. The CBSE provides the family with nourishing meals and upskilling classes so his father can pursue higher-paying employment.

## K-5 STUDENT
## FADUMA HASSAN

### Day in the Life

Faduma, age 8, is a fourth-grade immigrant student at Dr. Martin Luther King Elementary School. She is from  a populous coastal community in Somalia with a  trading port, and English is her second language. As her original language is oral and not written, Faduma often serves as the translator between school and home. School staff immediately noticed her social and leadership qualities, as she is lively, creative and thrives in art and math. Her parents want her to become a doctor. She is still trying to make sense of American culture. The Hassan family now meets regularly with a translator who talks about the immigrant support services, events and programs through PPS and the CBSE. This means Faduma no longer needs to be the sole translator between her school and her family. Faduma's parents are now aware of all school activities and Faduma is able to connect with culturally specific resources from the CBSE like its art and history lessons.

## 6-8 STUDENT
## NICO THOMAS

### Day in the Life

Nico, whose country of birth is Ethiopia, is a 13-year-old transgender 7th grader who was adopted into a white family. They are an only child with supportive parents. However, Nico has experienced negative encounters at school, so they disengage often. They are more interested in cultural learning than traditional classes and are connected to the queer affinity group on campus. Nico's parents use the CBSE website to find learning opportunities for them to better support Nico in their Blackness. Additionally, Nico's parents contact PPS' Civil Rights Office to investigate Nico's experience at school. They swiftly respond in a timely fashion. By the following quarter, Nico and the other students have undergone peer mediation and their experience has shifted completely.

## 9-12 STUDENT (SPED)
## JAMAL BAPTISTE

### Day in the Life

Jamal, age 14, is an African-American boy. He has had a difficult adjustment to Portland after his family moved from Louisiana, where he was accustomed to seeing more students and educators of color. His college-educated parents suspect their child has undiagnosed PTSD, depression and anxiety, and the family hasn't yet settled into finding a Catholic church. Jamal does well in sports, music and after-school robotics club. He has had regular discussions with his counselor about transitioning to his new school. His counselor has met with him weekly at school to inquire about his school transition and has informed his family of all of the services that are available to them like rental assistance and Individualized Education Plan (IEP) assessments. By the end of the year, Jamal's counselor and family have collaboratively worked together to support Jamal to discover his academic and social spark.

## FAMILY #1
## CAMREN AND CHRIS JOHNSON

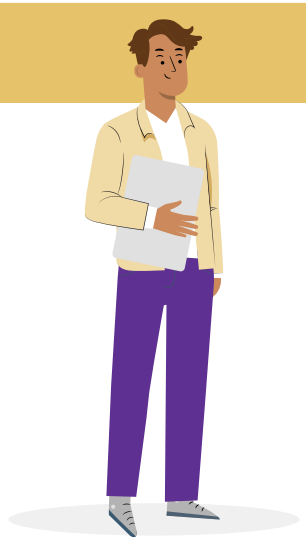
### Day in the Life

Camren and Chris, a financially secure older couple with children, are white transplants from California to Portland. They had a longstanding corporate career where they moved to various locations throughout North America and Southeast Asia. They just purchased a new home within the Albina neighborhood in inner-North Portland without knowing much of the local history. They prefer to be considered liberals, but have had minimal engagement with the Black community. They are excited to get involved in the educational community through their philanthropy and volunteerism. After learning about the Center for Black Student Excellence (CBSE), they are finding several ways to participate in community discussions and engagements. The CBSE has several entry points for them to learn about the history of the Albina neighborhood and the value of the phrase "When Black children are well, all children are well."

## FAMILY #2
## JENNIFER AND JAMES JACKSON

### Day in the Life

James and Jennifer, both in their late 30s, are Jefferson High School graduates who live in the Parkrose neighborhood in East Multnomah County, but their church community is in Albina, where they grew up. They were priced out of their neighborhood after three generations. But because of PPS' Right to Return agreement, their daughter Janet, a 4th grader, attends Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. Elementary School; Jasper, is an 8th grader at Harriet Tubman Middle School; and Jaiden is an 11th grader at Jefferson High School. With a single family car, they appreciate the Parkrose bus route which picks up and drops off their students for school. The CBSE has been a place where the Jackson Family can learn more about what is going on in the community even though they have been forced to leave the neighborhood.



## EDUCATOR #1
## ARMANDO PEREZ-SMITH

### Day in the Life

Mr. Perez, age 27, is a fifth-grade educator at Boise Eliot/Humboldt Elementary, and he is early in his teaching career. He is a bilingual, first-generation college graduate who wants to leave an impact on the next generation, especially as he remembers the challenges he faced growing up. He wants to leave an impact on the next generation of students and make his immigrant parents proud. Because Perez-Smith is a native Spanish speaker, he has been vital to speaking with families whose primary language is Spanish. He participates in the Parent Teacher Home Visits (PTHV) program to learn more about the cultures of Boise-Eliot/Humboldt's Black families to better support their students in school. With regular professional development, Perez is becoming a stronger educator.

## EDUCATOR #2
## MRS. SHIRLEY JOHNSON

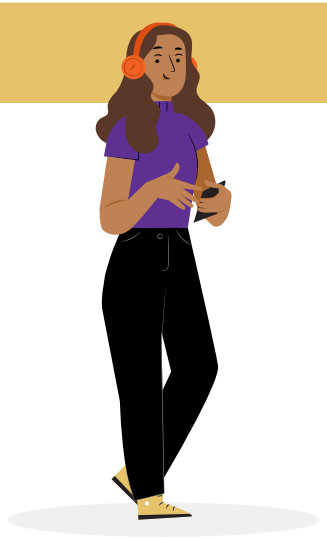
### Day in the Life

Mrs. Shirley, age 57, is an African American, veteran educator at Jefferson High School, and provides a classroom where students are drawn to her before and after school. She has high expectations of her students and ensures each of her students graduate with a post-secondary plan. She lives in the Albina neighborhood and is a parent of three children. She is a 4th generation Portlander and NAACP member. As a multi-award winning educator, she receives an annual stipend to support newer educators in learning culturally responsive pedagogy. On her weekends, she visits the CBSE to mentor students who adore the compassion and love she holds.

## COMMUNITY BASED ORGANIZATION #1
**ROBERT DIXON**

### Day in the Life

Robert, age 43, leads a staff of mostly native Portlanders who provide culturally specific empowerment programming. Robert has several opportunities to meet with the team overseeing contracts before the Request for Proposals are due. Staff provide Robert with clear guidance and technical assistance to make his submission process simple. As a partner, Robert and his staff are seen as essential to the fabric of the district. His organization advocates for more parent involvement. In collaboration with the Office of Technology and Information Services (OTIS) and the CBSE, Robert's organization teaches Black families how to better support their students in a rapidly changing technology world.



## COMMUNITY BASED ORGANIZATION #2
**CHI PATTERSON**

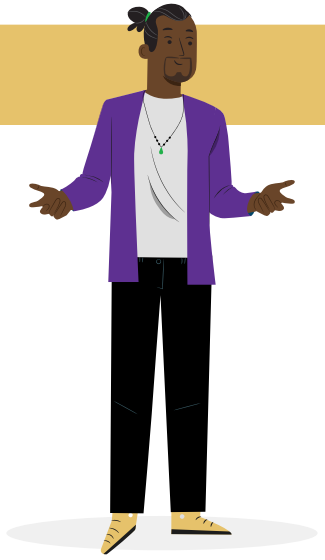
### Day in the Life

Chi, age 24, is a bi-racial, culturally specific service provider working within Harriet Tubman Middle School whose passion is to support students. Because she "sees no color," she struggles to relate to the students of color demographic, as she defaults to supremacy culture, having been raised by a white mother and Black father. She likes her job, and a new metric for evaluating program success now allows her to hold students to a high standard with clear outcomes. In training at her site, she is finding new ways to stop the spread of intraracial harm between her and the Black students she works with. She has grown her anti-racist reading list from the suggestions in the weekly CBSE newsletter.

## HEALING - MENTAL HEALTH PRACTITIONER #1
**DR. QUANDRAE O'NEIL**

### Day in the Life

Dr. O'Neil, age 40, is a bi-racial, married, highly educated counselor. While he grew up in dominant culture, he is heavily influenced by Black scholars such as Cornel West and Bob Moses. O'Neil has a doctorate from Harvard, specializing in middle-school education. He balances between wielding his credentials and genuine connection with students, as his upper middle class background created some distance between him and his students. He understands that children are inherently brilliant, but trauma is happening everyday. He leverages the CBSE to provide mental health services such as private offices and communal healing spaces. His office has posters of influential Black leaders, law makers, journalists, thinkers, athletes, and activities that students can look up to.



## HEALING - MENTAL HEALTH PRACTITIONER #2
**JON KAMERY**

### Day in the Life

Jon, age 38, is a native Portlander who spent many years in the metro D.C. area before returning to Portland to help take care of an elderly family member. As an HBCU alumnus, he prides himself on being intuitive as a holistic health-school psychologist. He teaches trauma-informed yoga, breathing techniques, and martial arts as a form of discipline and introspection, as he deeply understands how trauma affects the body. He is a father figure to everyone, especially Black boys. Jon's children attend school in Southeast Portland. Jon works from the drop in offices at the CBSE between his school visits. After years of advocating for students, he has the full support of teachers and staff as they have been informed of the importance of mental health resources for Black students.

# 03.
# PLACE

- **Summary**
  - Design Justice
  - Type of Infrastructure
- **Community Narratives**
- **Place Types**
- **Resources Mapping**

In collaboration with

COLLOQATE

IMAGINE BLACK FUTURES

# SUMMARY

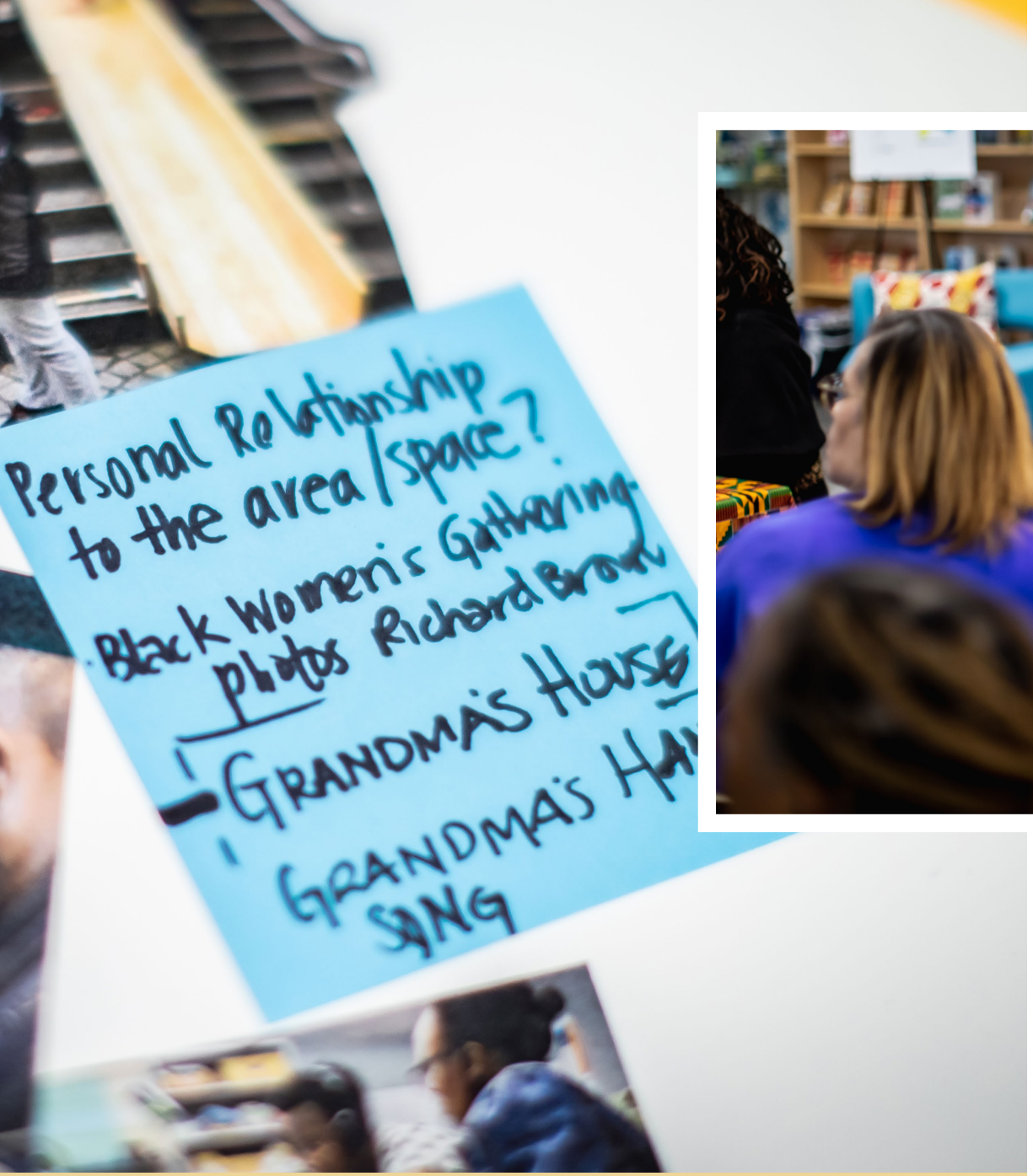
Place refers to how the Center for Black Student Excellence **is designed in response to student, staff, and community-identified priorities.**

love
Romance
dating
emotions
#BLACK EXCELLENCE
Kassaerian Ingerd
And now are the children

# DESIGN JUSTICE

To design is to have an unyielding faith in the potential for a just society. It is an act of individual and collective hope that has the potential to express collective values and amplify community power through the processes and outcomes of design. However, historically, the design profession has excluded justice and equity as part of the design process and has further marginalized the very groups who are most apt to name their own needs.

Making design decisions through the lens of Design Justice necessitates evaluating not only physical school spaces, but also the systems which define how a space is able to function.



# TYPE OF INFRASTRUCTURE

The Center for Black Student Excellence will serve as a central hub with spatial components embedded in schools and accompanied by a digital infrastructure. Space types are rooted in community narratives.

# COMMUNITY NARRATIVES

THROUGH COLLECTIVE ACTION AND TRANSFORMATIVE RELATIONSHIPS, WE CAN CHALLENGE OPPRESSIVE SYSTEMS, HEAL INTERGENERATIONAL WOUNDS, AND BUILD A RESILIENT AND THRIVING COMMUNITY.

# HEALING JUSTICE AND COMMUNITYCARE

## Healing Justice: Definition

Healing Justice is a framework seeking to intervene in generational trauma and to build collective power toward our resistance and collective survival (Hayes, 2023). The concept of Healing Justice centers around intervening in generational trauma and cultivating collective power as a means of resistance and collective survival. It challenges societal norms and calls for a fundamental shift in how we engage in interpersonal relationships, empowering ordinary individuals to forge collective approaches to healing, support, interventions, accountability, and transformation.

At its core, Healing Justice prompts a reevaluation of organizational dynamics, emphasizing the importance of self-care and healing practices within collective groups. It recognizes that individual well-being is intricately linked to the well-being of the community. Moreover, it demands a cultural shift within systemic oppression and institutions, tackling the root causes of harm and violence by transforming the social conditions and institutions that perpetuate or support such harm within the Black community.

By embracing the principles of Healing Justice, we can foster a nurturing environment that uplifts the Center for Black Student Excellence and supports the holistic well-being and empowerment of Black individuals. Through collective action and transformative relationships, we can challenge oppressive systems, heal intergenerational wounds, and build a resilient and thriving community.

# SAFETY

## Safety: Definition

This narrative includes both safety and security. The fostering of a safe and secure environment involves prioritizing both safety and security. Safety entails creating a sense of security and reducing incidents of physical and emotional harm, including public health concerns. Security measures refer to access control and procedures that are put in place for the safety of public professionals and staff. The sense of safety felt by a community is impacted by these security measures, which should also take into consideration the mental health and wellbeing of the community.

One crucial aspect of safety is dismantling the school-to-prison pipeline. This pipeline refers to policies and practices that disproportionately push Black youth out of schools and into the criminal justice system, often due to harsh discipline policies, biased policing, and inadequate educational resources.

# HOLISTIC SUPPORT

## Holistic Support: Definition

This narrative defines the need for wraparound support including care for families in order for those students to thrive academically. It moves the education system's responsibility beyond only academic outcomes.

# PATHWAYS TO SUCCESS

## Pathways to Success: Definition

This category considers the myriad of opportunities for learning that support students to thrive in life beyond secondary education.

# COLLABORATIVE ECOSYSTEM

## Collaborative Ecosystem: Definition

This narrative envisions a system and place where educators, organizations and individuals share resources and collaborate to maximize potential for serving Black Youth. It reflects the belief that **'we are stronger together'.**

The creation of a collaborative ecosystem includes coordinating and supporting existing resources and efforts, seeking a location that has synergy with other Black institutions, distributing ownership, sharing space, and removing barriers to access.

# FOSTERING BLACK JOY

## Black Joy: Definition

The experience of joy is both foundational to healing, and also the result of a healed, restored, and truly affirming place that would be created through success in achieving the goals of the other community narratives. Centering Blackness unapologetically creates an environment full of caring community and connection where students have the safety to play freely. This includes a celebration of Black art and culture.

# PLACE TYPES

VISUALIZING PLACES AT THE CENTER FOR BLACK STUDENT EXCELLENCE.

# AT THE CENTER FOR BLACK STUDENT EXCELLENCE THERE ARE...

# PLACES FOR PLAY

**To have culturally Black spaces of play is an investment into the health and happiness of the Black community as well as addressing the impacts of historic disinvestment.**

Spaces of play create joyful opportunities for rest, release, and restoration. Play is a critical part of considering a physical place for the Black community because there are very few places for Black youth to fully express themselves, play, and feel safe doing so.

## Correlating narratives:

- **Healing**
- **Safety**
- **Black Joy**

## Community-Identified Places for Play

- **Gymnasium**
- **Outdoor courts**
- **Fields Swimming Pool**
- **Gaming station / Arcade**
- **Youth kickback/ hangout Coffee shop**
- **Salon**
- **Bowling Alley**
- **Movie Theater**
- **Skating Rink Youth**
- **Park Playground**

## PRECEDENTS

# VISUALIZING WHAT A YOUTH KICKBACK MIGHT LOOK LIKE

## IMAGINE...

A large room with concrete floors has multiple areas where groups of young people are spending time together. The back left wall is black with 3 big paintings in vibrant colors, there is a glow strip of pink, blue and green along the wall base. Three groups of green chairs around yellow tables sit along this wall. The right wall is covered in a black and white geometric pattern. There are two vending machines with snacks and a large multicolored painting. In the middle of the room there is a wooden island with four half circle booths. At the front of the island is a green rug with couches, bean bags, low tables and youth playing video games. Along the front edge there are two wooden tables with green chairs. One table has a chess game on it, one has dominoes. The front corner has a smaller rug with bean bags, a person sitting and a person in a wheelchair talking.

**TYPICAL SQUARE FOOTAGES:**

**1,000 sf min**

**Gymnasium** **5,000-8,000 sf**

**Playgrounds** **75 sf per child**

**Auditorium** **4,600 sf min**
(highly variable depending on audience count and layout)

# AT THE CENTER FOR BLACK STUDENT EXCELLENCE THERE ARE...

# PLACES FOR COLLABORATION

**This narrative imagines a system and place where Community Based Organizations and individuals share resources and collaborate to maximize potential for serving Black Youth.** Desired solutions are embedded in values of Umoja and Ujamaa - Unity, Collective Work and Responsibility. It reflects the belief that 'we are stronger together'.

## Correlating narratives:

- **Healing**
- **Collaborative Ecosystem**
- **Pathways to Success**

## Community-Identified Places for Play

- **Hot-desks**
- **Conference rooms Huddle spaces**
- **Printing/Scanning room**
- **CBO Incubator Office spaces**
- **Bookable Event spaces**
- **Supply Library / Maker Space**
- **Storage**
- **Outreach van / Mobile truck**

## PRECEDENTS

# VISUALIZING WHAT A CBO CO-WORK MIGHT LOOK LIKE

## IMAGINE...

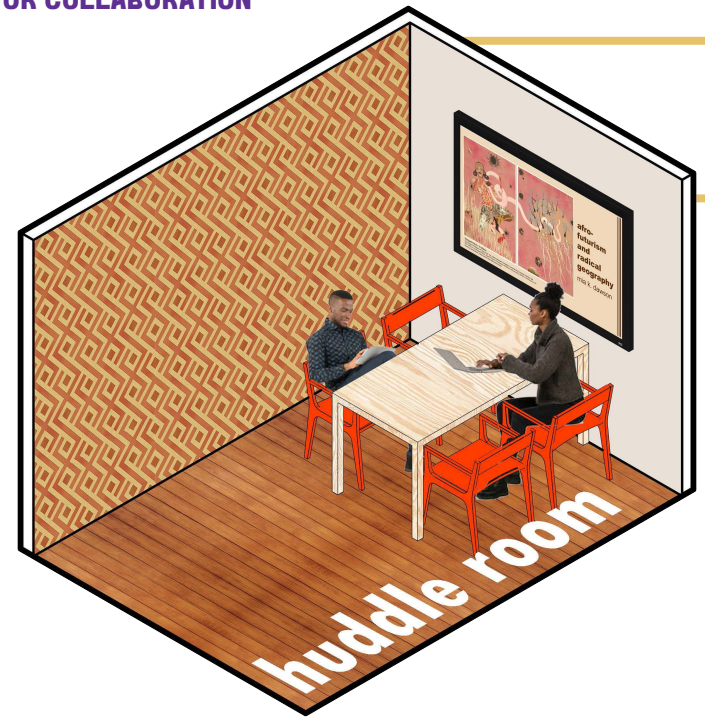
Groups of people work in different spaces within a large room. The room has gray concrete floors with two small breakout rooms on the right side, one with blue walls and one with dark reddish brown walls. Next to the breakout rooms is a supply area with printers and shelves of helpful items. There is a large leafy plant in a wooden pot next to the shelves. A large open space is in the middle with a long wooden table with bright orange chairs. The main wall has geometric patterns, a dry erase board and a cork board. There is also a group of comfortable yellow chairs around a low table sitting on a reddish brown rug. On the left side, there are four half walled work areas with textile patterns and wooden desks. Large leafy plants sit along the walls of the work areas.

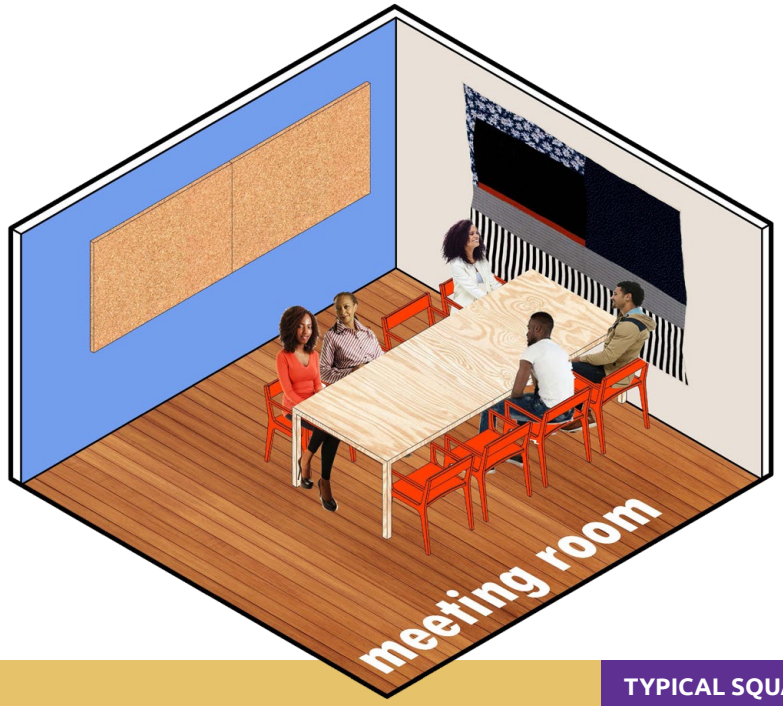
**TYPICAL SQUARE FOOTAGES:**

**100 sf per person**

**120-300 sf for print & supply area**

# SMALL HUDDLE & MEETING ROOMS




## IMAGINE...

Two small rooms with warm wood floors host small groups of people working together at wooden tables. One room has a bright blue wall on the left with cork boards. The right wall is cream colored with a black and white striped tapestry. The Text indicates this space as a meeting room. The second room is smaller with one patterned wall and one cream wall with a framed article on the wall.

**TYPICAL SQUARE FOOTAGES:**

**Huddle 70 to 140 sf;**

**Meeting Room**
**120 sf small**
**220 sf medium**
**550 sf large**

## VISUALIZING WHAT A CLASSROOM MIGHT LOOK LIKE

## IMAGINE...

A large open room with warm wooden floors. There is a u-shaped configuration of wooden tables with bright orange chairs. People sit around the table looking at a projected image of a woman on a pink background holding up her fist. The wall is burgundy. The other wall is a light cream color with pinned up diagrams, a cork-board, and a dry erase board.

**TYPICAL SQUARE FOOTAGES:**

**900 to 1,500 sf**

# AT THE CENTER FOR BLACK STUDENT EXCELLENCE THERE ARE...

# PLACES FOR GATHERING

**At the heart of healing, teaching, and joy within the Black community are events that bring folks together in community.** Gathering becomes more than recreational, in these spaces are where elders share stories, mothers pass down generational recipes to their daughters, and youth discover a network of support that they can rely on.

## Correlating narratives:

- Healing
- Collaborative Ecosystem
- Pathways to Success
- Black Joy

## Community-Identified Places for Play

- **Front Porch**
- **Kitchen**
- **Backyard**
- **Large flexible room**
- **Dining Room**

## PRECEDENTS

# VISUALIZING WHAT A COMMUNITY KITCHEN MIGHT LOOK LIKE

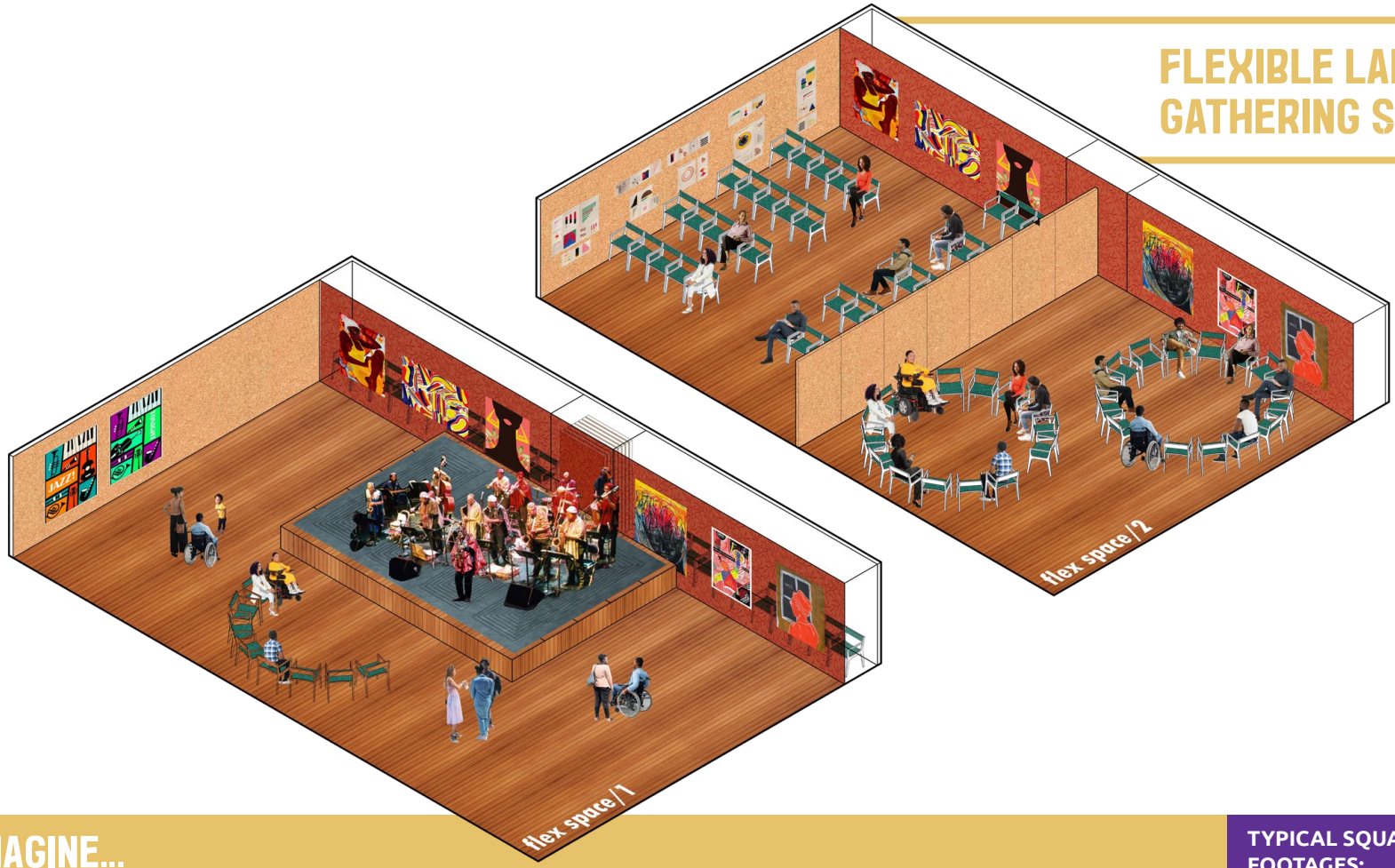
## IMAGINE...

A long room with concrete floors have a kitchenette along one wall, an island, a dining table with orange chairs, then cabinets and a shelf with potted herbs. The cabinetry has a bold black and white geometric pattern, the counter tops are light wood. There is black tile behind the kitchenette with herbs hanging to dry. The right wall is a light pink with four bold paintings of African baskets.

**TYPICAL SQUARE FOOTAGES:**

**500 sf min**

# FLEXIBLE LARGE GATHERING SPACE



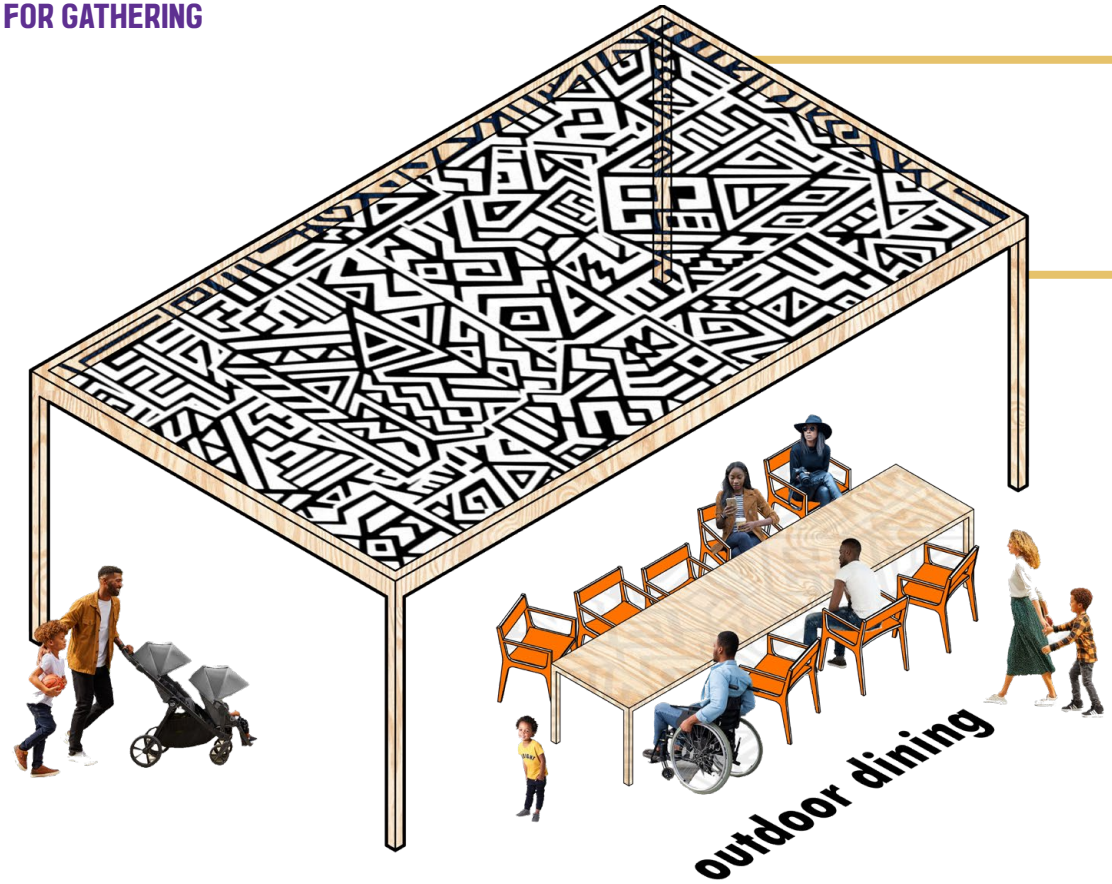

## IMAGINE...

A large common space for gathering and activities has floors of warm wood. The left wall is covered in cork-board, the right wall has a red floral pattern with local Black art on the wall. The red wall conceals storage for chairs and a deployable divider wall. When the divider wall is in place, two events can happen at the same time. When the wall is put away, a stage can be assembled for events such as dance or a jazz band playing while people gather to watch.

**TYPICAL SQUARE FOOTAGES:**

**1,200sf to 5,000sf**

# VISUALIZING WHAT A PORCH MIGHT LOOK LIKE




## IMAGINE...

A shade structure made of wood with a black African pattern casts a patterned shadow on the ground and over a long wood table with bright orange chairs that are disorganized as if people just got up from a long dinner. There are three people still sitting, one person at the table is in a wheelchair. There is a little child standing, while a mother and her child walk to the table, and a father pushing a stroller and a child walk to the table from the other side.

**TYPICAL SQUARE FOOTAGES:**

**300 sf min**

# AT THE CENTER FOR BLACK STUDENT EXCELLENCE THERE ARE...
# PLACES FOR CARE

**By embracing the principles of Healing Justice, we can foster a nurturing environment that uplifts the Center for Black Student Excellence and supports the holistic well-being and empowerment of Black individuals.** Care considers the needs of students AND their families. Academic success is impacted by the basic needs and family life of a student.

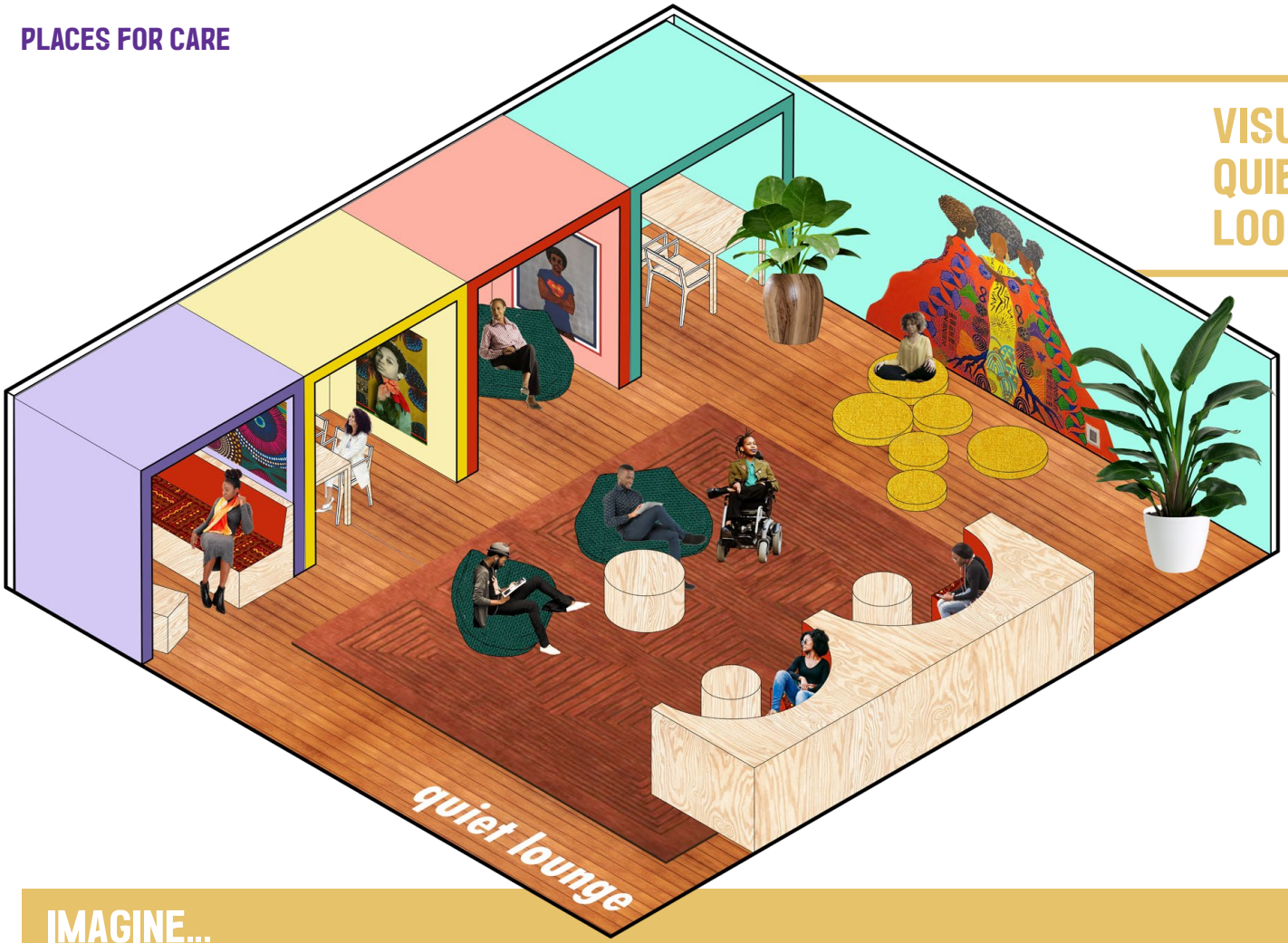
## Correlating narratives:

- Healing
- Collaborative Ecosystem
- Pathways to Success
- Black Joy

## Community-Identified Places for Play

- Dining Room
- Quiet spaces
- Spaces to be loud and play
- Gardens
- Free pantry (food)
- Free pantry (clothes)
- Laundry
- Childcare/ parent support Teacher
- support rooms

## PRECEDENTS




# VISUALIZING WHAT A QUIET LOUNGE MIGHT LOOK LIKE

## IMAGINE...

A large room with warm wooden floors has four smaller rooms on the right side and soft seating in the middle on a large reddish brown rug. There are wooden booths on the closest edge of the room, facing the soft seating. People lounge on the seats and a person in a wheelchair is next to the person on a beanbag. The small rooms are different colors, one is purple, one is yellow, one is red, and one is green. Each room shows people doing different activities such as sitting on a green bean bag, sitting at a desk, and sitting on a comfortable bench. The right wall is painted green with a mural of three women in patterned robes holding each other. A woman sits cross legged on round yellow pillows in front of the mural. A big leafy potted plant is on either side.

**TYPICAL SQUARE FOOTAGES:**

**700 sf min**

**Quiet Room: 100 sf min;**

**Focus room: 50 sf min;**

**Prayer / Meditation: 100 sf min**

## CHILDCARE / PARENT SUPPORT

## URBAN GARDEN

### IMAGINE...

An outdoor space with a greenhouse and storage room with murals on the door; garden beds are on the right side. The perimeter garden is growing apples, oranges, tomatoes, and basil. The four interior garden beds are sprouting leafy greens. A little girl and younger child stand and gather greens with a girl in a motorized chair. A man tends to the sprouts. A person with a bicycle talks to a person in a long yellow dress near the greenhouse.

### IMAGINE...

An intimate room with warm wooden floors and a large yellow rug. A child stands smiling on blue and green play blocks. In the back corner is a round rug with colored squares along the edge. Young children sit in the squares while an adult reads from a book. The left wall has a blue, teal, and green mural of a geometric woman reaching down to touch a child's face. The right wall is green and has two large windows with blue curtains.

**TYPICAL SQUARE FOOTAGES: GARDEN**

**400 sf min**

**TYPICAL SQUARE FOOTAGES: CHILDCARE**

**50 sf per child min**

Lactation / Nursing Room: **75-85 sf**

## VISUALIZING WHAT A FREE STORE MIGHT LOOK LIKE

## IMAGINE...

A bustling room with concrete floors and a u-shaped wooden counter in the middle. The counter has baskets of produce and baskets with home items on it, and a person stands behind the counter. A large leafy potted plant is on both sides. A father pushing a stroller and a child walk by the counter. A mother and her child holding a basket walk towards two refrigerators. Next to the refrigerators are wooden shelves filled with produce. On the right side of the counter are clothing racks and a large shelf filled with folded clothes. The back wall has a bright orange and flower pattern with a neon sign with the words food and clothes separated by an infinity symbol.

**TYPICAL SQUARE FOOTAGES:**

**600 to 4,000 sf**

# AT THE CENTER FOR BLACK STUDENT EXCELLENCE THERE ARE...

# PLACES FOR RESEARCH

**Grounding the Center for Black Student Excellence in Black scholarly research includes providing access to Black scholarly research and histories while being able to discuss together on new research.** An archival space for Black research should not be stuffy or off- limits; this should be a space should redefine "archive," be vibrant, and encourage interactive multi-media learning.

## Correlating narratives:

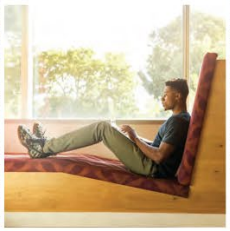
**Healing**

**Collaborative Ecosystem**

## Community-Identified Places for Play

- **Archive**
- **Mentorships**
- **Library**
- **Travel**
- **Outdoors**

## PRECEDENTS



# VISUALIZING WHAT A CULTURAL ARCHIVE MIGHT LOOK LIKE

## IMAGINE...

A large room with warm wooden floors has large wooden bookshelves along the left side. There is a central aisle with two long wooden tables and chairs sitting on reddish brown rugs. To the right of the tables are three concrete display blocks. The furthest back block has a sculpture of a head, the middle block has a tall sculpture of a person with feathers coming from their shoulders, the closest block has woven baskets on display. To the far right of the room are two small display rooms. Next to the small rooms is a wall with three paintings by Black artists. Two big leafy plants sit on either side of the paintings. The back wall is a dark warm brown with a quilt hung up and the right wall is a bright pink. Small groups of people using the different spaces through the room.

**TYPICAL SQUARE FOOTAGES:**

**1,000 sf min**

# AT THE CENTER FOR BLACK STUDENT EXCELLENCE THERE ARE...
# PLACES FOR CELEBRATION

**Black students are excellent and that excellence should be celebrated! Throughout the Center for Black Student Excellence and schools there should be ways to celebrate and display that excellence.** This Cultural Museum is not fragile or off-limits, but should be hands on and welcoming for all ages.

## Correlating narratives:

## Community-Identified Places for Play

- **Museum**
- **Art showcase Outdoor gathering**
- **Spatial Aesthetics**
- **Presence of Black art**
- **Music by Black artists**

## PRECEDENTS

# VISUALIZING WHAT AN EXHIBITION SPACE MIGHT LOOK LIKE

## IMAGINE...

A large room with warm wooden floors has three full height bi-fold art display panels on either side of the room. On each wing of the panels are large images of regional art by Black artists. In the middle of the room are six concrete display blocks, each with an artifact covered by a clear case. On the far wall are six wooden sculptures, each with a orange light creating a back glow. People are scattered throughout the room looking at the artifacts.

**TYPICAL SQUARE FOOTAGES:**

**700 sf min**

# AT THE CENTER FOR BLACK STUDENT EXCELLENCE THERE ARE...
# PLACES FOR INNOVATION

**Black culture is historically one of innovation, entrepreneurship, and resilience.** CBSE should provide an educational environment where students can explore and innovate through experiential and hands-on learning opportunities while being encouraged to discover a path that they can be excited about is foundational to celebrating innate excellence.

## Correlating narratives:

**Healing**

**Pathways to Success**

## Community-Identified Places for Play

- **Dance room**
- **Makerspace and STEAM lab**
- **Accessible transportation**
- **Computer lab**
- **Youth employment center**
- **On-site coffee shop**
- **Kitchen**
- **Sound recording room**
- **Music room**

## PRECEDENTS

# VISUALIZING WHAT A MAKER-SPACE MIGHT LOOK LIKE

## IMAGINE...

A large space with concrete floors and bright multi-colored walls with neon signage that says “the future is yours to create.” There are four large wood tables with black metal legs where people are doing different activities. At the back set of tables, one person is cutting wood and two people are putting models together. At the front set of worktables, one person is looking at circuit boards, one person sits at a laptop and another person has an experiment with a solar panel and water and wires. Two smaller tables with purple chairs have people doing ceramics and painting.

**TYPICAL SQUARE FOOTAGES:**

**60 sf per student min**

Green Screen Studio
**500sf min**

Sound Recording Room
**150 sf**

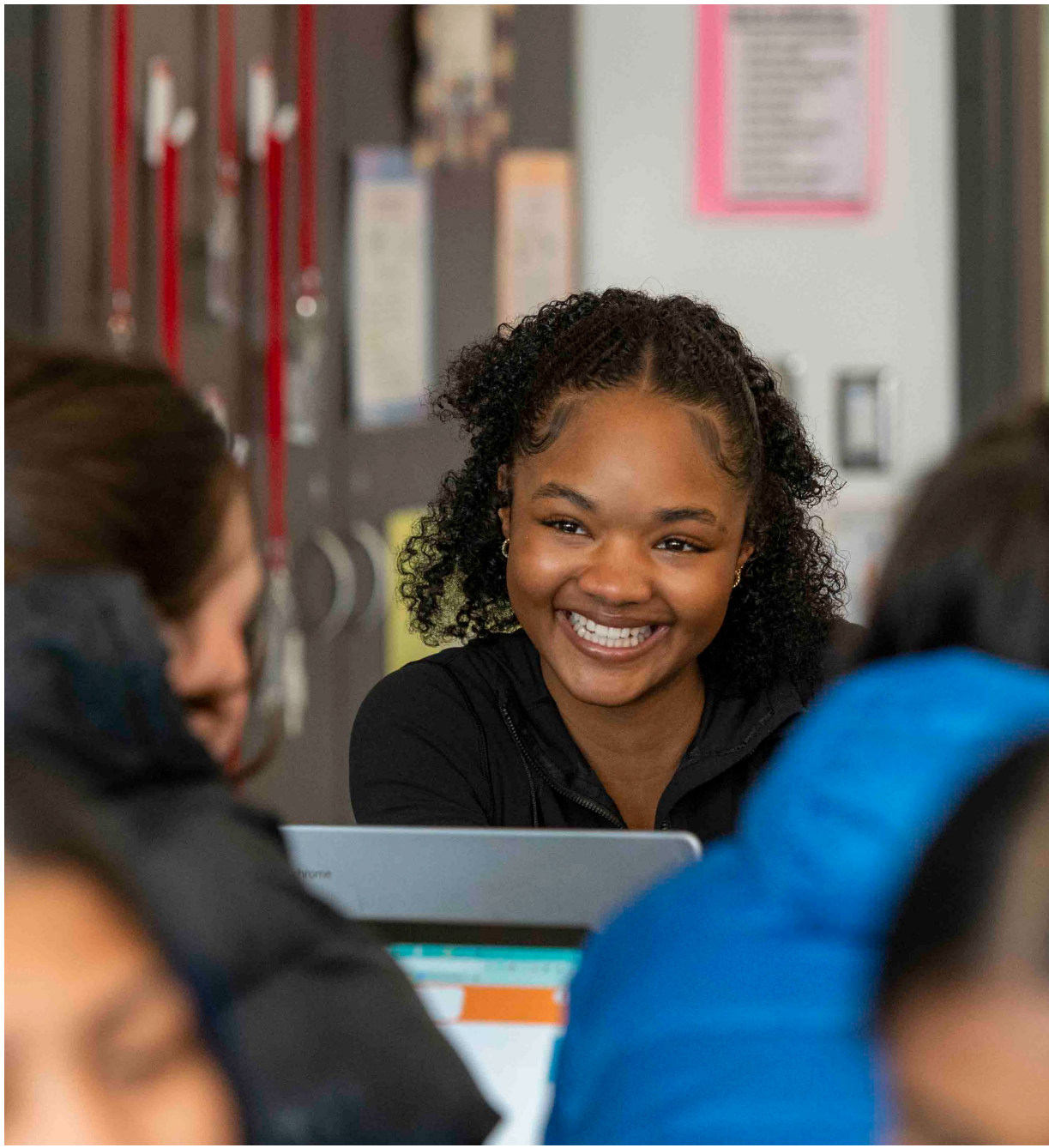
Computer Room
**35 sf per seat min**

# HOW MUCH PROGRAM SPACE IS POSSIBLE?

**$60 Million dollars of bond funding** have been allocated towards Capital Project costs for the CBSE. This includes both hard construction costs as well as the soft costs that go towards design and engineering fees, project management, administration, contingency, equipment, permitting and testing.

## IT WILL LIKELY NOT BE POSSIBLE FOR EVERY TYPE OF SPACE DESIRED TO BE AFFORDED WITHIN THE CURRENT BUDGET.

The project will need to go through a "Programming" process to work with stakeholders to confirm priorities, strategize space use, and determine what spaces will be implemented in alignment with budget for the first build and any future builds.



## AN EXAMPLE:

**Often 30-35% of a building's capital project costs will go towards soft costs.** With multiple capital projects underway, PPS can work with a cost estimator and take a look at other projects for an idea of what this percentage might come out to. Be aware that CBSE will not be a typical school building and account for any particular costs that may arise from the coordination of more technical spaces and involvement of community members in design coordination.

**Using 30-35% of soft costs taken out of $60 Million for the moment, this might look like a $39 to $42 Million construction budget.** To understand how large of a building that might provide, this can be divided by a cost per square foot that reflects the quality of building and amenities desired.

**Other local and PPS projects can help to set a precedent for determining the desired cost per square foot starting point.** Are concrete floors and exposed ceilings comfortable or is a higher amount of interior finishes desired? How much wood and casework will be in the space? Will there be highly technical spaces like a theater or science lab or will spaces be simpler? Will the building be net zero and self-sustaining?

**Cost per square foot metrics will not stay stable.** Because of inflation, the cost per square foot will grow every year. In a typical stable construction market, this inflation rate could be predicted to stay within 5% annually, but we have seen up to 20% annual inflation in recent years. So an $800/sf building can become an $840/sf building with a year passing of time.

- **At $700/sf this could be a 55,700-60,000 sf building.**
- **At $800/sf this could be a 48,750-52,500 sf building.**
- **At $900/sf this could be a 43,300-46,600 sf building.**

Storage, mechanical, electrical, IT, plumbing, corridors, and walls can account for 30% of a building in civic buildings, but would be less of the floor area for something like an office.

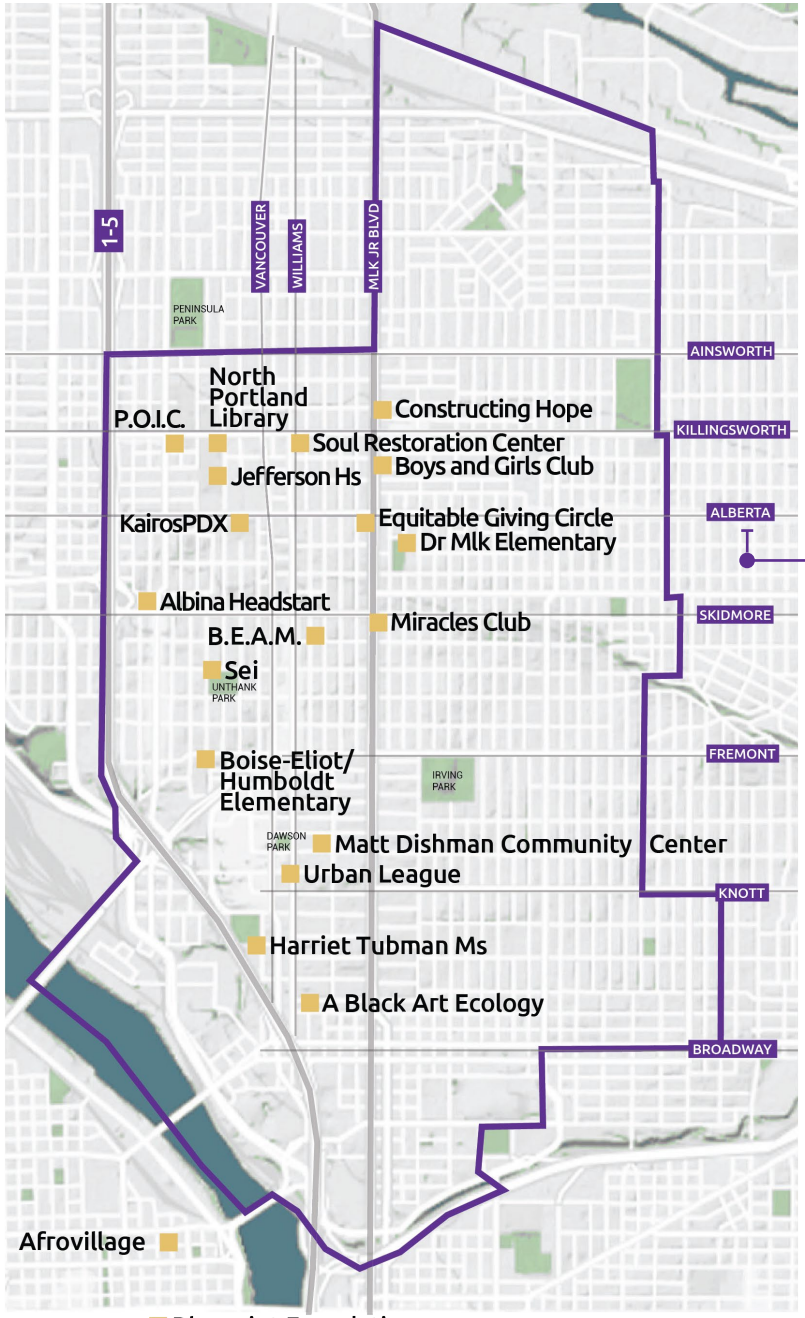
- **At 55,700 sf this might leave 38,990 sf for programmed spaces.**
- **At 48,750 sf this might leave 34,125 sf for programmed spaces.**
- **At 43,300 sf this might leave 30,310 for programmed spaces.**

**This is an example rather than a real project cost estimate. All costs should be determined for the particular project conditions by a construction cost estimator and/or contractor.**

# RESOURCES MAPPING

## A COLLABORATIVE ECOSYSTEM

# ORGANIZATIONS
# SERVING BLACK YOUTH




### No Physical Address

- Brown Girl Rise
- Iurban Teen
- Race Talks
- Project Pipeline
- Holla Mentors
- Tomorrow's Journey
- Unify Portland
- Black Male Achievement

### Black United Fund

- World Stage Theatre
- Coalition Of Black Men
- Camp Elso

### East Portland:

- Elevate Oregon
- Black Community Of Portland
- Africa House
- A Y C O
- Y.O.U.T.H. PDX
- Mudbone Grown
- P.O.I.C.
- REAP
- Building Blocks 2 Success
- Derose Community Bridge
- Inner City Basketball

### South-East Portland:

- Black Futures Farm

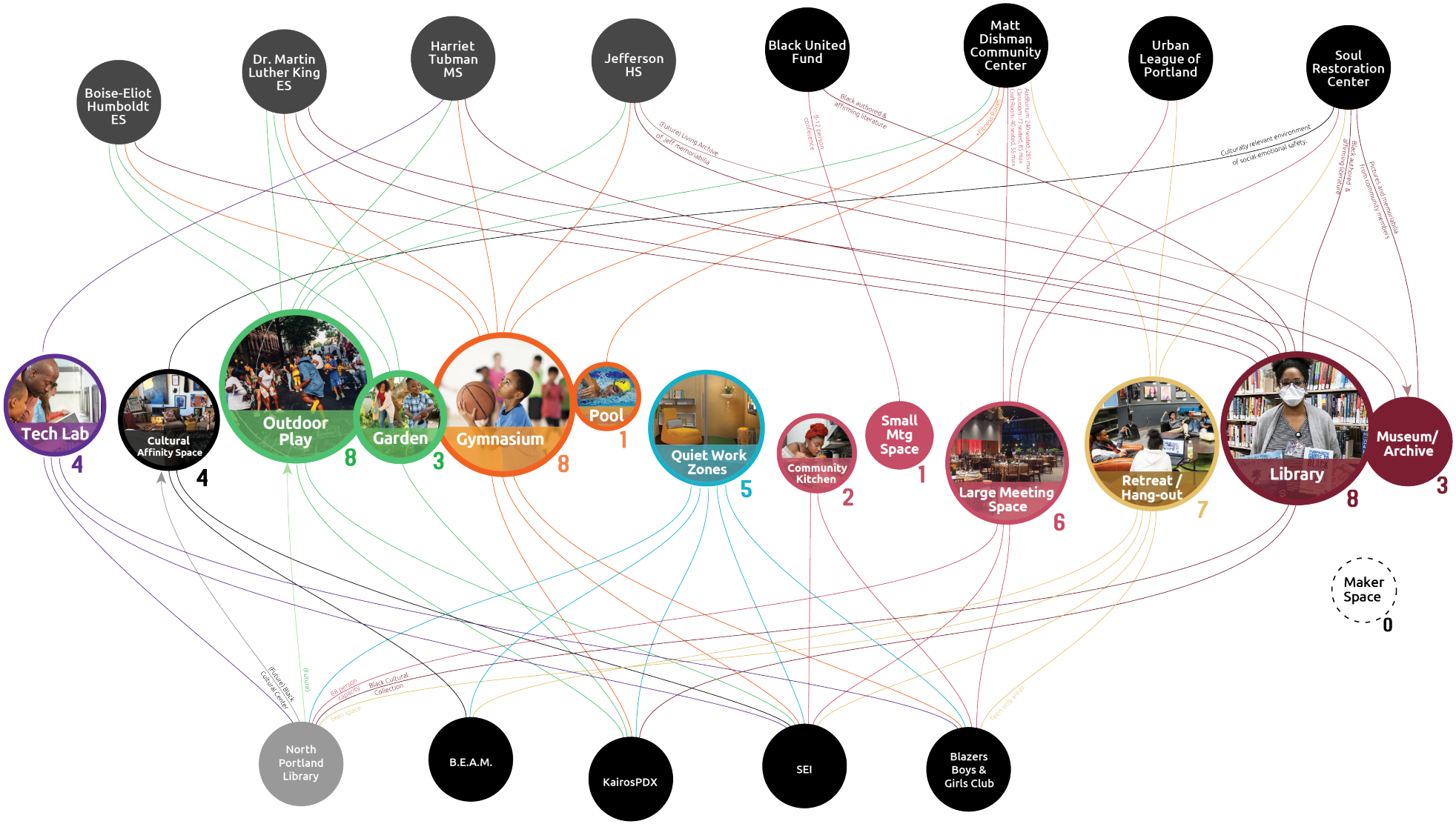
### Northwest Portland:

- NAACP
- Word Is Bond

# SPATIAL RESOURCES

(Albina)

*These initial graphics are based on information available on websites and the programs we are familiar or connected with as a team. Resource Mapping should be built out with each organization and take into account reach and effectiveness of each effort. It is likely that there are resources we are unaware of that should be made visible for the continuing work.



# SPATIAL RESOURCES (OPENLY AVAILABLE FOR BLACK YOUTH)

(Albina)

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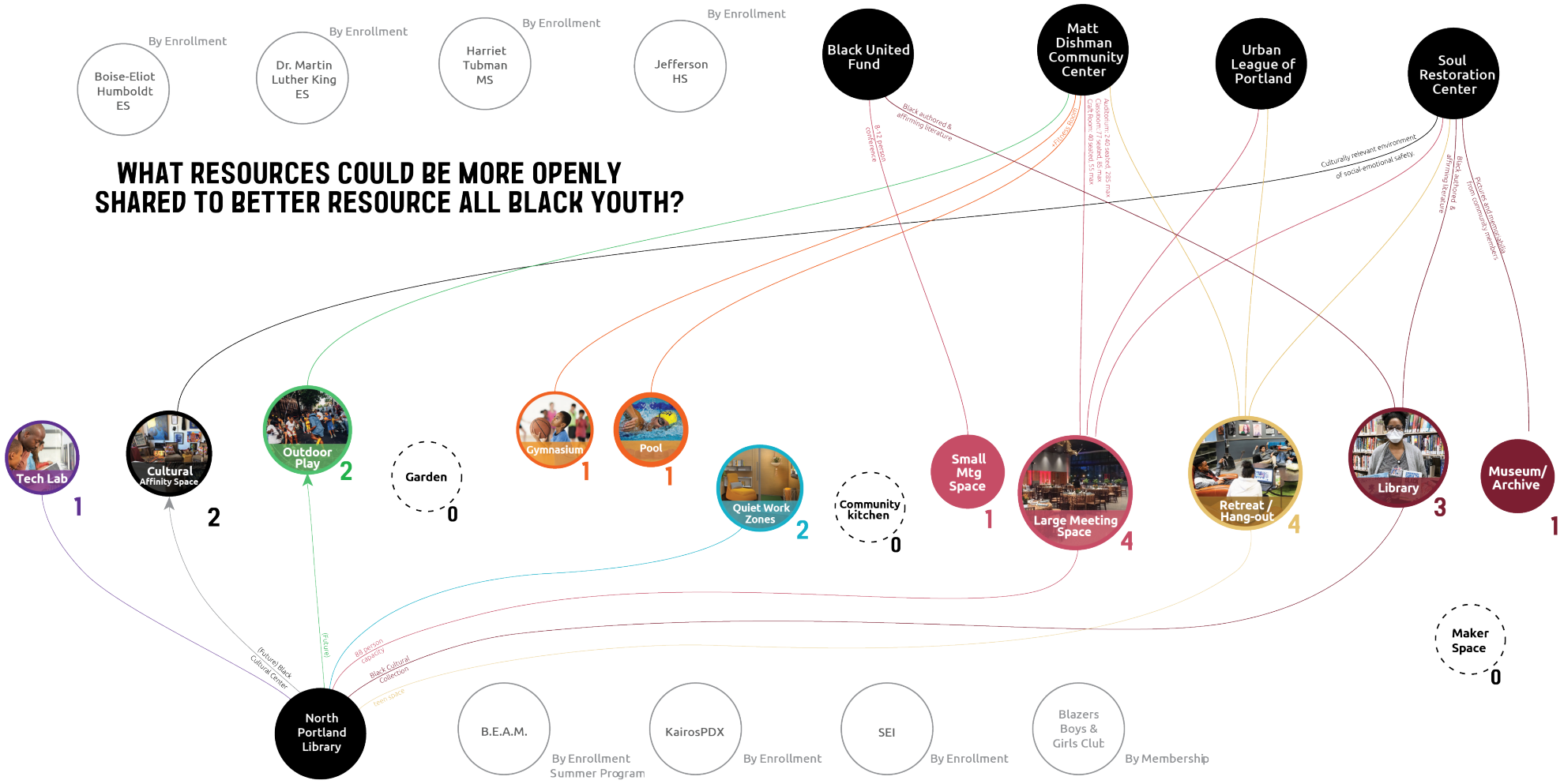

# SPATIAL RESOURCES

(East Portland)

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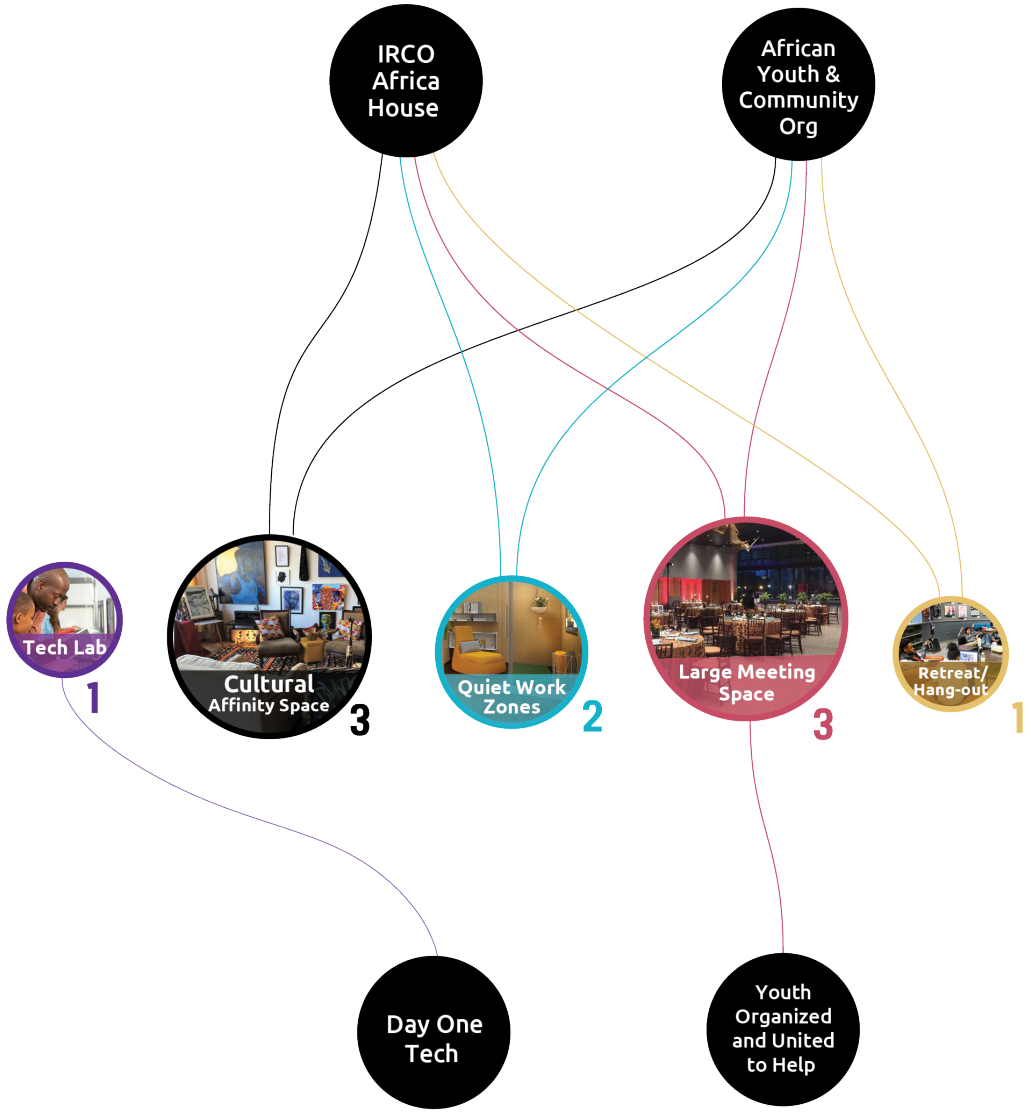


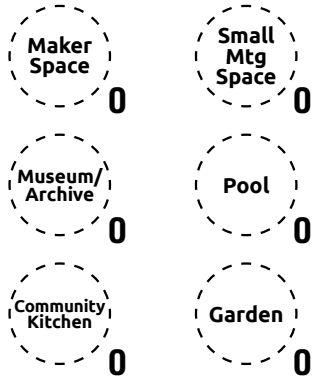

# ACADEMIC PROGRAMS:
# PRE-K TO CAREER

(Albina)

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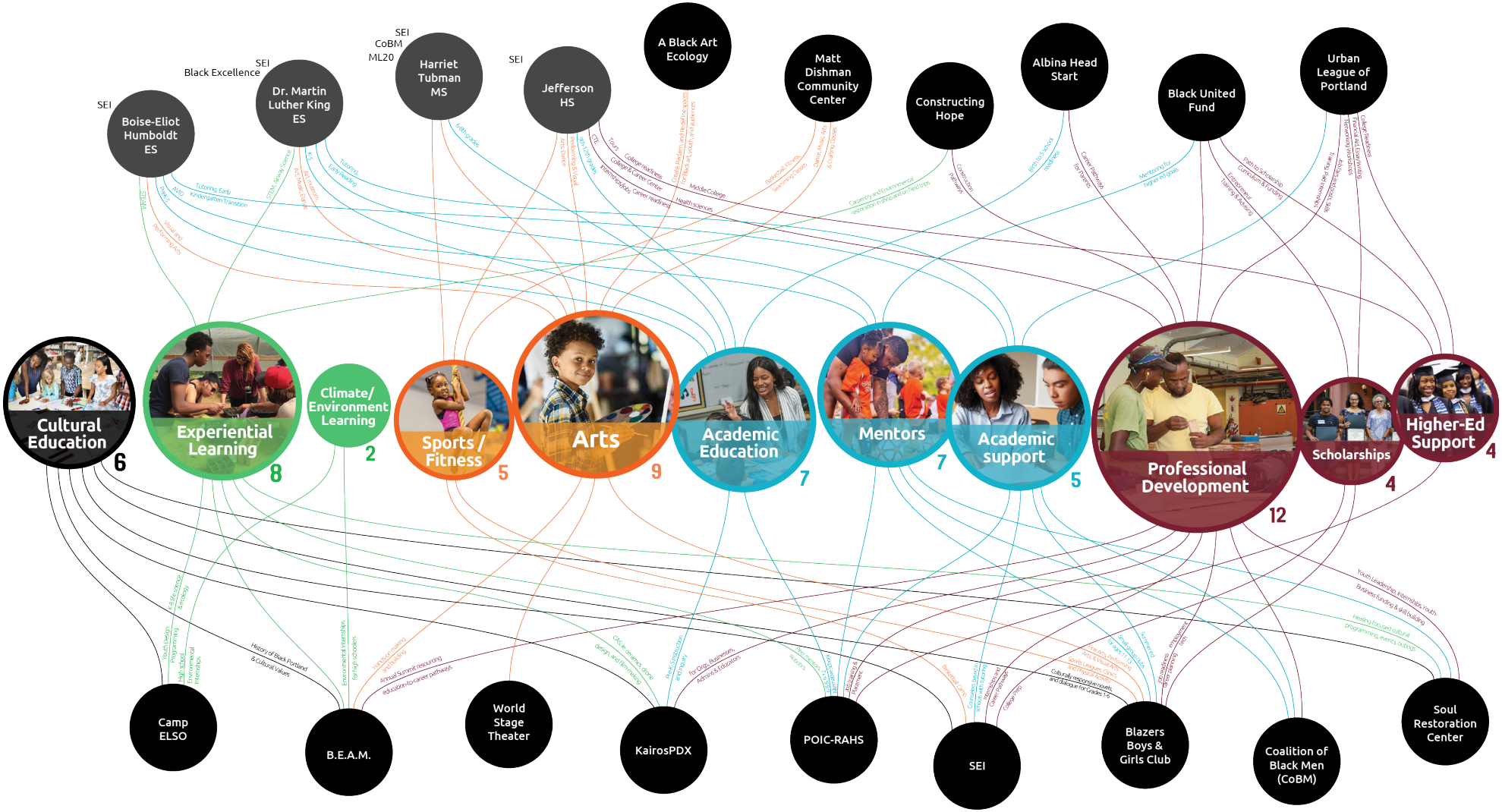

# ACADEMIC PROGRAMS:
# PRE-K TO CAREER

(East Portland)

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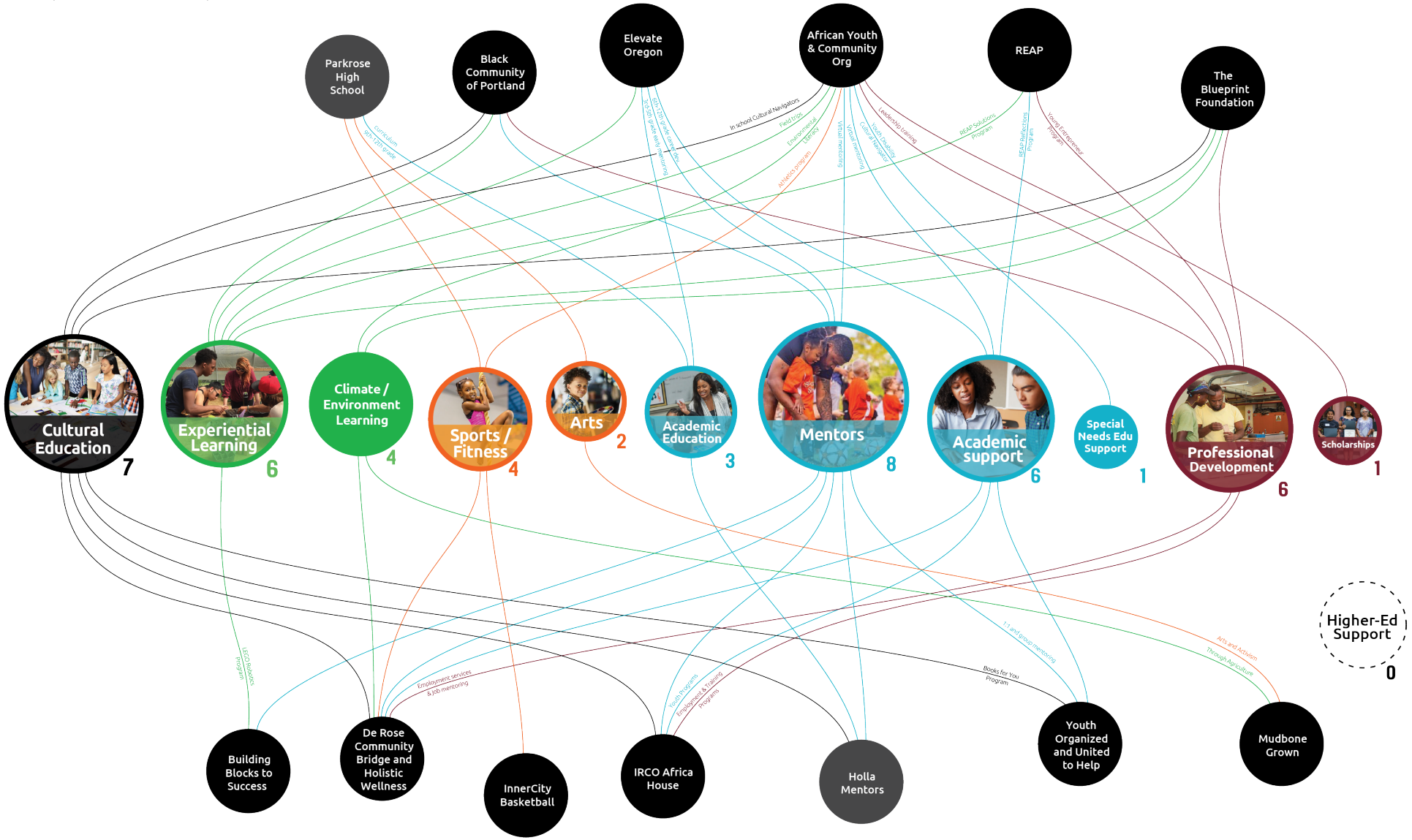
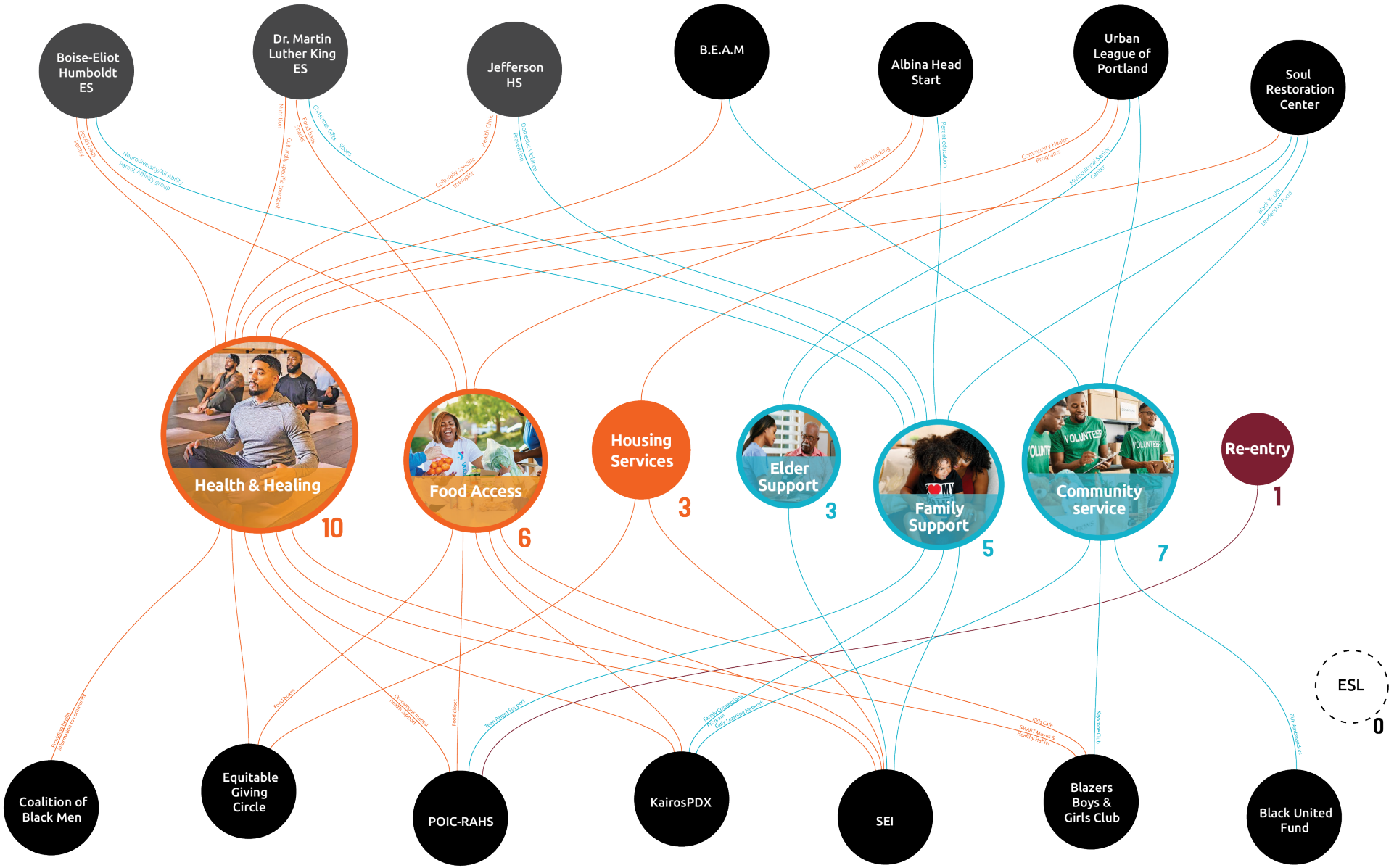


# HOLISTIC COMMUNITY SUPPORT (Albina)

*These initial graphics are based on information available on websites and the programs we are familiar or connected with as a team. Resource Mapping should be built out with each organization and take into account reach and effectiveness of each effort. It is likely that there are resources we are unaware of that should be made visible for the continuing work.



# HOLISTIC COMMUNITY SUPPORT

(East Portland)

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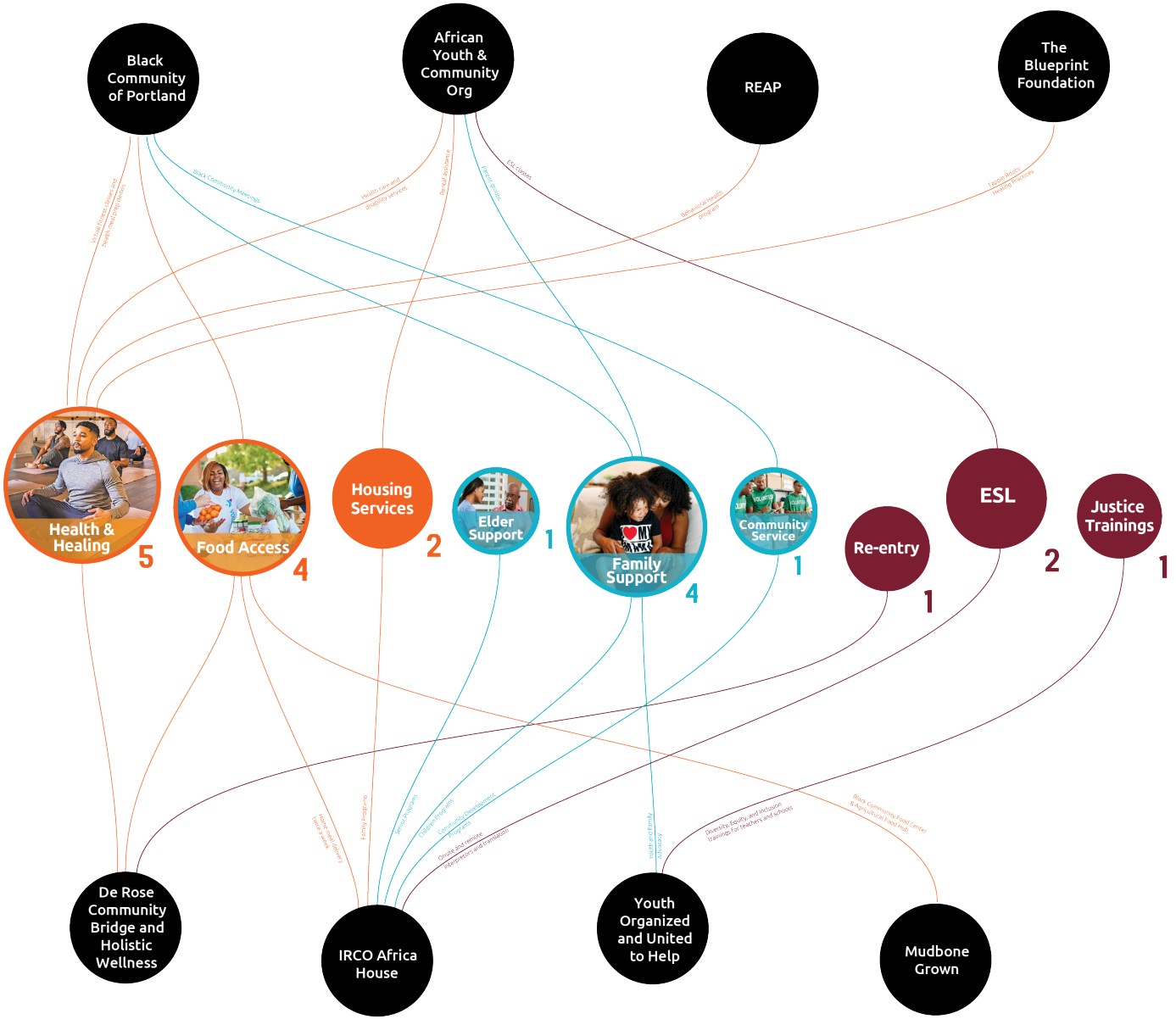


# 04. APPROACH

- Summary
- Curriculum/Instruction
- Student Support
- Family Support
- Educator, Capacity Building, Hiring and Retention
- Advocacy

# SUMMARY

**The Center for Black Student Excellence is a constellation of academic programs, strategies, supports, and experiences supported by infrastructure that work in coordination to form a transformational Approach to Black student learning.**

The Approach relies on the integration of positive cultural identity development and student leadership, with culturally affirming teaching and learning. In recognition that our students' experience is influenced by the adults who support them–particularly their families and educators–the Center for Black Student Excellence seeks to build an ecosystem that acknowledges their needs as central to student success.

ALL-STAR
VIP
PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
ALL-STAR
VIP

# CURRICULUM & INSTRUCTION

**Curriculum and Instruction refers to the educational experience of students** both inside and outside of the classroom.

MARVEL

## Outcomes:

- Black students will experience improved academic outcomes.
- Black students' attendance will increase.
- Black students will report a stronger sense of belonging.
- Black students will graduate with a post-secondary plan.

## Albina Arts, Excellence, and Culture Pathway

### Description:

Boise-Eliot Humboldt Elementary, Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr. Elementary, KairosPDX, Harriet Tubman Middle School, Jefferson High School, and partner programs in the area form an aligned PK-career pathway characterized by:

- Coordination across grade bands, building staff, and partners.
- Rigorous experiential learning.
- Visual and performing arts.
- Year-round Black history embedded across disciplines.
- Schools as community hubs.
- Cultural celebrations.
- Career exploration especially in green careers, business and marketing, product design, biotechnology, information technology, and construction.

When students walk into the doors of any of the Albina schools, they can expect to enter a warm and welcoming environment where their social and intellectual curiosities are nurtured. The local area becomes a tool for place-based learning, and Black excellence is the standard. Celebration is a regular practice as each school fosters Black joy. Students graduate with a post-secondary plan and job-ready skills.

**Correlating Narrative**

- Black Joy
- Collaborative Ecosystem
- Pathways to Success
- Safety

**Special Initiatives**

- Black Excellence Pre-K
- Kindergarten Innovation
- Middle School Redesign
- High School Success (M98)
- Master Arts Educational Plan
- Middle College

**Institutional Infrastructure**

- College and Career Readiness
- Instructional Framework
- Master Arts Education Plan
- Office of Teaching and Learning
- Social Sciences Curriculum
- Adoptions
- Student Learning and Family Engagement
- PK-5 Academic Programs
- Visual and Performing Arts

# Black History Rooted in Culturally Relevant Instruction

## Description:

Students have access to high-quality instructional materials that represent the many cultures within the African diaspora. As a part of the instructional core, namely social studies, all students learn about Black history before colonization and American slavery. This learning is augmented in the Center for Black Student Excellence's cultural archive where students have access to stories outside of suffering and the contributions of Black Oregonians. Educators and partners leverage the Center for Black Student Excellence to share and refine teaching practices and supplemental materials. In particular, they embed creativity, art, and storytelling in instruction.

**Correlating Narrative**

- Black Joy
- Pathways to Success
- Safety

**Special Initiatives**

- Summer Learning Academy
- Middle School Redesign

**Institutional Infrastructure**

- Instructional Framework
- Learning Acceleration
- Office of Teaching and Learning
- Racial Equity and Social Justice
- Social Sciences Curriculum
- Adoptions

# STUDENT SUPPORT

**Student Support refers to both programming, experiences and resources available to students** in schools and within the Center for Black Student Excellence.

## Outcomes:

- Black students will experience improved academic outcomes.
- Black students' attendance will increase.
- Black students will report a stronger sense of belonging.
- Black students will graduate with a post-secondary plan.
- Black students will demonstrate leadership qualities.
- Black students will experience improved mental wellness.

## Academic Interventions & Enrichment

### Description:

Black students have access to year-round academic interventions that support them to meet and exceed proficiency in math and literacy. This includes after school and summer tutoring. In addition, at the Center for Black Student Excellence, students have access to a network of partners and providers that host enrichment and pro-social activities to keep them engaged throughout the year. The programs teach team building, activate the imagination, and provide diversions from violence.

**Correlating Narrative**

- Black Joy
- Collaborative Ecosystem
- Pathways to Success
- Safety

**Special Initiatives**

- Summer Learning Academy

**Institutional Infrastructure**

- Learning Acceleration
- Racial Equity and Social Justice
- Schools Uniting Neighborhoods
- Office of School Performance

## Black Student Union Programming & Leadership Development

### Description:

Black students are united across school communities through a shared standard for Black Student Union programming. Central to each of the affinity clubs' success is the foundation of culture, identity, belonging and Black joy. They are encouraged to participate in rite of passage ceremonies, Historically Black College and University (HBCU) tours, and international trips. Black students are supported to become agents of change in topics of interest, and they gather collectively for joint student-led events at the Center for Black Student Excellence.

**Correlating Narrative**

- Black Joy
- Pathways to Success
- Safety

**Special Initiatives**

- All-Star Awards
- International Youth Leadership Conference

**Institutional Infrastructure**

- Climate Justice Youth Advisory
- Community Engagement and Student Voice
- District Student Council
- Affinity Group Network
- PPS reImagined Student Interns
- Office of School Performance

## Mentorship

### Description:

Black students have access to a network of mentors that span their social, cultural, and career interests. In particular, the Center for Black Student Excellence connects students with recent graduates, business professionals, and elders. In addition, mentors coach students on responsibly navigating social media and technology as digital natives.

**Correlating Narrative**

- Black Joy
- Collaborative Ecosystem
- Pathways to Success
- Safety

**Special Initiatives**

**Institutional Infrastructure**

- Career and Technical Education
- College and Career
- Office of School Performance
- Readiness
- Racial Equity and Social Justice
- Student Success and Health

## Wraparound Support & Healing Services

### Description:

The Center for Black Student Excellence provides students and families access to free and affordable food. In recognition of racial trauma, students have access to individual, group, and family mental health resources. The resources include holistic and licensed practitioners who provide training on:

- Conflict Resolution Practices
- Emotional Response Training

**Correlating Narrative**

- Black Joy
- Collaborative Healing
- Holistic Support
- Safety

**Special Initiatives**

- Ballmer Institute

**Institutional Infrastructure**

- Funded Programs
- Nutrition Services
- Student Support Services
- Multi-tiered Systems of Support
- Schools Uniting Neighborhoods

## Nurturing Pathways to Success

### Description:

At the Center for Black Student Excellence, community members and professionals host experiential and hands-on education classes that explore foundational life skills, business ownership, industry insights, and college preparation.

**Correlating Narrative**

- Black Joy
- Collaborative Healing
- Pathways to Success

**Special Initiatives**

- Plumbing, Air, Carpentry, Electrical Mentorship Program (PACE)
- ACE Mentorship Program

**Institutional Infrastructure**

- Career and Technical Education
- College and Career Readiness
- Office of Technology and Information Services

Alaska
PORTLAND

# FAMILY SUPPORT

**Family Support refers to the programming, resources, and knowledge building opportunities** for parents and caregivers in schools and within the Center for Black Student Excellence.

PPS
PORTLAND
PUBLIC
SCHOOLS
THE
ALL-STAR
AWARDS
CEREMONY
FRIDAY, JUNE 3, 2022
6:00 PM - 8:00 PM

## Outcomes:

- All families will understand the historical context of schools in the Albina neighborhood despite changing demographics.
- Black families will report fewer barriers to engaging with their students' school community.
- Black families will have access to tools and wraparound services for holistic support.

## Parent/Caregiver Affinity Groups

### Description:

Black families have access to differentiated support groups focused on:

- Parents of newborns/young children.
- Parents of elementary age children.
- Mothers.
- Fathers.
- Grandparents/caregivers/guardians.
- Single parents.
- Pregnant parents.

In addition, parents and caregivers have agency to facilitate Peer Led Support Groups. This ongoing peer led group provides parents and caregivers the opportunity to support one another and share information, advice or problem solving strategies related to parenting experiences.

| Correlating Narrative | Special Initiatives | Institutional Infrastructure |
|---|---|---|
| Black Joy<br>Collaborative Ecosystem<br>Healing<br>Holistic Support<br>Safety | | Headstart<br>Student Learning and Family Engagement<br>Office of School Performance |

## Parent/Caregiver Academy

### Description:

The Parent/Caregiver Academy program provides Black parents/caregivers and non-Black parents/caregivers raising Black children with training, information, and resources to support their essential responsibility for influencing their children's lives and maintaining the standard of excellence. By partnering with internal district departments, academic institutions, community organizations and other agencies to equip families with additional skills, knowledge, and resources, Parent/Caregiver Academy supports and empowers parents/caregivers to become leaders and advocates for their child's learning and navigate resources within the Center for Black Student Excellence. The Academy also serves as an avenue to learn about the history of Portland in the face of changing demographics.

Classes and workshops offered through Parent Academy provide resources and training on topics including safety, life skills, academic development and financial literacy, and provide families with tools that they can use to encourage their children to become successful.

**Correlating Narrative**

- Collaborative Healing
- Pathways to Success
- Safety

**Special Initiatives**

**Institutional Infrastructure**

- Office of Teaching and Learning
- Academic Programs
- Student Learning and Family Engagement
- Student Success and Health
- Multi-tiered Systems of Support
- SPED
- Funded Programs
- McKinney Vento
- High School College and Career Readiness
- Building Leaders
- Racial Equity and Social Justice Partners
- Civil Rights Coordinator

## Wraparound Support & Healing Services

**Description:**
The Center for Black Student Excellence provides students and families access to free and affordable food. In recognition of racial trauma, students have access to individual, group, and family mental health resources. The resources include holistic and licensed practitioners as well as emergency care.

| Correlating Narrative | Special Initiatives | Institutional Infrastructure |
|---|---|---|
| Black Joy<br>Collaborative Ecosystem<br>Healing<br>Holistic Support<br>Pathways to Success<br>Safety | | Funded Programs<br>Nutrition Services<br>Racial Equity and Social Justice<br>Student Success and Health |

## Family Advocacy & Case Management

**Description:**
The Center for Black Student Excellence directs families through the correct channels to navigate challenges in schools and supports them to escalate issues as needed. Through family advocacy and case management, families have a system of accountability with clear feedback loops. The Center for Black Student Excellence also removes barriers preventing families from accessing available services and resources. Through public and private partnerships, families receive transportation assistance to and from school and community activities.

| Correlating Narrative | Special Initiatives | Institutional Infrastructure |
|---|---|---|
| Collaborative Ecosystem<br>Holistic Support<br>Pathways to Success<br>Safety | | Civil Rights Coordinator<br>Complaints Coordinator<br>District Family Liaison<br>Funded Programs<br>Racial Equity and Social Justice |

# Parent/Caregiver Education and Skill Classes

## Description:

The Parent/Caregiver Education Program focuses on enhancing parenting practices and behaviors, such as developing positive discipline techniques, learning age-appropriate child development skills and milestones, promoting positive play, and interaction between parents and children.

**Correlating Narrative**

- Black Joy
- Collaborative Healing
- Pathways to Success
- Safety

**Special Initiatives**

**Institutional Infrastructure**

- Student Learning and Family Engagement

# EDUCATOR CAPACITY BUILDING, HIRING, AND RETENTION

Educator capacity building, hiring, and retention refers to the continuum of activities to support educators through their employee lifecycle. **While efforts to recruit Black educators continue, Portland Public Schools is responsible for ensuring that all educators are equipped and accountable to holding Black students to a high standard of success and that schools are places where students experience physical and emotional safety.**

BENSON
PHYSICAL EDUCATION
FIT LIVE AND LEARN
Cook, P

## Outcomes:

- All educators will be equipped to communicate with and involve students and families at every level of decision-making that directly impacts Black students.
- All educators and administrators will keep families proactively informed about student progress and opportunities for engagement and success.
- All educators will demonstrate mastery of curriculum and culturally affirming instruction.
- All educators will receive scaffolded support to ensure every Black student is seen, welcomed, valued, and held to high standards, so that they achieve educational equity.
- Administrators will ensure that educators are accountable to maintaining a culture of Black student excellence as informed by student voice.
- All educators will have opportunities to understand the history of the Albina neighborhood and build a network of culturally competent allyship.
- All educators will have access to wellness resources. Black educators will have access to an affinity network.

## Family Engagement Toolkit

### Description:

The Family Engagement Toolkit is a resource for schools to develop, and sustain consistent family engagement. It provides strategies, tips, and tools to forecast engagement events and important discussion topics for the school year. As student opportunities emerge, the family engagement toolkit empowers schools to establish a regular practice of communication with families.

## Become Rooted in the History of Black Portland

### Description:

The Center for Black Student Excellence provides opportunities for educators and administrators to learn about the history of the Albina neighborhood and the contributions of Black Portlanders up to the present day. Through learning experiences, they develop competence in the social and political factors that contribute to Black student learning and can demonstrate awareness of their own positionality, biases and identities as well as those of their students, and how this impacts dynamics of power, social norms, privilege, and oppression in the classroom. The Center for Black Student Excellence provides a pathway to harnesses best practices and the wisdom of the community in support of student success.

**Correlating Narrative**

- Black Joy
- Collaborative Ecosystem
- Pathways to Success

**Special Initiatives**

**Institutional Infrastructure**

- Racial Equity and Social Justice
- Teacher Professional Development
- Office of Teaching and Learning
- Workforce Diversity and Development

## Culturally Responsive Instruction

**Description:**
The Center for Black Student Excellence serves as an incubator to test and share effective classroom management and instructional practices, source supplemental materials, find resources to curate culturally affirming classroom spaces, and empower families in supporting their child's academics at home in close cooperation with educators. In partnership with district teams, all educators, administrators, and partners are trained and coached to fully support all Black students academically, socially, and emotionally. Training includes:

- Classroom Management
- Conflict Resolution
- Culturally Affirming Instruction
- Data-driven Continuous Improvement
- Differentiation
- Parent Teacher Home Visits (PTHV)
- Racial Equity and Social Justice Foundations
- Support for gender non-conforming students
- Transformative Social Emotional Learning (TSEL)

**Correlating Narrative**

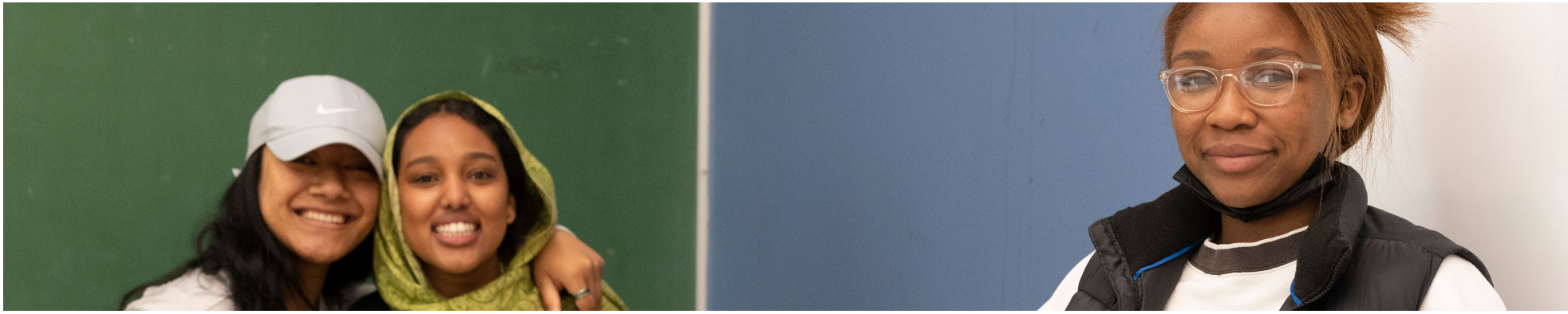
- Black Joy
- Collaborative Ecosystem
- Pathways to Success

**Special Initiatives**

- Coach to Classroom
- Racial Equity Centered Principal Pipeline Initiative

**Institutional Infrastructure**

- Office of Teaching and Learning
- Teacher Professional Development
- Research Assessment and Accountability
- Racial Equity and Social Justice
- Student Support Services
- Workforce Diversity and Development



## Educator Affinity Groups & Leadership Development

### Description:

At the Center for Black Student Excellence, Black educators meet for affinity and model educational excellence for students aspiring to become teachers. Educators build camaraderie with diverse educators from various content areas, with varying years of experience and pathways. They too, engage in peer and intergenerational mentorship while accessing mental health and healing resources for themselves. At the Center for Black Student Excellence, teacher leaders and veteran educators explore pathways to become administrators and opportunities to demonstrate their leadership in district-level discussions.

**Correlating Narrative**

- Black Joy
- Collaborative Ecosystem
- Holistic Support
- Pathways to Success
- Safety

**Special Initiatives**

- Career Lattice
- Coach to Classroom
- Racial Equity Centered Principal Pipeline Initiative

**Institutional Infrastructure**

- Employee Benefits
- Office of Teaching and Learning
- Racial Equity and Social Justice
- Teacher Professional Learning
- Workforce Diversity and Development

# ADVOCACY

**Advocacy refers to the internal policies and processes to accelerate Black student excellence and external policy positions** to consider that may directly or indirectly reinforce Portland Public Schools' ability to support Black students.

## Affordable Housing

**Description:**
Support investments in affordable housing in North and Northeast Portland.

## A Strong Educator Workforce

**Description:**
Support Grow Your Own and pipeline development programs.

## Discipline

**Description:**
Support restorative justice and alternative discipline practices.

## Early Childhood/Literacy

**Description:**
Support early interventions for early childhood literacy.

## Educator Assignments

**Description:**
Support a contract amendment to assign teachers to schools where they more closely reflect the demographics of the students.

## Educator Accountability

**Description:**
Support a contract amendment that installs firm accountability for incidents racial discrimination.

## Enrollment

**Description:**
Revisit feeder, zoning, and admission to ensure Black students benefit from the focus on North and Northeast Portland schools.

## Ethnic Studies

**Description:**
Support the full implementation of Ethnic Studies standards and professional learning for educators.

## Transportation

**Description:**
Support the implementation of strategies that increase Black students in the Portland metro to participate in Right to Return.

## Universal Meals

**Description:**
Support funding for all kindergarten through 12th grade public schools to provide free meals during each school day to students requesting a meal, regardless of the student's financial eligibility.

| Correlating Narrative | Special Initiatives | Institutional Infrastructure |
|---|---|---|
| Collaborative Ecosystem<br>Holistic Support<br>Pathways to Success | | ■ Center for Black Excellence<br>■ Communications<br>■ General Counsel<br>■ Government Relations<br>■ Funded Programs<br>■ Nutrition Services<br>■ Planning & Asset Management,<br>■ Portland Public Schools Board of Education, Enrollment & Transfer |

# 05.
# REDESIGN OF THE SYSTEM

- Summary
- System-level strategies

# SUMMARY

The System Redesign refers to changes in Portland Public Schools' priorities and how it operates to position the organization for accelerated implementation of Center for Black Student Excellence efforts. **The redesign leverages Portland Public Schools' strategic priorities while insisting that the success of Black students requires radically different methods from the ones that have maintained the system up to this point.**

# SYSTEM-LEVEL STRATEGIES

Portland Public Schools uses data effectively and consistently to drive cycles of continuous improvement that lead to **decisions — and actions that improve Black student outcomes.**

Dia De
Muertos
Talent Show

# BUILD A COLLECTIVE SENSE OF TRUST AND BELONGING

## Strategic Outcome

Through repeated behavior change, Portland Public Schools creates a new track record of trustworthiness with the community, and across the organization. We collectively establish shared ownership for the success of Black students while publicly acknowledging the history of shortcomings and failures by the public education system, how that history impacts the present, and the pathway to different outcomes.

## Description

In collaboration with our educators and community, the vision of the Center for Black Student Excellence is rooted in the values of Umoja and Ujamaa - Unity, Collective Work, and Responsibility. Umoja and Ujamaa are Kwanzaa principles that unite and empower the African-American community through joint efforts and solutions. Umoja expresses the desire to strive for and maintain unity in the family, community, nation, and race. Ujamaa seeks to build and maintain community together and make our community's problems our problems and for us to solve together.

### GOAL #1

Include Black student, family, partner, and community voices at every level of decision-making that directly impacts Black students.

### GOAL #2

Publicly reflect the direct connection between every staff team's respective bodies of work and the implementation of Center for Black Student Excellence efforts.

### GOAL #3

Design conflict mediation protocols for Black students, families, staff, and partners.

### GOAL #4

Establish regular convenings of educators, service providers, community members, and entities working in coordination for the benefit of Black students, at a minimum of once per quarter.

# ESTABLISH A PRACTICE OF STRATEGIC FORESIGHT AND SUSTAINABLE TEAMING STRUCTURES

### Strategic Outcome

Portland Public Schools is better equipped to anticipate and meet the needs of schools in service of Black student excellence.

### Description

Portland Public Schools has cultivated a practice of forecasting and aligning all district priorities and bodies of work with teams structured to eliminate duplication and staff burnout. School district staff work to develop mutually empowering partnerships with peers, families, and Portland's diverse communities. Requests for staff participation in disparate working groups are reduced as gathering time is more efficient and intentional with direct correlation to advancing Black student excellence. Resources are more efficiently distributed across the organization, and staff across departments can, at a minimum, provide high-level summaries of what other colleagues are working on.

**GOAL #1**

Establish an annual district work plan that complements school rhythms and maximizes breaks for preparation.

**GOAL #2**

Create official channels for collaboration between capital and programmatic projects impacting Black students to increase staff efficiency and eliminate silos.

**GOAL #3**

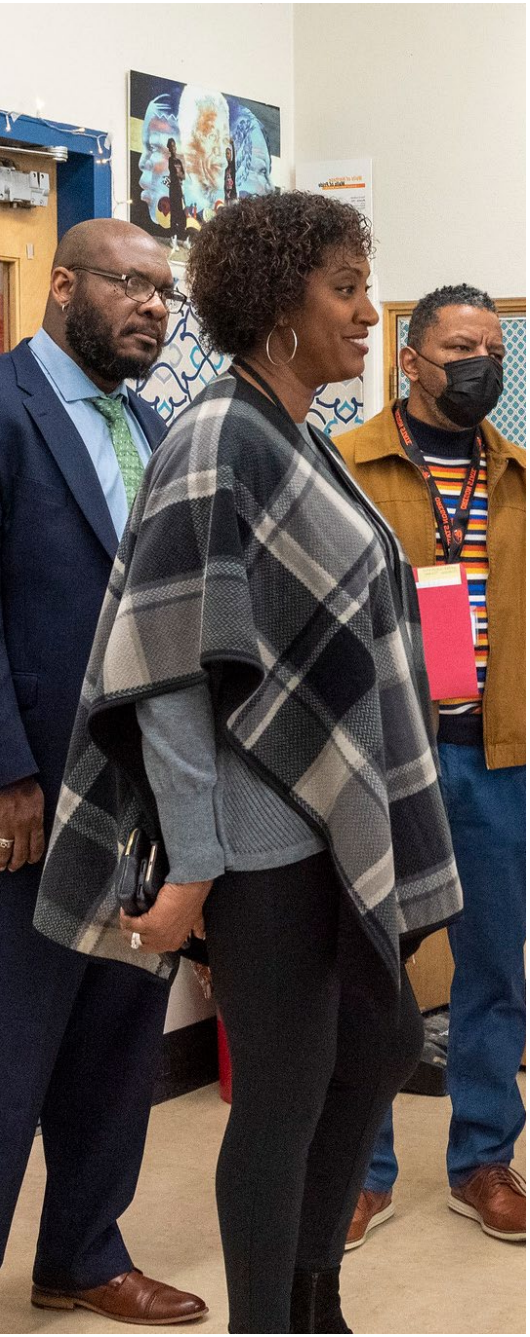
When evaluating the geographic location of the Center for Black Student Excellence, consider the proximity to other Black-serving organizations, institutions and services.

**GOAL #4**

Dedicate a fixed percentage of time for every district staff member to collaborate on cross-functional work strands.

**GOAL #5**

Consider sharing programs between co-located institutions and organizations in order to maximize financial and spatial resources.



# EMBED SYSTEM-WIDE DATA-DRIVEN CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT PRACTICES

## Strategic Outcome

Portland Public Schools uses data effectively and consistently to drive cycles of continuous improvement that lead to decisions — and actions that improve Black student outcomes.

## Description

Effective data-driven continuous improvement practices are evident throughout the district, especially at the classroom, grade-level, school, and central office department levels. Educators have the capacity to set measurable goals, collect outcome and implementation data from multiple sources, analyze data, adjust actions, and monitor progress toward goals. Diverse stakeholders are involved in data analysis to strengthen interpretation, and this informs decisions and actions, especially resource allocations, that lead to improved outcomes.

**GOAL #1**

Collaboratively create a new metric for evaluating Black student success, and provide partners with data to proactively adjust actions.

**GOAL #2**

Include Black student voice in educator evaluations.

**GOAL #3**

Provide a clear process and protocol for the response to racialized incidents between students and staff.

# IMPLEMENT A PROACTIVE, EFFECTIVE, AND CREATIVE COMMUNICATION PRACTICE

## Strategic Outcome

Our communication practice proactively informs internal and external stakeholders in ways that are respectful, transparent, and inclusive of our linguistically and culturally diverse communities.

## Description

Internal and external communication are consistent and accurate, and inform stakeholders in a timely fashion. Attention to accessibility has made methods and content responsive to audience needs. By using a variety of data and media, we "show the system to itself" and the broader community through stories of growth and accomplishment, keeping our community proactively informed as to progress across the district.

### GOAL #1

Leverage traditional and nontraditional communication platforms to provide internal and external staff, families, and community members regular updates on key decisions, developments and progress of Black students with guidance on opportunities to get involved.

### GOAL #2

Provide students with clear guidance on whom and where to go for additional assistance.

# CULTIVATE AND PROMOTE ALIGNED COMMUNITY PARTNERSHIPS

## Strategic Outcome

Our partnerships equitably support our students to achieve the Graduate Portrait.

## Description

Internal and external stakeholders are active partners supporting our vision, PPS reImagined, and the Center for Black Student Excellence efforts. They have clear options and opportunities to align their efforts with our vision. We cultivate, foster, and sustain partnerships so that our collective efforts to support our students to achieve the Graduate Portrait are maximized.

### GOAL #1

Collaboratively develop a new shared metric to identify the efficacy of strategies and partnerships in advancing Black student excellence.

### GOAL #2

Support smaller Community Based Organizations with capacity building to effectively support Black students especially those in schools with smaller percentages of Black youth.

# DEVELOP A COHERENT SYSTEM-WIDE COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT APPROACH

### Strategic Outcome

Stakeholder engagement is a core competency through which the perspectives and voices of educators, students, and families are authentically integrated.

### Description

Our coherent, system-wide approach to internal and external community engagement uses consistent guidelines for departments and sites on the design of engagement activities to ensure that they are meaningful and transparent. Guidelines clarify expectations as to the purpose and outcomes of engagement, including expectations for collaboration and feedback loops, and help stakeholders feel that their participation is valued by understanding how their input, feedback, and collaborative design efforts will be used.

**GOAL #1**

Create clear and accountable feedback loops for all engagement efforts.

**GOAL #2**

Remove barriers and incentivize community participation with flexible compensation models.

**GOAL #3**

Leverage the information from previous engagement processes and scholarly research to avoid community fatigue.

**GOAL #4**

Create pathways for Black community members to influence and support implementation.

# DEVELOP A DIVERSE, HIGH-QUALITY, THRIVING WORKFORCE

## Strategic Outcome

We have a diverse, high-quality, thriving workforce that is supported in personal and professional well-being and success.

## Description

We have a diverse workforce that reflects student demographics through intentional recruitment, hiring, retention, and development of educators of color. We have a high-quality, thriving workforce that is supported by professional experiences throughout the entire employee lifecycle, to ensure each educator's personal and professional well-being, growth, and success.

### GOAL #1

Establish school and department wellness strategies with metrics to track Black staff retention.

### GOAL #2

Develop Human Resource professionals as generalists and increase staffing to reduce backlog in school-based and district staff support requests.

### GOAL #3

Establish a Black educator affinity network and support system to report and ensure accountability for targeted incidents of racialized discrimination.

### GOAL #4

Establish a year-round recognition system for exemplary educators.

### GOAL #5

Develop and publicize Grow Your Own programs through innovative partnerships with local colleges and universities.

### GOAL #6

Develop a pipeline program from Historically Black Colleges and Universities (HBCUs).

### GOAL #7

Increase building administrators' capacity as instructional and equity-centered leaders who can hold educators accountable for cultivating safe environments for Black students.

### GOAL #8

Establish a high-quality robust professional learning catalog that is meaningfully integrated during pre-service training and throughout the year.

# DIGITAL INFRASTRUCTURE

### Strategic Outcome

Students and families have the opportunity to receive information and participate in key decisions, developments, and community events in person and virtually.

### Description

Students and families are aware of the resources available through a digital platform. The resource centralizes opportunities for Black students and community members to reduce competing events.

**GOAL #1**

Coordinate and maintain a directory of Black student and community-serving resources and events including scholarships and internship opportunities. Ensure students at every PPS school have access and support to navigate the platform.

**GOAL #2**

Create hybrid and asynchronous engagement opportunities.

# SCHOOLS AS COMMUNITY HUBS

### Strategic Outcome

Schools have become community hubs that integrate support services for families—including health care, housing support, clothing, and food—that are intuitive, easy to navigate, and driven by community need.

### Description

These support services are also used to help students at critical transitions—kindergarten, sixth grade, ninth grade, and twelfth grade/transition to post-secondary, and when students arrive as newcomers or move between schools—creating a foundation for specific needs that allows students to engage fully in their education. Learning draws upon families' backgrounds and cultural assets to build school community and help students achieve their highest academic potential. The school district builds connections, and district spaces also support interactions and collaborations with community partners.

**GOAL #1**

Establish partnerships to meet the needs of school communities driven by student and family requests.

**GOAL #2**

Welcome participation and presence of community members who may not have contracts with the district to support school climate and mentorship activities.

# REIMAGINED RESPONSES TO SAFETY AND SECURITY

## Strategic Outcome

Black students experience physical and emotional safety.

## Description

Incidents of community violence reduce as students have more access to mental health services and prosocial activities. Community members have opportunities for active participation. Black joy and a culture of celebration serve to amplify students' sense of belonging. Through this effort, Portland Public Schools dismantles the school-to-prison pipeline, which refers to policies and practices that disproportionately push black youth out of schools and into the criminal justice system, often due to harsh discipline policies, biased policing, and inadequate educational resources.

### GOAL #1

Increase student Awareness for Mental Health and Wellness Supports.

### GOAL #2

In conjunction with our Safe Routes to School team, pilot efforts to have community-based individuals posted on identified routes to support middle and high school students traveling to and from school during arrival and dismissal bell times.

### GOAL #3

In partnership with students, educators, and mental health providers, develop a standard post-traumatic event protocol that:

- Addresses trauma using healing centered practices.
- Provides tools for collective response to trauma.
- Creates tools that center culture, identity, and race as a leverage to holistic healing and well-being.
- Foster relationships, prioritize agency, promote collective action, and promotes culturally based learning.
- Creates school-based proactive strategies that support individual, interpersonal, and institutional well-being.

### GOAL #4

Establish consistent classroom management practices that disrupt push-outs and maintain high standards for students.

### GOAL #5

Resource community-based prevention programs to provide pro-social activities.

# SUSTAINING
# THE EFFORT

### Strategic Outcome

Portland Public Schools, in partnership with the community, cares for future generations with a promise of academic excellence, economic security, self-determination, and equal opportunities.

### Description

The community vision for the Center for Black Student Excellence is sustained through innovative governance and funding models that leverage collective impact. Using the CBSE vision as guidance, organizations have a clear direction and leverage their strengths as they pursue aligned investment opportunities. Portland Public Schools maintains a dedicated budget for Black student achievement and related strategies.

**GOAL #1**

In partnership with Center for Black Excellence (CBE) leadership, establish a robust fund development strategy for continued private investment.

**GOAL #2**

Establish transparent standards for Center for Black Excellence board membership and actively develop the pipeline of board leadership.

**GOAL #3**

Launch an unapologetically Black-led design process for the physical building that positions Black creatives including artists, interior designers, and architects at the forefront of the core design team to create pathways for Black economic development and student internships.

**GOAL #4**

Determine and maintain staffing levels to sustain project management, program development, fund development, technology, building maintenance and operations.

**GOAL #5**

Establish public and private transportation partnerships and scale the infrastructure in proportion to the growth in displaced students.

# 06.
# APPENDIX

- Design and Engagement Calendar
- Glossary
- CBSE Bibliography

# DESIGN AND ENGAGEMENT CALENDAR

| PHASE I | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **October** 2022 | | | |
| **Event** | **Date & Time** | **Location** | **Type** |
| Homecoming Lunch | 10/3/22<br>11:44am-12:19pm | Jefferson High School Cafeteria<br>5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Design Research<br>(Student) |
| Homecoming Lunch | 10/4/22<br>11:44am-12:19pm | Jefferson High School Cafeteria<br>5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Design Research<br>(Student) |
| Harriet Tubman<br>Staff Meeting | 10/4/22<br>4:00pm-5:30pm | Harriet Tubman Middle<br>2231 N Flint Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Design Research<br>(Staff) |
| Know Your School | 10/4/22<br>5:30pm-6:30pm | Virtual | Community<br>Engagement |
| Jefferson<br>Homecoming Lunch | 10/5/22<br>11:44am-12:19pm | Jefferson High School Cafeteria<br>5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Design Research<br>(Student) |
| Jefferson<br>Homecoming Lunch | 10/6/22<br>11:44am-12:19pm | Jefferson High School Cafeteria<br>5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Design Research<br>(Student) |
| Jefferson<br>Lunch Period | 10/11/22<br>12:21pm-1:09pm | Jefferson High School Cafeteria<br>5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Design Research<br>(Student) |
| Modernization<br>Evening BBQ | 10/11/22<br>5:45pm-8:00pm | Jefferson High School Cafeteria<br>5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Community<br>Engagement |
| Tubman<br>Lunch Period | 10/12/22<br>12:21pm-1:09pm | Harriet Tubman Middle Cafeteria<br>2231 N Flint Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Design Research<br>(Student) |
| Jefferson College<br>and Career Day | 10/12/22<br>8:45am-11:40am | Jefferson High School<br>5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Design Research<br>(Student) |
| Jefferson Modernization<br>Town Hall | 10/12/22<br>5:00pm-6:00pm | Jefferson High School Library<br>5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Community<br>Engagement |

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|---|---|---|---|
| Jefferson Comprehensive Planning Committee #5 | 10/12/22 6:30pm-8:30pm | Jefferson High School Library 5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Community Engagement |
| Tubman Lunch Period | 10/13/22 12:21pm-1:09pm | Harriet Tubman Middle Cafeteria 2231 N Flint Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Design Research (Student) |
| PIL Volleyball Tournament | 10/15/22 7:00am-5:00pm | Jefferson High School Gym 5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Community Engagement |
| Jefferson Modernization Community Design Workshop | 10/15/22 9:00am-4:00pm | Jefferson High School Cafeteria 5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Community Engagement |
| Tubman Staff Meeting | 10/18/22 4:00pm-5:30pm | Harriet Tubman Middle 2231 N Flint Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Design Research (Staff) |
| Tubman Community Lesson (8th grade) | 10/21/22 2:46pm-3:45pm | Harriet Tubman Middle 2231 N Flint Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Student Engagement |
| Tubman Community Night | 10/27/22 5:30pm-7:00pm | Harriet Tubman Middle Cafeteria 2231 N Flint Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Community Engagement |
| Tubman Assembly (8th grade) | 10/28/22 2:46pm-3:45pm | Harriet Tubman Middle Cafeteria 2231 N Flint Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Student Engagement |
| CBSE Mixer | 10/31/22 4:00pm-5:30pm | Dr. Matthew Prophet Center 501 N Dixon St., Portland, OR 97227 | Community Engagement |

## **November** 2022

| Event | Date & Time | Location | Type |
|---|---|---|---|
| Jefferson Staff Meeting | 11/1/22 3:45pm-5:00pm | Jefferson High School 5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Design Research (Staff) |
| Know Your School | 11/1/22 5:00pm-6:30pm | Virtual | Community Engagement |
| Jefferson 8th grade Parent Night | 11/9/22 5:30pm-6:30pm | Jefferson High School Cafeteria 5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Community Engagement |
| Dr. King Black Family Night | 11/17/22 5:30pm-7:00pm | Martin Luther King School 4906 NE 6th Ave, Portland, OR 97211 | |

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|---|---|---|---|
| Tubman Community Lesson (7th grade) | 11/18/22 2:46pm-3:45pm | Harriet Tubman Middle Cafeteria 2231 N Flint Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Student Engagement |
| Jefferson Parent Teacher Conferences | 11/21/22 12:30pm-4:00pm | Jefferson High School Cafeteria 5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Community Engagement |
| Jefferson Parent Teacher Conferences | 11/21/22 5:00pm-7:45pm | Jefferson High School Cafeteria 5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Community Engagement |
| Jefferson Parent Teacher Conferences | 11/22/22 8:30am-11:30am | Jefferson High School Cafeteria 5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Community Engagement |
| Jefferson Staff Meeting | 11/29/22 3:45pm-5:15pm | Jefferson High School Room B-27 5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Design Research (Staff) |

## **December** 2022

| Event | Date & Time | Location | Type |
|---|---|---|---|
| Preserving Black Spaces Lecture - Learning Journey | 12/1/22 6:00pm - 7:30pm | Architectural Heritage Center 701 SE Grand Ave, Portland, OR 97214 | Community Engagement |
| Tubman Assembly (7th grade) | 12/2/22 2:46pm-3:45pm | Harriet Tubman Middle Cafeteria 2231 N Flint Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Student Engagement |
| Tubman Community Lesson (6th grade) | 12/2/22 2:46pm-3:45pm | Harriet Tubman Middle Cafeteria 2231 N Flint Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Student Engagement |
| Tubman Staff Meeting | 12/6/22 4:00pm-5:30pm | Harriet Tubman Middle 2231 N Flint Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Design Research (Staff) |
| Know Your School | 12/6/22 5:30pm-6:30pm | Virtual | Community Engagement |
| Jefferson Boys Basketball Game | 12/6/22 7:00pm-9:00pm | Jefferson Athletic Fieldhouse (Basketball Gym) 5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Community Engagement |
| Tubman Assembly (6th grade) | 12/9/22 2:45pm-3:45pm | Harriet Tubman Middle Cafeteria 2231 N Flint Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Student Engagement |
| Jefferson Boys Basketball Game | 12/13/22 7:00pm-9:00pm | Jefferson Athletic Fieldhouse (Basketball Gym) 5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Community Engagement |

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| Harriet Tubman Black Student Union Engagement | 12/15/22 12:00-12:46 | Jefferson HS 5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Student Engagement | |
| Black Family Night | 12/15/22 5:30pm-7:00pm | Martin Luther King School 4906 NE 6th Ave, Portland, OR 97211 | Community Engagement | |

## PHASE II

### December 2022

| Event | Date & Time | Location | Type | Partner |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Preserving Black Spaces Lecture | 12/1/22 6:00pm-7:30pm | Architectural Heritage Center 701 SE Grand Ave, Portland, OR 97214, USA | Learning Journey | Architectural Heritage Center |

### January 2023

| Event | Date & Time | Location | Type | Partner |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Jefferson High School Students and Staff | 1/1/23 | Jefferson High School 5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Learning Journey | I AM MORE |
| Met with Jefferson Staff and Students | 1/11/23 | Jefferson High School 5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Learning Journey | I AM MORE |
| In My Shoes Walk: Students & Parents | 1/14/23 10:00am-11:45am | Unthank Park 3920 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Learning Journey | Word is Bond |
| In My Shoes Walk: Partners & Staff | 1/14/23 12:00pm-1:45pm | Unthank Park 3920 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Learning Journey | Word is Bond |
| Church Celebration of Dr. King Highland Church | 1/16/23 1:00pm-4:00pm | Highland Church 7600 NE Glisan St, Portland, OR 97213 | Student Engagement | I AM MORE |
| McDaniel BSU Coordinator/Students (22) | 1/17/23 | McDaniel High School 2735 NE 82nd Ave, Portland, OR 97220 | Student Engagement | I AM MORE |
| Jefferson Student Athletes/Leaders | 1/18/23 2-3:30pm | Jefferson High School 5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Student Engagement | I AM MORE |
| Jefferson HS Open House | 1/18/23 6:30-8:30pm | Jefferson High School 5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Community Engagement | |

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| Harriet Tubman Middle School BSU | 1/19/23 12:00pm-11:00pm | Harriet Tubman Middle School 2231 N Flint Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Student Engagement | I AM MORE |
| Alliance at Meek | 1/19/23 | Alliance at Meek 4039 NE Alberta Ct, Portland, OR 97211 | Student Engagement | I AM MORE |
| Portland Opportunities Industrial Center | 1/19/23 | Portland Opportunities Industrial Center 717 N Killingsworth Ct, Portland, OR 97217 | Student Engagement | I AM MORE |
| Connected with students from Benson, Meek, Roosevelt and PSU to discuss the Black Student Expo. 10 students | 1/21/23 | Soul Restoration Center 14 NE Killingsworth St, Portland, OR 97211 | Student Engagement | I AM MORE |
| Black Professionals Expo | 1/21/23 12:00pm-6:00pm | Lloyd Center (Inside of the old Victoria Secret) 1405 Lloyd Center, Portland, OR 97232 | Learning Journey | Young, Gifted, and Black National Association of Minority Contractors |
| Youth Entrepreneurial Advisory Team to brainstorm engagement with schools moving forward and to discuss positive changes we want to see | 1/22/23 | | Student Engagement | I AM MORE |
| MoAD Virtual Tour: The New Black Vanguard | 1/23/23 11:00am-1:00pm | Via Zoom | Learning Journey | Museum of the African Diaspora (MoAd) |
| Student Leaders and Principal at Alliance High School Meek | 1/25/23 | Alliance at Meek 4039 NE Alberta Ct, Portland, OR 97211 | Student Engagement | I AM MORE |
| Bagel and Dropoff Student engagement with 40 students | 1/26/23 | Harriet Tubman Middle School 2231 N Flint Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Student Engagement | I AM MORE |
| Student engagement with 50 students | 1/26/23 | Alliance at Meek 4039 NE Alberta Ct, Portland, OR 97211 | Student Engagement | I AM MORE |
| Bagel and Dropoff Student engagement at POIC | 1/26/23 | Portland Opportunities Industrial Center 717 N Killingsworth Ct, Portland, OR 97217 | Student Engagement | I AM MORE |
| Bagel and Dropoff Student engagement with 50 students | 1/26/23 | Alliance at Meek 4039 NE Alberta Ct, Portland, OR 97211 | Student Engagement | I AM MORE |
| Guiding Coalition #2 | 1/27/23 4:30pm-8:00pm | Grant High School 2245 NE 36th Ave, Portland, OR 97212 | Community Engagement | I AM MORE MKT BOX Colloqate |

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| Guiding Coalition #2 | 1/28/23<br>9:00am-4:00pm | Grant High School<br>2245 NE 36th Ave, Portland, OR 97212 | Community<br>Engagement | I AM MORE<br>MKT BOX<br>Colloqate |

## February 2023

| Event | Date & Time | Location | Type | Partner |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| # Enough Plays to<br>End Gun Violence | 2/2/23<br>6:00pm-9:00pm | Jefferson High School Auditorium<br>5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Learning<br>Journey | Four Forces Inc |
| Bagel Engagement Drop<br>Off @ Jefferson High | 2/2/23 | Jefferson High School Auditorium<br>5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Student<br>Engagement | I AM MORE |
| Bagel Engagement Drop<br>Off @ Harriet Tubman | 2/2/23 | Harriet Tubman Middle<br>2231 N Flint Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Student<br>Engagement | I AM MORE |
| Bagel Engagement Drop<br>Off @ Alliance @ Meek | 2/2/23 | Alliance at Meek<br>4039 NE Alberta Ct, Portland, OR 97211 | Student<br>Engagement | I AM MORE |
| Bagel Engagement Drop<br>Off @ POIC | 2/2/23 | POIC + RAHS<br>717 N Killingsworth Ct, Portland, OR 97217 | Student<br>Engagement | I AM MORE |
| Bagel Engagement Drop<br>Off @ Ivy Middle School | 2/2/23 | Ivy Middle School<br>5420 N Interstate Ave, Portland, OR 97217 | Design Research<br>(Staff) | I AM MORE |
| Bagel Engagement Drop<br>Off/BSU Meeting @ Ockley | 2/2/23 | Ockley Green Middle School<br>6031 N Montana Ave, Portland, OR 97217 | Student<br>Engagement | I AM MORE |
| Stars of Jefferson:<br>Black Shines Brighter | 2/3/23<br>12pm – 7 pm | 815 N. Killingsworth,<br>Portland, OR 97217 | Community<br>Engagement | Jefferson Community |
| Portland City Tour | 2/4/23<br>11:00am-5:00pm | Dr. Matthew Prophet Center<br>501 N Dixon St., Portland, OR 97227 | Learning<br>Journey | ReBuilding Cornerstone's<br>"MAYO House Learning Hub"<br>Self Enhancement INC.<br>BSTRONG Learning Hub<br>Soul Restoration Center<br>Black United Fund<br>Feed'em Freedom Foundation<br>Akadi PDX |
| MoAD Virtual Tour: The Life<br>+ Art of William H. Johnson | 2/6/23<br>1:00pm-3:00pm | Via Zoom | Learning<br>Journey | Museum of the African<br>Diaspora (MoAd) |
| Bagel Engagement Drop<br>off @ Jefferson High | 2/9/23 | Ockley Green Middle School<br>6031 N Montana Ave, Portland, OR 97217 | Student<br>Engagement | I AM MORE |

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| Bagel Engagement Drop off @ Harriet Tubman (50 Students) | 2/9/23 | Harriet Tubman Middle School<br>2231 N Flint Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Student Engagement | I AM MORE |
| Bagel Engagement Drop off @ POIC | 2/9/23 | POIC + RAHS<br>717 N Killingsworth Ct, Portland, OR 97217 | Student Engagement | I AM MORE |
| Bagel Engagement Drop off @ Ivy Middle School | 2/9/23 | Ivy Middle School<br>5420 N Interstate Ave, Portland, OR 97217 | Student Engagement | I AM MORE |
| Bagel Engagement Drop off @ Ockley | 2/9/23 | Ockley Green Middle School<br>6031 N Montana Ave, Portland, OR 97217 | Student Engagement | I AM MORE |
| Family Night at Tubman (Jefferson Engagement Event) | 2/9/23<br>5:00-7:00pm | Harriet Tubman Middle School<br>2231 N Flint Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Community Engagement | |
| Engagement with students about CBSE with Interviews | 2/10/23 | Harriet Tubman Middle School<br>2231 N Flint Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Student Engagement | I AM MORE |
| Connection with Students from De La Salle to speak about CBSE | 2/10/23 | Soul Restoration Center<br>14 NE Killingsworth St, Portland, OR 97211 | Student Engagement | I AM MORE |
| 2023 Healing Summit: Coming Together – Community & Youth Empowerment | 2/11/23<br>11:00 AM - 5:00 PM | Portland Community College<br>Cascade 705 North Killingsworth Street<br>Portland, OR 97217 | Community Engagement | Lines for Life |
| Bagel Engagement Drop off @ Harriet Tubman (50 Students) | 2/16/23 | Harriet Tubman Middle School<br>2231 N Flint Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Student Engagement | I AM MORE |
| Bagel Engagement Drop off @ Harriet Tubman (50 Students) | 2/16/23 | Harriet Tubman Middle School<br>2231 N Flint Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Student Engagement | I AM MORE |
| Bagel Engagement Drop off @ POIC | 2/16/23 | POIC + RAHS<br>717 N Killingsworth Ct, Portland, OR 97217 | Student Engagement | I AM MORE |
| Jefferson High School Modernization's Design Advisory Group | 2/16/23<br>5:00pm - 7:00pm | Jefferson High School Cafeteria<br>5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, OR 972147 | Community Engagement | |
| Guiding Coalition #3 | 2/17/23<br>4:30pm-8:00pm | Grant High School<br>2245 NE 36th Ave, Portland, OR 97212 | Community Engagement | I AM MORE<br>Colloqate<br>MKT BOX |
| Guiding Coalition #3 | 2/18/23<br>9:00am-4:00pm | Grant High School<br>2245 NE 36th Ave, Portland, OR 97212 | Community Engagement | I AM MORE<br>Colloqate<br>MKT BOX |

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| RESJ Partners<br>Q2 Event | 2/27/23<br>11:30am-1:00pm | Windows Conference Room (Second Floor)<br>Dr. Matthew Prophet Center<br>501 N Dixon St., Portland, OR 97227 | Community<br>Engagement | |

**March** 2023

| Event | Date & Time | Location | Type | Partner |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Black Student<br>Excellence Expo | 3/25/23 (Postponed)<br>11:00am-3:00pm | Blazer Boys & Girls Club<br>5250 NE Martin Luther King Jr Blvd, Portland, OR | Student<br>Engagement | I AM MORE |

## PHASE III

**March** 2023

| Event | Date & Time | Location | Type | Audience | Partner |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Student Enrichment and<br>Relationship Building | 3/2/2023 | Harriet Tubman Middle School; Cafeteria<br>2231 N Flint Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Student<br>Engagement | Tubman<br>Students | I AM MORE |
| Student Enrichment and<br>Relationship Building | 3/2/2023 | Alliance at Meek<br>4039 NE Alberta Ct, Portland, OR 97211 | Student<br>Engagement | Alliance @<br>Meek Students | I AM MORE |
| Student Enrichment and<br>Relationship Building | 3/2/2023 | Ivy Middle School<br>5420 N Interstate Ave, Portland, OR 97217 | Student<br>Engagement | Ivy Middle<br>School Students | I AM MORE |
| Student Enrichment and<br>Relationship Building | 3/2/2023 | Ockley Green Middle School<br>6031 N Montana Ave, Portland, OR 97217 | Student<br>Engagement | Ockley Green BSU | I AM MORE |
| Class Visits and<br>Introductions | 3/3/2023 | Vernon K-8 School<br>2044 NE Killingsworth St, Portland, OR 97211 | Student<br>Engagement | Vernon<br>School Students | I AM MORE |
| The Impacts of Gun<br>Violence & Displacement | 3/4/2023 | Nick Fish Building<br>10560 NE Halsey St., Portland, OR 97220 | Community<br>Engagement | Displaced Impacted<br>by Gun Violence | Four Forces,<br>Prosper Portland |
| Gang Informed<br>Teens and Adults | 3/5/2023 | N/A | Community<br>Engagement | Community Members<br>Informed by Gang Activity | Four Forces,<br>Prosper Portland |
| Albina Vision Trust<br>Community Plan Open House | 3/6/2023<br>5:30pm-7:30pm | Albina Vision Trust, Left Bank Building<br>240 North Broadway Suite 116 Portland, OR 97227 | Community<br>Engagement | AVT Stakeholders | Albina Vision Trust |
| Student Enrichment and<br>Relationship Building | 3/6/2023 | Vernon K-8 School<br>2044 NE Killingsworth St, Portland, OR 97211 | Student<br>Engagement | Vernon<br>School Students | I AM MORE |

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|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Staff and Student Interviews Engagement | 3/7/2023 | Ivy Middle School<br>5420 N Interstate Ave, Portland, OR 97217 | Student Engagement | Ivy Middle School Students | I am MORE |
| Student and Parent Interviews and Videos | 3/8/2023 | Soul Restoration Center<br>14 NE Killingsworth St, Portland, OR 97211 | Community Engagement | | I am MORE |
| Clergy Engagement | 3/8/2023<br>11:30am-1:00pm | Life Change Church<br>3635 N Williams Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Community Engagement | Faith Community | Life Change Church |
| Student Enrichment and Relationship Building | 3/9/2023 | Harriet Tubman Middle School | Student Engagement | Harriet Tubman Students | I am MORE |
| Student Enrichment and Relationship Building | 3/9/2023 | Alliance @ Meek | Student Engagement | Alliance @ Meek Students | I am MORE |
| Student Enrichment and Relationship Building | 3/9/2023 | POIC + RAHS<br>717 N Killingsworth Ct, Portland, OR 97217 | Student Engagement | POIC + RAHS Students | I am MORE |
| Student Enrichment and Relationship Building | 3/9/2023 | Roosevelt High School<br>6941 N Central St, Portland, OR 97203 | Student Engagement | | |
| MLK Black Family Night | 3/9/2023<br>5:15pm-7:00pm | Martin Luther King School<br>4906 NE 6th Ave, Portland, OR 97211 | Community Engagement | K-5 Families | MLK PTA |
| National Panhellenic Council Engagement | 3/10/2023<br>6:00pm-8:00pm | Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center<br>501 N Dixon Street | Community Engagement | Black Greek Letter Organizations | |
| Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center Renaming | 3/11/2023<br>12:00pm-2:30pm | Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center<br>501 N Dixon Street | Community Engagement | Elders and Educators | Oregon Alliance of Black School Educators |
| Kairos Family Council (KFC) | 3/14/2023<br>5:30pm-7:00pm | KairosPDX<br>4915 N Gantenbein Ave, Portland, OR 97217 | Community Engagement | K-5 Families | KairosPDX |
| Harriet Tubman Community Night | 3/15/2023<br>5:30pm-7:00pm | Harriet Tubman Middle School; Cafeteria<br>2231 N Flint Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Community Engagement | 6-8 Grade Families | |
| Harriet Tubman BSU - Student Engagement | 3/16/2023<br>12:00 - 12:45pm | Harriet Tubman Middle School<br>2231 N Flint Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Student Engagement | 6-8 Grade Students | I am MORE |
| Guiding Coalition #4 | 3/17/2023<br>5:30 - 8:00pm | 2245 NE 36th Ave, Portland, OR 97212 | Community Engagement | Guiding Coalition | I AM MORE Colloqate MKT Box |

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| Guiding Coalition #4 | 3/18/2023<br>9:00am - 4:00pm | 2245 NE 36th Ave, Portland, OR 97212 | Community Engagement | Guiding Coalition | I AM MORE<br>Colloqate<br>MKT Box |
| Declaration of a State of Emergency for Black Children | 3/21/2023<br>6:30pm-8:30pm | Promise Land Community Church<br>5760 NE Cleveland Ave, Portland, OR 97211 | Community Engagement | Clergy | |
| Student Enrichment and Relationship Building | 3/21/2023 | Harriet Tubman Middle School<br>2231 N Flint Ave, Portland, OR 97227 | Community Engagement | Harriet Tubman Students | I AM MORE |
| Jefferson High School Modernization's Design Advisory Group | 3/23/2023<br>5:00pm - 7:00pm | Jefferson High School Cafeteria<br>5210 N Kerby Ave | Community Engagement | Jefferson Community | |
| Kairos Parent Teacher Conferences | 3/23/2023<br>8:00am-5:00pm | Kairos PDX<br>4915 N Gantenbein Ave, Portland, OR 97217 | Community Engagement | K-5 Families | Kairos PDX |
| Kairos Parent Teacher Conferences | 3/24/2023<br>8:00am-5:00pm | Kairos PDX<br>4915 N Gantenbein Ave, Portland, OR 97217 | Community Engagement | K-5 Families | Kairos PDX |
| Black Student Excellence Expo | 3/25/23 (New Date)<br>11:00am-3:00pm | Blazer Boys & Girls Club<br>5250 NE Martin Luther King Jr Blvd, Portland, OR | Student Engagement | All Community | I AM MORE |
| CBSE Student Branding Workshop | 3/29/2023<br>10:00am-12:00pm | Virtual | Student Engagement | | |
| March Community Dinner Series | 3/30/23<br>5:30pm-8:00pm | Ecotrust<br>1140 SE 7th Ave Suite 150,<br>Portland, OR 97214, USA | Community Engagement | Elected Officials, Business Leaders, Higher Education Partners, Center for Black Excellence Steering Committee | |
| Interviews with CBO Leaders | Throughout the Month<br>Varied | Multiple Locations | Community Engagement | Leaders of Community Based Organizations serving Black Students | Colloqate -<br>CDO Mims Rouse |
| Interviews with Students | Throughout the Month<br>Varied | Multiple Locations | Community Engagement | Students and Alumni | Colloqate -<br>Syncier Sevier |

## PHASE IV

### April 2023

| Event | Date & Time | Location | Type | Audience | Partner |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Coalition of Black Men | 4/1/2023<br>10:00-11:30am | Virtual | Student Engagement | Mentors, Educators, Elders | Colloqate -<br>CDO Mims Rouse |

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| Black Community of Portland - Youth kick-back | 4/1/2023 3:00pm - 6:00pm | 16126 SE Stark St, Portland, OR 97233 | Student Engagement | Displaced Black youth and families | Colloqate - CDO Yemaya Benton |
| Black Community Of Portland Gathering | 4/2/2023 5:30pm - 7:30pm | 5441 SE Belmont St, Portland, OR 97215 | Community Engagement | Ppen invite to Black community | Colloqate - CDO Yemaya Benton |
| Workstrand Inventory Meetings - Communications | 4/5/2023 3:45pm - 4:30pm | Virtual | Design Research (Students) | | |
| Workstrand Inventory Meetings - Jefferson Modernization Team | 4/6/2023 9:00 – 9:45am | Virtual | Design Research (Staff) | | |
| Workstrand Inventory Meetings - Middle School Redesign | 4/6/2023 9:45 – 10:30am | Virtual | Design Research (Staff) | | |
| Workstrand Inventory Meetings - PK - 5 Mathematics | 4/7/2023 12:00 – 12:45pm | Virtual | Design Research (Staff) | | |
| Workstrand Inventory Meetings - Facilities | 4/11/2023 3:00 – 3:45pm | Virtual | Design Research (Staff) | | |
| Workstrand Inventory Meetings - Self-Enhancement, Inc. (SEI) | 4/14/2023 9:00 – 9:45 am | Virtual | Design Research (Staff) | | |
| Black Student Success Summit | 4/15/2023 8:00am - 4:00pm | | Student Engagement | | Hosted by Black Educational Achievement Movement (BEAM) |
| Immigrant/ Refugee Phone Banking | 4/15/2023 4:00pm - 8:00pm | Virtual | Student Engagement | Immigrant and refugee students | Hosted by Imagine Black Futures in collaboration with AYCO and SAMO |
| Workstrand Inventory Meetings - GEAR UP | 4/17/2023 11:15am – 12:00pm | Virtual | Design Research (Staff) | | |
| Reclaiming the Black Educational Experience | 4/17/2023 5:00pm-7:30pm | | Community Engagement | Open invite to Black community including stakeholders from Jefferson and Harriet Tubman. | |
| Workstrand Inventory Meetings - Funded Programs | 4/18/2023 3:00 – 3:45 pm | Virtual | Design Research (Staff) | | |
| Workstrand Inventory Meetings - Racial Equity and Social Justice (RESJ) | 4/21/2023 9:00 – 9:45 am | Virtual | Design Research (Staff) | | |

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| Workstrand Inventory Meetings - Sabin Elementary School | 4/21/2023 3:00 – 3:45 am | Virtual | Design Research (Staff) | | |
| RESJ in person Follow-up Partners Event | 4/24/2023 11:30am-1:00pm | | Community Engagement | RESJ Partners | |
| Workstrand Inventory Meetings - Boise-Eliot Elementary School | 4/24/2023 1:00pm - 1:45pm | Virtual | Design Research (Staff) | | |
| Workstrand Meeting - Dr. Martin Luther King Middle School | 4/25/2023 3:00 – 3:45 pm | Virtual | Design Research (Staff) | | |
| Workstrand Inventory Meeting - Sabin Elementary School | 4/26/2023 9:00 – 10:00 am | Virtual | Design Research (Staff) | | |
| Workstrand Inventory Meetings - College and Career Readiness | 4/26/2023 11:15am - 12:00pm | Virtual | Design Research (Staff) | | |
| Workstrand Inventory Meetings - Student Learning | 4/26/2023 12:00 – 12:45 pm | Virtual | Design Research (Staff) | | |
| Workstrand Inventory Meetings - Office of Teaching and Learning | 4/27/2023 12:00 – 12:45 pm | Virtual | Design Research (Staff) | | |
| Workstrand Meetings - Racial Equity and Social Justice (RESJ) | 4/27/2023 3:00 – 3:45 pm | Virtual | Design Research (Staff) | | |
| Workstrand Inventory Meetings - Learning Acceleration | 4/28/2023 9:00 – 9:45 am | Virtual | Design Research (Staff) | | |
| Workstrand Inventory Meetings - Human Resources | 4/28/2023 10:00 – 10:45 am | Virtual | Design Research (Staff) | | |
| Workstrand Inventory Meetings - Government Relations | 4/28/2023 1:30 – 2:15pm | Virtual | Design Research (Staff) | | |

## **May** 2023

| Event | Date & Time | Location | Type | Audience | Partner |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Workstrand Inventory Meetings - Indian Education | 5/1/2023 11:45am – 12:30pm | Virtual | Design Research (Staff) | | |

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| Workstrand Inventory Meetings - Youth Violence Prevention | 5/1/2023<br>1:00 – 1:45 pm | Virtual | Design Research<br>(Staff) |
| Workstrand Inventory Meetings - Student Learning and Family Engagement | 5/1/2023<br>2:00 – 2:45 pm | Virtual | Design Research<br>(Staff) |
| Jefferson High School Modernization's Design Advisory Group | 5/1/2023<br>5:00pm - 7:00pm | Jefferson High School Cafeteria<br>5210 N Kerby Ave | Community<br>Engagement |
| Workstrand Inventory Meetings - Head Start Black Excellence Classroom | 5/4/2023<br>3:00pm - 4:00pm | Virtual | Design Research<br>(Staff) |

## Key Definitions

### Design Research

A broad term for the process that designers use to better understand the desires, needs, and challenges of those who will be most impacted by new products, services, programs, etc.

### Student & Community Engagement

A series of activities aimed at creating awareness and opportunities for the broad groups of stakeholders to participate in a process. Community engagement often falls on a spectrum.

- **Inform**
  We provide balance and objective information to our community.
- **Consult**
  We seek and obtain feedback from our community on analysis, issues, alternatives and decisions.
- **Involve**
  Work with our community to make sure that their concerns and aspirations are considered and understood.
- **Collaborate & Empower**
  Partner with the community in each aspect of the decision-making.
- **Communicate Powered Action**
  District-decision making as a result of autonomous advocacy from the community.

For the sake of this important body of work, we intend to **Involve and Collaborate and Empower** our community.

### Learning Journey

Learning Journeys are experiences intended to activate all of the participant's senses. They draw participants into introspection while also inciting inspiration. For the sake of the Center for Black Student Excellence project, the Learning Journeys are designed to elevate the work of those who are accelerating Black Excellence whom we may want to learn from as we consider what to include in Portland's CBSE.

# GLOSSARY TERMS

### Black Radical Imagination
The Studio Museum in Harlem defines the 'Black Radical Imagination as a revolutionary process of thinking otherwise using Black diasporic critique to articulate a vision for a different world.'

### Collaborate and Empower
Partner with the community in each aspect of the decision-making.

### Culturally Affirming
Instruction affirms and honors our students and communities of color including their ethnic, racial, and linguistic identities and develops all students' ability to recognize and critique social inequities.

### Educational Equity
Raising the achievement of all students while (1) narrowing the gaps between the lowest and highest performing students and (2) eliminating the racial predictability and disproportionality of which student groups occupy the highest and lowest achievement categories.

### Design Justice
We seek to dismantle the privilege and power structures that use the design professions to maintain systems of injustice in order to envision spaces of radical justice and liberation. It is imperative for the project to center the lived expertise of the communities to which the project serves.

### Differentiation
An approach to teaching that involves offering several different learning experiences and proactively addressing students' varied needs to maximize learning opportunities for each student in the classroom. It requires teachers to be flexible in their approach and adjust the curriculum and presentation of information to learners of different abilities.

### Involve
Work with our community to make sure that their concerns and aspirations are considered and understood.

### Self-Efficacy
Students' belief in their innate ability to set and achieve goals.

### Trauma-Informed Approach
Designed to be a community response to support traumatized students and their families. This includes policies and practices that create safe school environments and professional learning regarding the signs and symptoms of trauma, promote resiliency and wellness among students, their families, and staff, and reduce re-traumatization.

### Racial Equity
Racial equity is the condition that would be achieved if one's racial identity no longer predicted, in a statistical sense, how one fares. When we use the term, we are thinking about racial equity as one part of racial justice, and thus we also include work to address root causes of inequities not just their manifestation. This includes elimination of policies, practices, attitudes and cultural messages that reinforce differential outcomes by race or fail to eliminate them. (Center for Assessment and Policy Development)

## Racial Justice

Racial Justice [is defined] as the proactive reinforcement of policies, practices, attitudes and actions that produce equitable power, access, opportunities, treatment, impacts and outcomes for all. (Catalytic Change: Lessons Learned from the Racial Justice Grantmaking Assessment Report, Philanthropic Initiative for Racial Equity and Applied Research Center, 2009.)

## Social Justice

Those who strive for social justice believe in the triumph of our shared humanity. Social Justice is a process, not an outcome that calls for both personal reflection and social change to ensure that each of us has the right and the opportunity to thrive in our community regardless of our identities. It calls on us to design and continually perfect our education institutions by challenging the roots of oppression and injustice, empowering all people to exercise self-determination and realize their full potential and building social solidarity and community capacity for collaborative action.

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